The Editorial Page: Restoration of J&K statehood calls for a phased and negotiated roadmap 10

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'NOTHING MORE IMPORTANT THAN WELFARE AND FUTURE OF OUR YOUTH'

PM steps in: Fast-track courts to punish exam leak guilty, tough new law on way

Draft Bill ready, will take it to Cabinet today... paper leaks have caused immense distress to students, their parents: Modi

Harikishan Sharma, Jatin Anand & Damini Nath
New Delhi, July 23

HOURS AFTER he announced fast-track courts to punish those behind exam paper leaks, Prime Minister Narendra Modi posted a video on social media Thursday night, saying a tough new law was on its way. He said he had received its draft and it would be discussed at a meeting of the Cabinet Friday.

In the video, Modi said, "Friends, I am well aware that the issue of paper leaks is not a small matter. It causes immense distress to lakhs of students and their parents. Consequently, numerous measures have been taken over the past two-and-a-half months following these incidents, and the culprits have been apprehended and are currently in jail."

"Our primary responsibility was to ensure that the students did not lose an academic year; conducting the examinations promptly was crucial. The government mobilised all its resources to arrange for the exams of 22 lakh students to be held in the shortest possible

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

EXPRESS interview

'PM's decision shows Govt very sensitive to issues of the youth'

ARJUN RAM MEGHWAL
LAW & JUSTICE MINISTER
PAGE 6

Business as Usual
By EP UNNY

Activist Sonam Wangchuk with Union Ministers J P Nadda and Jitendra Singh at Medanta Hospital in Gurgaon, Thursday, as he ended his hunger strike after 26 days. @WANGCHUK66/X

Wangchuk ends 26-day fast, cites 'long negotiation, possible violence'

Jatin Anand
New Delhi, July 23

ACTIVIST SONAM Wangchuk, whose indefinite hunger strike in support of the Cockroach Janta Party demands had strengthened the student protest at Jantar Mantar, ended his fast late Thursday night at the Medanta Hospital in Gurgaon.

Wangchuk, in a post on X, said, "Just now in the presence of Union Ministers JP Nadda & Dr. Jitendra Singh and the senior leaders of Apex Body of Leh Ladakh, I finally broke my fast after 26 days. Earlier, 65 Members of Parliament from different political parties had visited or signed letters urging me to break the fast. This was done after a long negotiation on various conditions and in view of possible violence in the country. I will explain the conditions in detail in a separate video very soon. Meanwhile, urge you all to stay very vigilant about not allowing violence of any kind anywhere."

Earlier in the day, in another post, he urged protesters to remain peaceful, saying he was pained by reports that "anti-social elements" were trying to provoke violence.

"Peace and only peace is my way. While at Jantar Mantar the protests remain peaceful, I'm pained to learn that elsewhere some antisocial elements are taking advantage of the peaceful protests to provoke violence," he said.

What this move will address: Endless trials of leak cases, gaps in law

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 23

THE FAST-track courts, announced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi Thursday, to address the issue of exam paper leaks, have their task cut out. In a system where accountability for exam leaks has been dismal with most cases stuck in legal quicksand.

An investigation by *The Indian Express*, published on June 5, found that of 45 major exam leaks between 2002 and 2025, each involving at least one lakh candidates or applicants, only two led to convictions. The biggest challenge, this newspaper found, is poor quality of investigation and the relatively lenient treatment of paper leaks as ordinary offences with no stringent bail conditions.

On multiple occasions, the courts rejected "closure reports" filed by probe agencies mainly citing lack of evidence,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Doping setback for India at CWG: Judoka suspended, sanction on weightlifting team

Pritish Raj
New Delhi, July 23

EVEN BEFORE the Glasgow Commonwealth Games were declared open on Thursday, the Indian contingent suffered a setback as two of its medal prospects — one each in judo and weightlifting — were withdrawn following anti-doping rule violations.

Arun Kumar, a judoka competing in the 78 kg category, was dropped from the squad after being provisionally suspended by the National Anti-Doping Agency (NADA). Though the judo team is yet to leave for Glasgow, India cannot name a replacement since competition rules do not allow it.

Hours after Kumar's suspension, it emerged that weightlifter Dilbagh Singh would return from Glasgow — though for no fault of his own. Indian weightlifting has reported five positive cases in the period June 1, 2025 to July 22, 2026. As a result, India's athlete quota was cut from 16 to 11.

Clause 2.4 of the qualification system reads: "During the period of 01 June 2025-22 July

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

3 treated for pellet injuries, CRPF probes chain of events, role of RAF

Mahender Singh Manral, Pragynesh, Tabshir Shams & Drishti Jain
New Delhi, July 23

WITH AT least three persons being treated in hospitals for pellet gun injuries sustained during the July 20 crackdown on protesters marching towards Parliament, the CRPF has initiated an inquiry to ascertain the exact sequence of events and determine whether pellet guns were used by personnel of its Rapid Action Force.

The RAF is a specialised unit of the CRPF, raised in 1992 to deal with riots and other public disturbances.

The Indian Express has also learnt that the Centre has asked the CRPF to avoid using pellet guns while on duty at Jantar Mantar, the site of the ongoing protest by the Cockroach Janta Party and its supporters.

Following the July 20 crackdown on protesters, at least three cases of pellet gun injuries have come to light — that of 25-year-old Irshad Sheikh who works in Gurgaon; 19-year-old Sahil Lochab, a Delhi University student; and a 28-year-old journalist with the Outlook magazine. All three have been to hospitals for treatment of pellet injuries.

Responding to a query from *The Indian Express* on the government's direction to the CRPF to avoid the use of pellet guns while on duty at Jantar Mantar, the CRPF spokesperson said, "We are comprehensively enquiring into the whole gamut of events. It will be premature to comment now."

Sources said that after the RAF and Delhi Police personnel cracked down on the protesters on July 20, no one in the CRPF was aware of any use of pellet guns. Pellet guns and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

INSIDE

WITH 360-DEGREE CAMERAS, AI FACIAL RECOGNITION, POLICE MONITOR PROTEST

NO EVIDENCE TO LINK KEY ACCUSED TO NEET-2024 PAPER THEFT, SAYS CBI

FULL COVERAGE
PAGES 4, 6, 8, 11

Happening today

- **THE SUPREME** Court will hear a plea of the Muslim side stating that the alternative site identified for namaz was too far from the disputed Bhojshala complex in Dhar.
- **J&K ASSEMBLY** privileges committee will hear a motion against PDP MLA Waheed Para.

TRACK THESE AND MORE ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Centre shifts higher education secy, education ministry gets 2 new secys

Harikishan Sharma
New Delhi, July 23

IN A major bureaucratic reshuffle, the Centre on Thursday shifted Higher Education Secretary Vineet Joshi to the Ministry of Panchayati Raj, and appointed two new Secretaries in the Ministry of Education.

The Ministry of Education has been at the centre of a controversy due to the NEET-UG question paper leak and irregularities in the CBSE's evaluation of board exams.

While Naresh Pal Gangwar has been appointed as the Higher Education Secretary, T K Anil Kumar has been brought in as Secretary, Department of School Education and Literacy. Gangwar, a 1994-batch Rajasthan-cadre IAS officer, is currently the Animal Husbandry Secretary. Anil Kumar, a 1995-batch Karnataka-cadre IAS officer, is posted as Additional Secretary in the Ministry of Rural Development.

Joshi was also holding the charge of School Education Secretary, and was the acting chairperson of the University Grants Commission (UGC) too.

He has also served as the Director General of the National Testing Agency (NTA) and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

ANTIQUE CANNON STOLEN FROM MP'S NARWAR FORT, HUNT ZEROES IN ON A VILLAGE IN RAJASTHAN

Down a fort, now under the ground? Cops of two states search for 3,500-kg cannon

Parul Kulshrestha & Anand Mohan J
Jaipur, Bhopal, July 23

CAN A 3,500-kg cannon just disappear? Police of two states are hoping not, as they search for the antique item stolen from the historic Narwar Fort in Shivpuri, Madhya Pradesh, on July 15, digging up, so far, only mounds of earth and no clues.

For the past two days, the search of the Rajasthan Police and Madhya Pradesh Police has been concentrated on Gavda Meena village in Karauli district which, at 250 km from the Narwar Fort, is a good six-seven hours drive for anyone hauling a 3.5-tonne cannon.

Excavation at one of the locations in Gavda Meena village in Karauli district of Rajasthan. EXPRESS

Since the Madhya Pradesh Police arrived Wednesday, JCB machines have been deployed for excavation at several locations in the village, with no luck. A team equipped with specialised metal detectors that can scan underground has been summoned from Bharatpur to help.

Giriraj Prasad, the SHO of the Hindaun Sadar Police Station, says the Shivpuri police told them they had received leads that the cannon, dating back 400 years, had been brought to Gavda Meena.

"Police and administrative teams are excavating several locations. More than 50 police

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

'Amistad' Honours

Chief of the Army Staff General Dhiraj Seth honouring a soldier who participated in a Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief mission in Venezuela under Operation Amistad, on Thursday. ANI

HONEYMOON MURDER CASE

Top court cancels Sonam's bail, orders her to surrender in three weeks

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 23

THE SUPREME Court Thursday cancelled the bail granted to Sonam Raghuvanshi, an accused in the Meghalaya honeymoon murder case, and asked her to surrender in three weeks.

A bench of Justices M M Sundresh and P B Varale disagreed with the conclusion of the Meghalaya High Court that the grounds of arrest were not supplied to the accused and said her "continued enlargement at this stage might hinder the ongoing trial".

Sonam was arrested in connection with the May 23 murder of her newlywed husband, Indore-based businessman Raja Raghuvanshi, during their honeymoon in the hill state.

Rejecting the HC's reasoning, the SC pointed to a distinction between non-service of the grounds of arrest and inadequate particulars in the grounds supplied.

"It is not as if the respondent was not served with the grounds of arrest. There is a difference between non-service and giving adequate reasons thereunder. While the first category might vitiate the arrest, in the second, one has to see the prejudice," the top court said.

It added that the accused "expressed her satisfaction on the (receipt of) reasons behind her arrest". "Documents were indeed served on her. Therefore, we are not inclined to go into the issue of the validity of the arrest. Suffice it to state that both courts have committed an error by granting bail on the basis of the judgment rendered by this court."

The bench said it is "also conscious of the fact that bail is the rule and jail is the exception". "However, we are dealing with a case where the earlier bail orders rejecting enlargement on merit have attained finality. The trial has already begun. We are inclined to observe that continued enlargement at this stage might hinder the ongoing trial."

The court said Sonam could apply for bail afresh if the trial is not completed in 6 months.

She was granted bail by a Shillong court in the case on April 27, saying the grounds of arrest had not been effectively communicated to her. The Meghalaya High Court dismissed the state's appeal challenging the order on June 29.

While challenging the bail, the state government contended that the grounds of arrest were communicated to her, but due to a typographical error, Section 403 of the BNS was mentioned instead of Section 103 (murder).

The state's plea also said that the accused obtained bail in her fourth attempt, and that three of her pleas were rejected by the trial court, citing her flight risk and the likelihood of her tampering with the evidence, given her past conduct.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

PM steps in

time, and the results were declared just five or six days ago, on the 19th (of July). While news of the success and happiness of students across the country is coming in, we are not the kind of people to simply rest content with that. That is why I instructed the departments concerned today regarding the establishment of fast-track courts," he said.

"Working tirelessly, late into the night, the departments have already submitted a draft proposal to me. This draft, which includes provisions for fast-track courts and stricter penalties, will be discussed in the Cabinet tomorrow. It will be finalised after incorporating suggestions from Cabinet colleagues, and efforts will be made to pass the Bill in the House as soon as possible, starting with the second week of the Parliament's session this coming Monday," he said.

Earlier in the day, the Prime Minister, in a post on X – his first public remarks on the row over examination paper leaks that have triggered protests in the heart of the Capital – said, "Nothing is more important than the welfare and future of our youth! We have decided to set up fast-track courts to ensure swift and stringent punishment for those involved in paper leaks. Have directed the concerned authorities and officials to take all necessary steps in this regard. This continues our series of steps for safeguarding the interests of students. Those who try to harm the future of our youth will not be spared."

His remarks came amid his government's efforts to defuse the situation arising out of the Cockroach Janta Party-led protests, now backed by the Opposition which has joined the chorus for the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan.

The CJP and Opposition leaders criticised the announcement, saying it did not address their key demands for accountability and the resignation of Pradhan.

Law and Justice Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal said the government would set up fast-track courts to conduct trials of examination paper leak cases.

Speaking to The Indian Express, Meghwal said, "We have taken note of the NEET exam leak cases ongoing at the Bombay, Delhi, Calcutta, and Madhya Pradesh High Courts. We are setting up fast-track courts at these four courts for speedy trials. In the future, we will do so if any such case arises."

He said the fast-track courts could be set up as early as this week. "There will be day-to-day hearings in the NEET cases so that the youth are given justice soon," he said.

BJP leaders and senior ministers welcomed the decision to form fast-track courts.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah said, "The decision to expedite hearings and take stringent action against the guilty in paper leak cases through the establishment of fast-track courts by the Prime Minister is a reflection of this very commitment. This important step... against those who toy with the future of the youth due to paper leaks will prove to be a milestone."

BJP chief Nitin Nabin said the PM had said earlier and reiterated that the NDA government was "ready for any investigation" and would bring fast-track courts to ensure that those involved would not be spared. "When Narendra Modi ji takes a sankalp (commitment), both the nation as well as the world know that it means taking this towards siddhi (completion/conclusion)," he said.

Nabin said the entire Opposition, including the Congress, was "running away from discussion, because they know that as soon as they come to the floor of the House, their double standards will be completely exposed".

Union Health Minister J P Nadda said, "To tackle a serious challenge like paper leaks, PM Modi ji's resolve to establish fast-track courts and take the strictest action against the guilty is a clear testament to our government's sensitivity and commitment towards the youth."

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What this move will address: Endless trials of leak cases, gaps in law

or reprimanded them for lapses in investigation.

In the 2016 Karnataka PUC Chemistry paper leak, for example, the Bengaluru Sessions Court acquitted 19 accused, including senior officials and the alleged kingpin booked under the stringent Karnataka Control of Organised Crime Act (KCOCA), in May 2024, citing serious investigative shortcomings.

In another case from that year — the UP Public Service Commission examination for the posts of Review Officer and Assistant Review Officer — a Special Judicial Magistrate rejected the closure report filed by the UP Police's CB-CID in 2018 and ordered a reinvestigation in 2020.

There have been instances where cases were closed in haste, too.

In the UGC NET case of 2024, for example, a Delhi court in May 2026 criticised the CBI for filing a closure report despite possessing, in the court's assessment, evidence of a leak.

According to investigators and officials, paper leaks are often treated under the law as ordinary offences. "Most cases were registered under IPC Sections such as 420 (cheating), 467 and 468 (forgery), and 120-B (criminal conspiracy) -- all ordinary offences that carry no stringent bail conditions. Some states have brought in the Enforcement Directorate to invoke the money laundering law... UP has, on occasion, applied the Gangsters Act to attach properties and extend custody," a senior official associated with a Central investigation told this newspaper.

One area where fast-track courts can potentially make a difference is in accelerating the process. For, as *The Indian Express* investigation found, in several cases, trials proceeded slowly when charges are framed. An illustrative example is the 2006 Railway Group-D case, which has seen 142 hearings between 2012 and 2026 and is still at the "witness stage".

Outside the court, too, there are three key gaps that need to be plugged.

- **Rot within:** The institutions meant to prevent leaks were sometimes enabling them. For instance, the Rajasthan High Court found that Rajasthan Public Service Commission members themselves were complicit in the 2021 Sub-Inspector exam leak.
- **Evolving rackets:** Leak rackets have transformed rapidly, leaving the investigative and legal apparatus several steps behind. Criminal networks have moved from fax transmissions to Bluetooth devices, remote-access software and compromised printing and logistics firms.
- **Weak links in chain:** Poor security at the printing and transport stage of exam papers are hard to trace and prosecute. Two examples: The 2023 Bihar Police Constable leak, where a printing firm diverted papers to an unauthorised private warehouse; the 2024 UP Police Constable leak, where the sealed trunks containing exam papers were tampered with while keeping the official seals intact.

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Cops of two states search for 3,500-kg cannon

personnel are involved in this, with others deployed across the village for security," says Prasad, adding that every heap where the soil looks freshly disturbed is being investigated. "We are looking at places where fresh soil is visible, or any other suspicious location. On Wednesday, the operation continued until night."

On Thursday, when the search went on from 9 am to 2 pm, at least five to six suspected locations were searched.

The race is against time, as authorities hope to find the heritage cannon before it makes its way to the organised antiquities trafficking network.

Meanwhile, the red-faced Madhya Pradesh authorities are trying to put the dots together on how the heist was pulled off from the Narwar Fort which, to top it, is located on a 3,000-ft-high steep hill. Dated 16th Century and believed to be a rare artillery piece belonging, the cannon was displayed in the 'Open Kachahari' complex of the fort.

On paper, six guards are deployed for security of the fort – four during the day and two at night. However, the night guards were reportedly missing. During questioning, one of them indicated to investigators that even if he had been around, he could have done little. They lack even basic facilities such as lighting, torches or security equipment, he said.

A joint inspection by the Madhya Pradesh State Archaeology Department and police recovered mattresses, quilts, iron pipes, drag marks and tyre impressions from the crime scene and along the difficult rear approach to the fort.

Based on that, the investigators believe the thieves wrapped the cannon in mattresses and quilts to protect it from damage and reduce the noise as it was handled, then used a bearing-fitted iron trolley to lower the cannon down the hill, and put it onto a transport vehicle waiting below. There is a bustling town in the lower ranges of the hill, but no one appears to have noticed a cannon.

MP's poor record

The Narwar Fort theft is the latest in a long series of heritage crimes in Madhya Pradesh, a state known for its rich collection of medieval temples, forts, sculptures and archaeological monuments.

Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) records show the state has topped the country in antiquity thefts from protected monuments over several decades now, besides vandalism. While some have been recovered, many continue to remain missing, and are suspected to have been trafficked to domestic and international markets.

Most of the thefts have been reported from northern Madhya Pradesh, particularly districts such as Gwalior, Morena and Guna. The artefacts stolen include brass finials from the tomb of Mohammed Ghaus, a carved lattice (jaali) from the Man Singh Palace, sculpted heads of Jain Tirthankaras, and from Morena's Shiv Temple, intricately carved sculptures. In Guna district, repeated thefts from the Khinniwala Temple and government sculpture sheds were reported between the early 1980s and late 1990s.

Among the oldest missing artefacts is a Shivlinga from the Asirgarh Fort in Burhanpur, stolen in 1978 and never recovered.

Several thefts have involved dismantling portions of protected monuments themselves, including doorframes, lintels, ornamental pillars, panels and brass pinnacles. At the Mahadeo Temple in Khandwa, multiple brass pinnacles disappeared in a single year.

Among the successful recoveries have been a dancing Ganesha sculpture from Sidhi, a Vishnu-Lakshmi panel from Jabalpur, the Jain Tirthankara heads stolen from Gwalior Fort and the Parshvanath idol from Udayagiri.

The dugout

A small village of about 1,500 people, Gavda Meena is mostly inhabited by the Meenas, who are a Scheduled Tribe community in Rajasthan.

The residents are not too thrilled about being the focus of the hunt for the cannon, with the rising agitation causing cautious authorities to wrap up operations in the afternoon on Thursday.

An official, speaking on the condition of anonymity, said police have called in additional forces to be on the safe side. "Villagers are angry that they are being defamed without any cause. No one has been arrested and no such artefact has been found in the area so far," the official said.

On Friday, the authorities hope to resume the search.

Pellet: CRPF probes role of RAF

shock batons are part of the RAF's riot-control equipment.

On Tuesday afternoon, Delhi Police, responding to a CJP post, said, "Reports claiming that police forces are using pellet guns against peaceful protesters are completely false and misleading."

Since then, at least three cases of pellet gun injuries have come to light.

Sahil Lochab, admitted to the AIIMS Trauma Centre, has been told that he may lose vision in the right eye. He underwent surgery Tuesday.

A senior AIIMS official confirmed that Lochab had "pellet injuries" on the right side of his body. "The patient is currently stable and is on painkillers. As for the extent of his vision loss, he is still undergoing treatment, and it would be premature to draw any conclusions at this stage. He is being provided the best possible treatment," the official said

A student at Delhi University's School of Open Learning, Lochab said he joined the July 20 protest because he was "frustrated" after the Delhi Police recruitment examination he had appeared for in 2024 was cancelled following a paper leak.

"I folded my hands as the security forces came running towards us. And then something hit the right side of my face and I fell down," he said. The next thing he remembers was reaching Lady Hardinge Hospital where Irshad Sheikh, who also sustained pellet injuries, was also admitted.

"From there, I was taken to Safdarjung Hospital. Then I was transferred to the RP Centre at AIIMS. But due to the severity of my injury, I was sent back to the AIIMS Trauma Centre," he said. His father Deepak works as a driver and the family lives in Najafgarh in southwest Delhi.

The third person with pellet injuries is a 28-year-old, a journalist with the Outlook. A medical report issued by Safdarjung Hospital on July 22 recorded that he had sustained injuries from "physical assault at Jantar Mantar by pellet gun". It mentioned small, punched-out wounds across his right arm, chest and back, with doctors noting injuries "consistent with pellets". Despite the injuries, he has resumed working from home.

Higher education secy shifted, education ministry gets 2 secys

chairman of the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE).

According to the order issued by the Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT), Joshi will succeed current Panchayati Raj Secretary Vivek Bhardwaj, who is superannuating at the end of the month.

In other changes, the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet, which is headed by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and has Home Minister Amit Shah as the other member, has appointed D Thara, a 1995-batch Gujarat-cadre IAS officer, as the Secretary of the newly created Department of Capital Development in the Ministry of Housing & Urban Affairs.

Satyendra Singh, a 1995-batch IAS officer of Jharkhand cadre, has been appointed as Secretary, Department of Urban Development. He is currently posted as the Additional Secretary, Cabinet Secretariat.

Urban Development Secretary Katikithala Srinivas, a 1989-batch IAS officer of Gujarat cadre, has been shifted as Secretary, Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region.

Chandra Bhushan Kumar, a 1995-batch IAS officer of AGMUT cadre, has been appointed as the new Labour Secretary, succeeding Vandana Gurnani, who is superannuating on July 31.

Mines Secretary Piyush Goyal has been given new charge as the Secretary, National Human Rights Commission. Keshav Chandra, a 1995-batch IAS officer of AGMUT cadre, has been appointed as the new Mines Secretary.

Sushil Kumar Lohani, a 1995-batch IAS officer of Odisha cadre, has been appointed as the new Secretary, Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying.

Doping setback

2026 the maximum number of athlete qualification slots allocated to a CGA will be reduced by one (1) if any weightlifting athlete and/or athlete support personnel from that CGA commits an anti-doping rule violation ('ADRV'). If there are multiple ADRVs, the maximum number of athlete qualification slots allocated to a CGA will be reduced by the same number as the number of ADRVs," the document stated.

Even so, the Indian Weightlifting Federation fielded a 12-member team for the Games. Asked about the selection and withdrawal, a federation official told *The Indian Express* from Glasgow: "We decided to withdraw Dilbagh as he is suffering from a back injury and hasn't trained at all during the preparatory camp in Birmingham."

The Sports Ministry had approved a 191-member contingent, including 126 athletes, for the event. But India's medal prospects had already taken a hit after several sports where the country has traditionally been strong, including shooting, wrestling and badminton, were dropped from the programme due to cost constraints.

India won 10 medals in weightlifting at the previous edition of the CWG, in 2022. The reduced squad size is likely to affect that tally this time.

Records show that weightlifting had the second-highest number of doping offenders among Indian sports, after athletics.

In fact, India topped the 2024 annual report of the World Anti-Doping Agency (WADA): 260 athletes tested positive for prohibited performance-enhancing drugs, with athletics accounting for 76 cases and weightlifting for 43. At 3.6 per cent, India's positivity rate was also among the highest in the world.

The latest development comes as India prepares to host the 2030 Commonwealth Games and bids for the 2036 Olympics.

Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya has said that the Government plans to criminalise doping. "Till now, only the sportspersons testing positive were punished with suspensions, disqualification or return of medals. That has not helped us eradicate the problem. We need to target the whole chain and hand out stringent punishments," Mandaviya said recently.

Govt says doors always open for talks; CJP, Opposition firm on Pradhan's resignation

Asad Rehman, Jatin Anand, Liz Mathew & Deeptiman Tiwary
New Delhi, July 23

EVEN AS the Centre renewed attempts to reach out to both the protesters and the Opposition, the deadlock — inside and outside Parliament — continued on Thursday.

Both the CJP, which is leading the protests at Jantar Mantar, and the Opposition remained firm on their demand for Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation over the NEET-UG paper leak.

Appealing to protesters to come forward for talks, Union Minister Jitendra Singh said the government's "doors are always open for talks with the students". He said that in the last 24 hours, the government had invited the CJP for talks "at least four times". He added that the protesters could come to either Health Minister J P Nadda's residence or his office for talks.

CJP spokesperson Saurav Das, however, said the ministers could come to Jantar Mantar or a neutral venue like the Constitution Club of India. "We will meet there. I have not received any message from their side yet. They should contact us directly and discuss where to meet, when to meet and how long the discussion continues," Das said.

According to sources, the CJP has indicated that there would be no compromise on its demand for Pradhan's resignation. The outfit has called for a nationwide protest on Friday.

Meanwhile, Parliament proceedings were disrupted for the fourth straight day on Thursday, amid protests and counter-protests outside the House, and sloganeering by both the Treasury and Opposition benches inside.

While Opposition MPs reiterated their demand for Pradhan's resignation, their counterparts in NDA criticised them for not agreeing to a discussion on the issue in the House.

The Opposition, barring the DMK and AAP, are learnt to have agreed to seek Pradhan's resignation as a pre-condition for any discussion in Parliament. Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju, meanwhile, made multiple appeals to the Opposition to agree to a discussion without any pre-conditions.

At a meeting in the morning, leaders from Opposition parties including the Congress, SP, TMC, Shiv Sena (UBT), Left parties, NCP and IUML decided to intensify their demand for Pradhan's resignation.

While Rijiju has been reaching out to Opposition leaders separately, the government hopes the floor leaders will come together for a meeting on Friday. "The ball is in their court. We will keep appealing," Rijiju said.

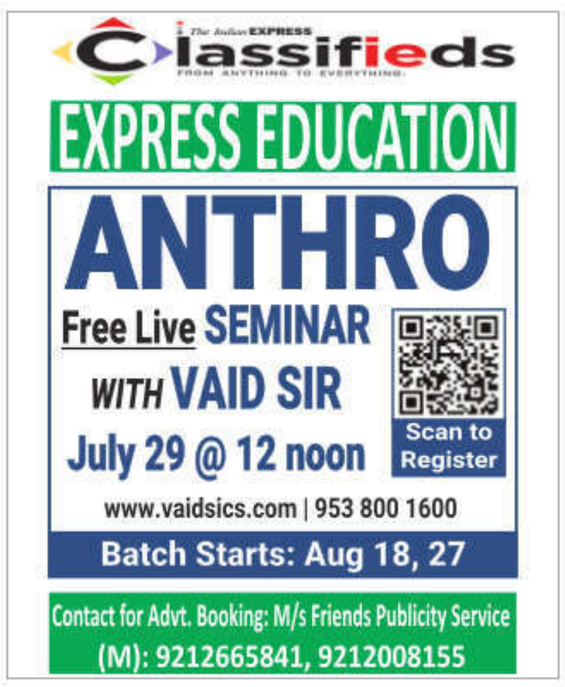
On Thursday, the two sides came face to face, raising slogans against each other, near Parliament's Makar Dwar.

The Opposition side was led by CPP chairperson Sonia Gandhi, LoP Rahul Gandhi, Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge, Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, SP president Akhilesh Yadav and NCP (SP) MP Supriya Sule. On the other side were NDA members including JD(U)'s Sanjay Jha, BJP's Manoj Tiwari, Tarun Chugh and Dilip Saikia, among others.

After the protest, Vadra said: "Have you ever seen, in the history of our democracy, government MPs protesting outside Parliament? They cannot run Parliament; they are extremely weak and cowardly. What kind of treatment is being meted out to the youth?" She asked why PM Narendra Modi wasn't "taking responsibility for the paper leaks". Gandhi said, "You (Modi) allowed and encouraged the total capture and destruction of our education system — and protected every person responsible for it."

BJP MP Dilip Saikia said the ruling members staged a protest against the obstruction "created by the Congress-led Opposition in the running of Parliamentary proceedings". "We urge the Congress not to run away and to participate in the vital discussions in Parliament regarding the students of our country," he said.

BJP RS MP K Laxman said he joined the protest at Makar Dwar against the INDIA bloc "repeatedly disrupting the proceedings of both Houses." BJP MP Anurag Thakur said: "Don't use youth to advance your politics, don't exploit their movement for political gains. If you have the courage, come and take part in the discussion."



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Rapid Action Force contingents stand on guard at Connaught Place. TASHI TOBGYAL

With 360-degree cameras, AI facial recognition, police monitor CJP protest

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, July 23

PARKED OUTSIDE the Kerala House building near Jantar Mantar — the heart of the ongoing student protests in the Capital — are two highly-equipped surveillance and monitoring vans deployed by the Delhi Police, keeping a constant watch on people joining the stir.

Delhi Police's Mobile Command and Control Vehicle; (right) an 'Ikshana' van. SOUMYARENDRA BARIK

In the bigger van, called the 'Mobile Command and Control Vehicle', some Delhi Police personnel are examining live CCTV footage of people at the protest. Opposite to it is a smaller van, called 'Ikshana' (Sanskrit for to look or sight), where two officers stand watch as the footage is run through an Artificial Intelligence (AI)-aided facial recognition software, which shows green boxes around each face as it tries to match it with a police database.

The Delhi Police had inducted the Ikshana van, describing it in a social media post as a "live CCTV surveillance vehicle", ahead of the G20 Summit in New Delhi in 2023. The vehicle is equipped with eight "state-of-the-art fixed cameras" for 360-degrees field of view, and is manned by trained CCTV operators.

A senior Delhi Police officer confirmed that they were using live facial recognition on protesters at the site, saying it was being done to identify any known criminals.

"We have a large database of criminals, with their pictures. So, we run facial recognition on the footage that is received from the various CCTVs in the area, to see if it flags any face the software matches with someone on our criminal database," said the officer, requesting anonymity as he was not authorised to speak to the media.

However, students at the protest said the constant surveillance was having an intimidating effect, forcing them to cover their faces for fear of repercussions later in their lives.

"I and my friends have made such amazing posters for the protests. But because of the cameras constantly monitoring and recording us, we are having to cover our faces while holding up our posters. We are all preparing for competitive exams for government jobs, and don't want to risk getting profiled in police databases," said a student from Rajasthan who is preparing for the UPSC exam in Delhi.

Another student, who was also covering her face, said: "What if the footage of me sloganeering and holding up posters, that the police are recording, somehow finds its way to my parents? They don't know I am here because they don't understand why I need to be here."

A second senior police officer said there weren't any specific data retention guidelines that they were adhering to during the protests. "If and when something unruly happens at the protests, it could merit an investigation either today or three months from now. To carry out the probe, the police would need access to footage from the site, even if the protests are over by then. So it is hard to conclusively say how long the videos could be in our systems," the officer said.

The Delhi Police did not respond to queries on the issue.

The unease protesters are facing over the constant monitoring by the police has also reached the courts. In a petition before the Delhi High Court, former president of the JNU Students' Union, Aishe Ghosh, has alleged that Delhi Police had subjected the protesters to "continuous, indiscriminate and intrusive surveillance", including installation of a permanent surveillance tower and blanket deployment of videographers.

The plea argues that such round-the-clock monitoring violates protesters' fundamental rights to privacy, dignity, free speech and peaceful assembly.

During a hearing in the case on July 20, the Delhi Police, represented by Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, told the High Court that the videography and photography at Jantar Mantar were being carried out solely to maintain law and order and ensure public safety, and "not for surveillance or snooping". The HC has sought the Centre's response on the plea and will hear the matter next on Friday.

From a regulatory standpoint, the usage of facial recognition technology on citizens is covered under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023. The legislation, however, grants wide-ranging exemptions to government agencies -- including security forces like the Delhi Police -- from adhering to much of the protections the law offers.

Across India, digital surveillance systems are increasingly becoming an integral part of modern policing, with law enforcement agencies deploying networks of CCTV cameras, facial recognition technology, drone-based monitoring, automated number plate recognition systems and AI-powered video analytics. While authorities argue that such tools improve public safety and policing efficiency, their growing use has also raised concerns among civil liberties groups over privacy, proportionality, transparency and the absence of a comprehensive legal framework governing surveillance.

Facial recognition systems analyse a person's facial features from an image or video, convert them into a unique digital template, and compare that template against images stored in a database. If the similarity score crosses a predefined threshold, the system flags a potential match for further verification. In response to a Right to Information (RTI) request in 2022, the Delhi Police had revealed that it considered a match to be "positive" if its system showed an accuracy rate of 80%.

Mobile Internet shut around Jantar Mantar

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 23

THE GOVERNMENT ordered telecom companies to shut down Internet services in parts of central Delhi on Thursday, particularly in areas around Jantar Mantar, the site of the students' protests.

According to two orders issued by the Ministry of Home Affairs, mobile Internet across all technologies was suspended in a 1.5-km radius of Jantar Mantar from 8 am to midnight on Thursday. The initial order was for suspension of services until 4 pm, which was then extended to midnight.

The orders said the suspension was necessary "in the interest of public safety and averting public emergency" and for maintaining public order and "preventing incitement to the commission of any offence".

The directions were issued under Section 20(2)(b) of The Telecommunications Act, 2023, and The Telecommunications (Temporary Suspension of Services) Rules, 2024.

Mobile data services in places as far as Mandi House metro station almost two kilometres away from Jantar Mantar were reported to have been impacted on Thursday. Both the protesters as well as people in workplaces in the city's central business district were impacted.

A message received by an Airtel user in the Mandi House area read: "Dear customer, as per Government directive, Internet services have been temporarily stopped in your area. Inconvenience caused is regretted. Team Airtel."

Hotels in the area that charge a fee to park vehicles told people that they would only accept cash. Several shopkeepers complained that they were unable to accept payments through UPI. Users said they could not make or receive WhatsApp calls, and normal calls were proving inconsistent due to network congestion.

Ghost town by dusk: CP falls silent as shutters come down

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, July 23

CONNAUGHT PLACE — usually packed with office-goers, shoppers and diners — had fallen eerily silent by Thursday evening.

Around 7 pm, shutters rolled down across much of the market, restaurants emptied out and only a handful of CJP protesters and Rapid Action Force (RAF) personnel occupied the streets.

Earlier in the afternoon, the New Delhi Traders Association (NDTA) had issued an "advisory circular", asking all shops and establishments, including offices and restaurants, in Connaught Place to close for the day by 6.30 pm on the advice of the NDMC chairman and vice chairman. The owners were requested to cooperate and ensure "strict compliance" with the directions to avoid any unpleasant situation and save themselves from "loss of property" and "injury".

Most businesses complied.

Popular eateries such as Embassy Restaurant, Immigrant Cafe, Haldiram's and KFC shut well before sunset. Retail outlets, including Fabindia, Raymond and Nike also pulled down their shutters by 6.30 pm.

But not all did.

Mayank Sharma, who has run a mobile accessories shop at Regal Building on Sansad Marg for 25 years, chose to keep his store open.

"My shop closes at 10 pm every day. I saw the NDTA notice, but it only advises us to shut by 6.30 pm," he said, pointing to the word "advise" on the circular displayed on his phone. "I will stick to my usual timings."

Saravana Bhavan, a popular South Indian restaurant, too, continued serving customers. "We have been told to stay open unless there is any problem. There hasn't been one so far, so we will continue," its manager said.

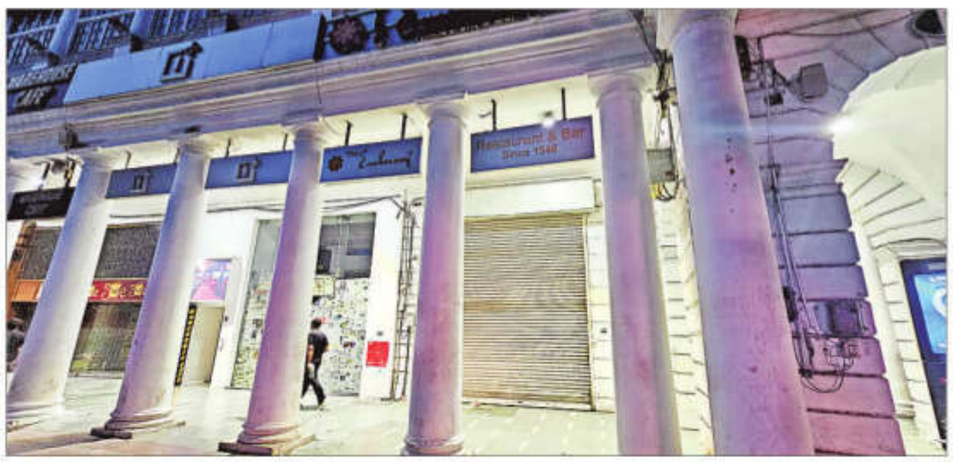
Crocs' store in B Block, Inner Circle, was one of the flagship stores that remained open even after 6.30 pm. The manager said the company's headquarters had not issued any closure instructions.

Restaurants that remained open said business had suffered over the last few days.

Barbeque Nation, which earlier received around 300-350 customers daily, now sees barely 50, its management said.

Sandos reported a similar decline. "Since the road closure after the violence on Monday, and the increase in the number of barricades, there has been a drastic decrease in footfall," said the manager of Sandos.

By 8.15 pm, the well-lit Connaught Place had given way to darkness. The only movement came from buses carrying RAF personnel, their headlights briefly lighting up the streets.



A deserted Connaught Place on Thursday evening. MISHAL MUSSADDIQUE

Went to rescue a colleague, was attacked: Injured ACP

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, July 23

A DAY after he sustained injuries in a clash with CJP protesters at the Tolstoy Marg-Sansad Marg intersection, ACP (Connaught Place) Vivek Bhagat said he was trying to save a policeman when he was attacked with sharp-edged bricks and other projectiles.

Bhagat said the incident took place when he was heading from the Regal Building in Connaught Place to the Tolstoy Marg-Sansad Marg intersection. Accompanied by a team of five to six personnel, including an ACP probationer and his operator, he said they encountered violence as they approached the junction.

According to Bhagat, protesters began pelting police personnel with water bottles and other objects, forcing officers to scatter. Amid the commotion, one policeman in his team was caught in the melee.

"His face was covered in blood. I went to rescue him," Bhagat said.

He alleged that as he attempted to pull the injured officer to safety, the crowd turned on him, attacking him.

"I had the grill on one side and the mob on the other three. To avoid being hit on my head, I put my hands against the grill. They kept hitting me," Bhagat said. He sustained bruises on his face and blows on his chest.

A few metres away at Jantar Mantar, ACP (Punjabi Bagh) Jai Prakash also sustained injuries while police personnel attempted to stop protesters from advancing towards barricaded areas.

Jai Prakash said protesters began throwing water bottles and pelting stones, prompting police personnel to form a human chain near the barricades. During the confrontation, he said, a stone struck him on the head, causing heavy bleeding. Fellow police personnel rushed him to hospital, where doctors found that he had sustained a minor fracture to his head. \Police said an FIR has been lodged on the charge of attempt to murder against unknown persons.

Besides the two ACPs, another ACP and four other police personnel had also sustained injuries between Wednesday afternoon and evening.

Over 20 held while returning from protest site, let off

Pragynesh
New Delhi, July 23

AROUND 20-25 people were detained by the Delhi Police early Thursday after they allegedly gathered in a prohibited area while returning from the Jantar Mantar protest, police said. They were taken to the Lodhi Colony police station, where their identities were verified and their role in the protest was examined before they were released around 10 pm, said police.

Among those detained was 18-year-old Vansh, a Class 12 student from Gokulpuri. According to his father Arvind, Vansh had left home around 8 pm on Wednesday with friends after pooling their pocket money to buy food for the protesters.

"The last time I spoke to my son was around 1 am. He was fine then and said he would return late. Later, his friends called to tell me that the police had detained him," Arvind said.

Among the other detainees were Aakil, Kaamil and Arbaz, their friend Mujeeb, who also went to the protest, said.

"I was on a scooter, so I left Jantar Mantar early. They were coming in an autorickshaw. Though I was not stopped, the police stopped and asked them where they were coming from. When they said they were returning from Jantar Mantar, they were detained. They had even served food to police personnel," Mujeeb claimed.

He added that he came to know about the incident when his friends – students of Jamia Millia Islamia and Delhi University who belong to Nuh in Haryana – called him from the police station. Mujeeb alleged that none of their parents were informed by the police and that he was the one who contacted their families.

A senior police officer, however, said the identities of all those detained has been verified. "We detained them as they had gathered in an area where gathering wasn't allowed. We are verifying what they did during the protest," said the officer.

Family members of some of the detainees allegedly approached lawyers from the Delhi High Court, including advocate Ratnesh Sharma, who reached the police station. The lawyers alleged they were initially prevented from meeting those detained. "We were told that they are not at the police station," said Umesh, an advocate. A lawyer also said that the policemen told him that they are verifying the "criminal record" of those detained.

FOCUS ON PAK-BASED HANDLES: POLICE

Crime Branch, Special Cell to probe clashes during CJP march

Crowd at the Parliament Street on Thursday. GAJENDRA YADAV

Alok Singh
New Delhi, July 23

THE DELHI Police has decided to transfer the investigation into 10 FIRs registered in connection with the clashes and violence during CJP's march towards Parliament on Monday to the Special Cell and the Crime Branch. The move is aimed at establishing whether anti-social elements or outsiders infiltrated the protest and triggered violence during what was initially intended to be a peaceful stir, officers said.

Police are also probing the role of social media in fuelling unrest. Officers said around 480 Pakistan-based social media handles have been identified for allegedly spreading misinformation and fake rumours linked to the protests.

The accounts have been blocked, and police have appealed to students and youth not to rely on unverified information circulated through foreign social media accounts, officers said.

Meanwhile, Delhi Police, along with other government agencies, are preparing an inventory of damaged public property, including police vehicles, barricades and other government assets. Police said once the losses are assessed, legal provisions could be invoked to recover compensation from those found responsible.

The probe into Monday's violence is relying heavily on digital and forensic evidence, officers said. Multiple teams are analysing CCTV footage, drone recordings, body-camera videos, mobile data, digital dump analysis and other forensic material to identify the role of each accused, an officer said.

Investigators have so far collected around 80 videos, which allegedly show protesters attacking police personnel and damaging public property.

SITE & sounds

'Please talk to the children': Physicswallah CEO makes impassioned appeal to govt

Co-founder and CEO of educational technology firm Physicswallah came out in support of the CJP protesters, criticising the government for not talking to them. In a video on Instagram, Pandey also criticised the "national media" for allegedly running fake news about the students, falsely accusing them of having connections with Pakistan, China, or terrorists. "These children were beaten with sticks, they were given wounds... They were beaten by police, and by many goondas as well... Why doesn't the government talk to these children? These are the children of our country. Please talk to them once and listen to their problems," he said.

Alakh Pandey at Jantar Mantar. INSTAGRAM/ @PHYSICSWALLAH

Stars rally behind protesters

"...When an entire generation speaks with one voice about its own future, listening isn't a courtesy we extend. It's an obligation we owe them."
Kareena Kapoor

"...Their courage humbles me. Their resolve is a mirror held up to all of us, asking whether we are truly listening to the very people who will inherit and shape this country's tomorrow."
Alia Bhatt

"We should have listened to when one child cried. Instead, we waited until far too many of our children died... A nation has failed when its children are met with barricades and batons instead of answers..."
Kamal Haasan

Actor Huma Qureshi at Jantar Mantar protest site early Thursday. X/@COCKROACHISBACK

"Beautiful news from my fellow cockroach." Hollywood star **John Cusack** while sharing an article by author Arundhati Roy, who criticised the Delhi Police for using excessive force on students during their 'Sansad Chalo' march.

SC lawyers read Preamble

During the reading of the Preamble at SC lawns. ABHINAV SAHA

Lawyers came together Thursday at Supreme Court to read out the Preamble of the Constitution and recite the National Anthem as a part of 'Save Democracy, Save Constitution' push tied to the CJP stir. Senior advocate Indira Jaising led the recitation alongside SC Bar Association chief Vikas Singh. The gathering was also attended by senior advocates like S Muralidhar, Anand Grover, Vrindra Grover.

Delhi Police Student Crackdown: Did Police Follow SOP During the CJP Protest? EXPLAINED

SCAN THE QR CODE TO WATCH THE VIDEO

After death of teacher, attempt at suicide, CEO office says SIR work mustn't affect school duty

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, July 23

A DAY after a teacher of an MCD school in Kapashera died after a heart attack — with her family claiming that she had been under "extreme stress" while juggling teaching responsibilities with Booth Level Officer (BLO) duties — the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer's office on Thursday directed election officials to ensure that teachers deployed for the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls are not required to disengage from their schools full-time.

The teacher has been identified as Suman Lata (51).

The direction came amid growing concerns over workload and working conditions of government school teachers assigned on the electoral exercise duty. The CEO's office, referring to concerns raised by the Directorate of Education and other representations, said teachers should be permitted to undertake "SIR/BLO-related work after school hours or in a manner that allowed them to continue with their primary academic responsibilities".

The order, issued to all 13 District Election Officers and circulated among all 70 Electoral Registration Officers, also cited the Election Commission's instructions stating that BLO activities should be carried out during holidays, non-teaching hours, after school hours and on non-teaching days so as to avoid loss of academic work.

Lata's death on Wednesday came against the backdrop of concerns raised by teachers over SIR-related work burden and followed an incident of suicide attempt by another teacher. Another government school teacher attempted suicide on July 8.

The order comes amid growing concerns over burden on teachers working as BLOs. FILE

He was supervising BLOs conducting the SIR of electoral rolls for booths.

While Lata's husband Sanjeev Kumar Yadav said she had been receiving work-related calls very late into early morning hours, their relative Karan Yadav told *The Indian Express* that it was not Lata alone who was under stress. Karan questioned the extent to which teachers, particularly older or middle-aged ones posted at government schools, could be expected to handle digital work alongside their regular duties. "IT graduates or diploma holders should be assigned the digital tasks, such as uploading forms. Many times, sites and servers shut down or computers do not work smoothly. Authorities often issue show-cause notices if they are unable to meet targets."

A PIL moved in the Delhi High Court Tuesday, meanwhile, has challenged the large-scale deployment of government and municipal school teachers for BLO and SIR duties, stating that education at such schools is being affected while there is no disruption at private schools.

The petition alleged that work has not been confined to holidays or non-teaching hours. It also cited the example of a school where only 15 guest teachers were left to conduct classes across 22 sections, and another where 22 teachers had been deployed for BLO work.

Ajay Veer Yadav, head of the Government School Teachers' Association, told *The Indian Express*, "Nothing has changed on the ground. How can female teachers feel safe when they are asked to go alone for door-to-door surveys? There is time-bound pressure and everything is digitised." he said.

A government school teacher from West Delhi, on condition of anonymity said, "Due to SIR duties only 20% permanent staff has been available. Rest are guest teachers."

(WITH INPUTS FROM PTI)

UNIVERSITY WARNS OF CONSEQUENCES

Students should not become political tool by joining 'cockroach' protest: DU official

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
New Delhi, July 23

STUDENTS should not become a "political tool" by participating in the ongoing CJP-led protests, Rajni Abbi, Director, Delhi University South Campus, told *The Indian Express*, saying it is advised that students stay away from the agitation as it has, in its view, "turned into a political exercise."

Meanwhile, on Thursday, DU issued an advisory on X, urging students and faculty to stay away from Jantar Mantar, where the protests are being held. "Dear students and faculty, your safety matters to us," the post said, warning that "any unlawful assemblies or demonstrations at Jantar Mantar, New Delhi, which are strictly regulated as per the directives of the Hon'ble Supreme Court of India, may invite legal action." It said participation in such activities could "pose serious risks to students' personal safety and significantly impact their academic progress and professional opportunities," and urged students to prioritise their safety and comply with the law. The university also cautioned that "a significant amount of fake and misleading content is being created and circulated to fuel the situation."

On the participation of DU students in CJP protests, Abbi said, "We do not want our students to become a 'political tool'. Our students have nothing to do with the ongoing agitation. Even if they wish to express solidarity, we want them to understand that participating in such protests can have consequences. FIRs and other legal proceedings are serious matters, and students are young and often do not fully appreciate their implications. It might lead to difficulties in getting opportunities in the future," Abbi said.

"They should carefully assess the nature and trajectory of any agitation before deciding to participate. What may have begun as a movement for reforms has now, in our view, turned into a political exercise and even a spectacle. There should certainly be reforms wherever they are needed, but the agitation has now become political," Abbi added.

She added that DU routinely counsels students to prioritise their education. "During the orientation programme, we generally communicate the importance of nationalism, discipline and responsible citizenship to our students...." Abbi said.

The remarks came a day after DU, in a post on X, said: "We see the pain and anxiety of our students. It is unfortunate that vested interests are exploiting their fears instead of easing them. The need of the hour is to calm the situation.."

Top cop can carry out preventive detentions under NSA

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, July 23

THE DELHI government has authorised the Commissioner of Police to exercise powers under the National Security Act, 1980 (NSA) for three months that began on July 19. Police have clarified that the order is "routine" and unconnected with the CJP protests.

The NSA provides for the preventive detention of individuals in certain cases, which include "acting in any manner prejudicial to the security of the State or...the maintenance of Public order or...the maintenance of supplies and services essential to the community".

A notification issued by the Home (Police-II) Department states that LG has empowered the Delhi Police Commissioner to act as the detaining authority under Section 3(2) of NSA.

The authorisation will remain in force until October 18.

Buses, walking: Commuters look for ways to travel after Metro again shuts 16 stations in protest zone

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, July 23

EVERY MORNING, Nazir Khan's job is to chase monkeys.

The 45-year-old travels from Bhalswa Dairy to the Australian High Commission, where he spends four hours capturing and relocating aggressive monkeys. "Everyday, 10-12 monkeys come there. My shift goes on for four hours," he said. On Thursday, Delhi Metro got in his way.

For the second consecutive day, 16 Metro stations around Central Delhi – all in the vicinity of the Jantar Mantar where CJP supporters are protesting – were closed.

Khan usually gets off at Lok Kalyan Marg station, barely 1.5 km from his workplace. But with the station closed, the train took him to Dilli Haat-INA, two stations ahead.

"I will take bus number 502 until Jor Bagh and then walk another 35-40 minutes. If I spend money on an autorickshaw every day, what will I save?" Khan told *The Indian Express*.

Outside Patel Chowk Metro station on Thursday (left) and commuter Nazir Khan ANI & EXPRESS

Since 7.30 am, 16 stations around Jantar Mantar remained shut, including Lok Kalyan Marg, Rajiv Chowk, Patel Chowk, Ramakrishna Ashram Marg, Barakhambha Road, Supreme Court, Seva Teerth, Janpath, Mandi House, Central Secretariat, ITO, Delhi Gate, Indraprastha, Khan Market, Jor Bagh and Shivaji Stadium.

While interchange facility was available at Rajiv Chowk, Mandi House and Central Secretariat Metro stations even during the closure, passengers could neither enter nor exit these stations. Khan wasn't the only one who suffered.

Delhi High Court advocate Hemant Baisla (32), who takes the Metro daily from Rohini, could not make it to the court. With stations near the HC, Supreme Court, Patiala House Court and Rouse Avenue Court shut, Baisla attended the hearings virtually.

"I use the Delhi Metro for nearly 90% of my monthly travel because it is the fastest and most reliable mode of transport. By car, it takes me around 1.5-2 hours to reach the court due to traffic, whereas the Metro takes about one hour," he said.

"For an advocate, every minute matters, as even a slight delay can affect court proceedings. The closure of Metro stations near court complexes has increased travel time, caused inconvenience to advocates and litigants, and disrupted the smooth functioning of the justice delivery system. The Government should resolve the issue at the earliest through dialogue, as justice delayed is justice denied."

"About 80% of young lawyers use the Metro. I couldn't go to court today, so I relied on virtual hearings," Baisla said.

At the Central Secretariat, only those with valid office IDs were allowed to exit. No one could enter the station.

By Thursday evening, entry gates at Rajiv Chowk, Mandi House and Central Secretariat Metro stations reopened after remaining closed for over 14 hours amid the ongoing CJP protest, while 13 other stations continued to remain shut.

Delhi Tourism & Transportation Development Corporation 18-A, DDA SCO Complex, Defence Colony, New Delhi-110024

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DELHI CONFIDENTIAL

'Odiya Style'

AMIDST HECTIC parleys and strategy meetings over the ongoing protests outside and inside Parliament, Union Home Minister Amit Shah managed to draw fellow MPs' attention with a slight change in look. Shah, who is mostly seen in his signature white Kurta and pyjama, arrived in Parliament wearing a white dhoti and kurta. Those present at Makar Dwar quickly clicked photos of the minister as he got out of the car. Some curious MPs even sought to know the reason for the switch to dhoti. Shah just smiled as Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju guessed that it could be the humid weather. When someone murmured that it's an Assamese-style dhoti, Shah quickly corrected him: "No, it's an Odiya-style dhoti."

The Missing Shoe

LEADER OF the Opposition Rahul Gandhi's "lost shoe" has become a topic of discussion on social media. In a video uploaded on X on Tuesday night, hours after Gandhi was forcibly removed from his protest outside Prime Minister Narendra Modi's residence, he is seen wearing just one shoe. His bare foot caught the attention of many as Gandhi attacked the BJP government over the police action on protesting students. Sources said Gandhi lost the shoe in the chaos at 7, Lok Kalyan Marg, when he was detained by the police.

Open Protest

A DAY after he was suspended for the rest of the Monsoon Session, following a complaint by two of his former party colleagues accusing him of unparliamentary conduct, Trinamool Congress MP Kalyan Banerjee refused to back down from his protest on Parliament premises. Wearing slogans accusing the BJP of having "20 gaddars (traitors)" on its side in the House, Banerjee raised slogans against the 20 rebel TMC MPs who switched to the Nationalist Citizens Party of India after the TMC's defeat in the West Bengal Assembly polls. While he cannot enter the House or be part of its business, among other constraints, the rules allow him to access the Parliament campus.

Jaishankar: There must be zero tolerance for terrorism

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, July 23

A DAY after a policeman on Amarnath Yatra duty was shot dead in Anantnag – the first terror attack in Kashmir since the killing of 26 people, including 25 tourists, in Pahalgam last year — External Affairs minister S Jaishankar said on Thursday that there must be "zero tolerance for terrorism", adding such acts will have consequences.

"There must be zero tolerance for terrorism. Nor should there be any doubt that acts of terrorism will have consequences," Jaishankar said, while speaking at the 33rd ASEAN Regional Forum (ARF) Ministerial Meeting in Manila.

On Wednesday, Head Constable Ashiq Hussain Qureshi, posted with the Indian Reserve Police and attached with the Special Operations Group, was shot dead near Lalchowk in the South Kashmir district, prompting a massive crackdown by security forces.

Jaishankar also said that "attacks on maritime shipping and civilian infrastructure are unacceptable, and commerce through international waterways should remain safe and unimpeded". These comments came in the backdrop of the attacks on ships amid the war between US-Israel and Iran in which Indian seafarers also lost their lives. Most recently, Russian strikes on a ship in Ukraine's vicinity killed Indian sailors.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar meets Oman's Foreign Minister Sayyid Badr bin Hamad Al Busaidi, in Manila on Thursday. ANI

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The External Affairs Minister also flagged China's "assertive" behaviour in the Indo-Pacific and its territorial claims in the South China Sea.

"On South China Sea, (we) underlined that we look forward to a substantive, effective and legally binding CoC (Code of Conduct) fully compliant with UNCLOS 1982 that does not prejudice the legitimate rights of all users," he said. The United Nations Convention on Laws of the Sea (UNCLOS) of 1982 governs the rights of countries regarding marine resources.

He said that he also "recognised the importance of ARF (ASEAN Regional Forum) for discussing political and security issues in the Indo-Pacific, especially in these complex times".

On maritime security, he "shared that the information Fusion Centre in India, the Indo-Pacific Maritime Domain Awareness initiative, deployment of Indian forces from the North Arabian Sea to the Western Pacific, are making a valuable contribution to counter piracy, trafficking and narcotics trade as well as secure maritime commerce".

On the margins of the ASEAN and East Asia meetings, he met his Omani counterpart Sayyid Badr bin Hamad Al Busaidi and discussed the West Asia crisis. The minister also called on The Philippines President Ferdinand R Marcos Jr. besides meeting UK Foreign Secretary Edward Miliband.

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House disrupted for fourth straight day over paper leak

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 23

DISRUPTIONS IN both Houses of Parliament continued for the fourth straight day on Thursday. No parliamentary business could be conducted as the Opposition stuck to its demand for the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan before any discussion on the paper leak issue.

The Lok Sabha witnessed pandemonium as soon as the proceedings began. Speaker Om Birla said the government was ready for a detailed discussion on the paper leak issue and appealed to the Opposition MPs to allow business to be taken up. When they did not relent, Birla adjourned the House till 12 noon. After the Lok Sabha resumed, Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju sought permission to speak.

"Speaker sir, we had appealed yesterday (Wednesday) as well and do so through you today; we have personally spoken to Congress and other Opposition leaders too. We have also invited them to make suggestions to us," Rijiju said. "In regard to the NEET paper leak, both in this House and the Rajya Sabha, in whichever way the Opposition wants, on what date and for whatever duration, the government is ready for a discussion," he said.

Union Minister Kiren Rijiju said the Opposition should not make a discussion on NEET incumbent on conditions. ANI

In Rajya Sabha too, as soon as the proceedings began, Rijiju said the Opposition should not make a discussion on NEET incumbent on conditions. He said all parties, including NDA parties, had demanded a discussion on NEET.

Responding to Rijiju, Leader of the Opposition in Rajya Sabha Mallikarjun Kharge said the Education Minister must resign before any discussion on paper leaks. Rajya Sabha Chairman C P Radhakrishnan adjourned the proceedings till 12 noon. After the proceedings resumed, Kharge said the government should make a statement on the demands for Pradhan's ouster and on the lathicharge and injuries faced by the protesters. As the chaos continued, the proceedings were adjourned till 2 PM. Proceedings then resumed amid slogans but the House was adjourned again until 3 pm.

After the Upper House re-assembled at 3 pm, Deputy Chairman Harivansh allowed Kharge to speak. Kharge began reading poetic remarks from a written text, which implied the Opposition would take on any challenge in the interest of the nation. Harivansh did not allow Kharge to speak further, saying he allowed the LoP to speak only to break the deadlock and start a discussion on the NEET issue, to which the government had already agreed. Within a few minutes, the Upper House was adjourned till 11 am on Friday.

Need a regulatory framework for virtual digital assets, says House finance panel

Ritu Sarin
New Delhi, July 23

THE PARLIAMENTARY Standing Committee on Finance, in its report on the Securities Market Code (SMC), has called for a "comprehensive examination" and an "appropriate regulatory framework" for Virtual Digital Assets (VDAs) such as cryptocurrencies.

The committee has also recommended that pending the establishment of such a comprehensive legislative framework, the government may consider introducing an interim regulatory mechanism through recognised Self-Regulatory Organisations (SROs) operating under the oversight of the designated regulator. Recognising that there was an "existing regulatory vacuum" in the regulation of VDAs, the committee has stated that risks should be mitigated; investor interests should be safeguarded and market discipline ensured while such a regulatory framework was drafted.

"Such a framework should prescribe minimum standards of governance, transparency, disclosure, investor protection, grievance redressal, compliance with prescribed codes of conduct and appropriate regulatory oversight," it said.

According to blockchain data and analytics company Chainalysis, nearly 12 crore Indians are participating in the VDA ecosystem. The committee has discussed reasons why VDAs were being excluded under the proposed changes in the Securities Markets Code since it adopts a "technology-neutral" definition of securities and such VDAs do not satisfy the legal characteristics of securities and derivatives under the proposed framework.

Thus, a new regulatory framework, the committee said, was necessary since the exclusion would be a "regulatory grey area." It said "(this) would result in regulatory uncertainty, exposing investors to heightened risks of fraud, market manipulation, misrepresentation and inadequate grievance redressal, while also creating opportunities for regulatory arbitrage". And that such uncertainty may adversely affect investor confidence and undermine the integrity, transparency and orderly development of the securities market. Although India does not yet have a legal regime for VDAs, the sector was subject to regulation for the purpose of anti-money laundering and taxation. To avoid any ambiguity and to ensure regulatory certainty, clarity on whether VDAs or crypto assets could be included or excluded was needed.

Giving the view of the Centre, the Committee has said that there was an admission that VDAs and crypto-assets were indeed presently unregulated in India, except for the limited purpose of taxation, preventing of money laundering and reporting and that any regulatory framework for such assets would require "significant international and domestic coordination".

EXPRESS special

PM's decision shows Govt is very sensitive to youth issues: Meghwal

Will start with fast-track courts at four places for speedy trial, more if need arises, says Law Minister

Damini Nath
New Delhi, July 23

LAW AND Justice Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal said Thursday that the government would set up fast-track courts in the High Courts of Bombay, Calcutta, Delhi and Madhya Pradesh to decide the pending cases pertaining to the NEET examination paper leak, with the aim of sending those responsible behind bars as soon as possible.

Speaking to *The Indian Express* after Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the government's decision, Meghwal said: "We have taken note of the NEET exam leak cases ongoing at the Bombay, Delhi, Calcutta and Madhya Pradesh High Courts. We are setting up fast-track courts at these four courts for speedy trials. In the future, we will do so if any such case arises."

He said instructions were being issued and the fast-track courts could be set up as early as this week. He said the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 provides for strict punishment for those involved in unfair means, including paper leaks, in all examinations conducted by the Union Public Service Commission, the Staff Selection Commission, the Railway Recruitment Board, Institute of Banking Personnel Selection and the National Testing Agency, which conducts the NEET exam. "But due to the lack of fast-track courts, day-to-day hearings could not be held in these cases so far."

> "...There will be day-to-day hearings in the NEET cases so that the youth are given justice soon"
>
> **ARJUN RAM MEGHWAL,** LAW AND JUSTICE MINISTER

He said there are ongoing cases at the Aurangabad and Nagpur benches of the Bombay High Court, the Calcutta High Court, the Delhi High Court and at the Madhya Pradesh High Court Bench at Indore.

"Looking at the Prime Minister's decision this morning, you can see that the government is very sensitive towards the issues of the youth. The intention behind the decision to set up fast-track courts is that there is speedy trial and all those responsible for paper leaks are behind bars as soon as possible. There will be day-to-day hearings in the NEET cases so that the youth are given justice soon," he said.

It is learnt that the Centre was communicating with the respective state governments Thursday to ensure that the High Courts have the resources required. Each fast-track court will require a designated judge, court staff and a courtroom.

The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 was passed by Parliament in February 2024. While replying to the debate on the Bill in the Lok Sabha on February 6, 2024, Jitendra Singh, Minister of State for Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions, had said: "The Bill is aimed at curbing corrupt practice by few unscrupulous elements that plays havoc with the future of our youth, destroying their careers and aspirations and occasionally resulting in fatal suicides."

The Act, which came into effect on June 21, 2024, provides for imprisonment of three to five years and a fine of Rs 10 lakh for anyone who resorts to unfair means.

LoP Rahul Gandhi and others at Gandhi Smriti on Thursday. EXPRESS

At Gandhi Smriti, Opp MPs pay tribute to students who died by suicide over NEET leak

Asad Rehman
New Delhi, July 23

A UNITED Opposition, led by Lok Sabha LoP Rahul Gandhi, went to Gandhi Smriti on Thursday, and paid tribute to students who died by suicide over the NEET paper leak. They reiterated that the entire Opposition stands behind the demands of the students.

Opposition MPs were first called to Rahul's 5, Sunehri Marg residence, where they held a meeting during which the LoP proposed that the Parliamentarians visit Tees January Marg, where Mahatma Gandhi was assassinated. Following consensus among MPs, Rahul led them to the Gandhi Smriti on a bus.

At the memorial, Rahul and other Opposition MPs paid homage to the deceased students with folded hands and later sang the national anthem. Rahul carried a copy of the Indian Constitution while JMM MP Mahua Majhi and TMC Parliamentarian Mahua Moitra were seen holding the national flag.

In a post on X, Rahul said, "MPs and leaders of the INDIA bloc are peacefully heading to Gandhi Smriti... We go to remember the students we lost...

"And we go to stand with the students who lie injured today... The entire Opposition stands with them and their demands."

Earlier, during the meeting at Rahul's residence, the Opposition MPs deliberated on their strategy to strongly raise the issue of alleged police brutality from the streets to Parliament.

The leaders present at the LoP's residence included Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, general secretaries Jairam Ramesh and K C Venugopal, senior leaders P Chidambaram, Pramod Tiwari, K Suresh, Kumari Selja and Priniti Shinde. RJD's Sanjay Yadav, Sudhakar Singh and Misa Bharti, CPI-M's John Brittas, RSP's N K Premachandran, TMC's Moitra and Saugata Roy, and Samajwadi Party MP Rajeev Rai, were also present.

CJP to Wangchuk, BJP to Rahul: Amid Jantar Mantar stir, why youth voices must be heard

THE NEERJA CHOWDHURY COLUMN

WEEKLY INSIGHT INTO WHAT'S CHANGING IN NATIONAL POLITICS – AND WHY

THREE DAYS after thousands of youths stormed central Delhi as they joined a march to Parliament called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) demanding the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan over the NEET exam paper leak, only to face lathi-charge and tear gas shells used by the police and security personnel, their protest continues at Jantar Mantar.

Following the Delhi High Court's order, the fasting activist, Sonam Wangchuk, has already been shifted to a private hospital in Gurgaon from the government-run Safdarjung Hospital. Rahul Gandhi along with Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and other senior Congress leaders have already been released after a brief detention on Tuesday, when they held a dharna outside Prime Minister Narendra Modi's residence on Lok Kalyan Marg, as was Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav who also joined their sit-in.

In his first remarks on the raging row on Tuesday, PM Modi, while addressing a meeting of the MPs of the BJP-led NDA, asserted that strong action was taken against those involved in the "grave offence" of paper leaks so that no one could play with the future of the youths. The government has also made a placatory gesture and reached out to the CJP leaders and Wangchuk – a move that could have been made several days ago. Why it did not do so, is a question on everyone's lips.

The Jantar Mantar protest has underscored the extent to which a faulty examination and education system is exercising the minds of the young in India today. It has now become increasingly clear that political parties would ignore the youth sentiments at their own peril. This also showed that even though the Modi government is within striking distance of mustering a two-thirds majority in Parliament, it must be prepared to face street protests in a young, diverse and aspirational country.

The CJP protests seem to be different from other protests in the past. Firstly, these protests are not centred on the concerns of any one section of society, like what was seen in recent years – be it the year-long agitation of farmers (from Punjab, Haryana and west UP) against the now-repealed central farm laws, or the anti-CAA-NRC dharnas involving essentially the Muslim community.

The CJP, which was launched by Abhijeet Dipke as a satirical, youth collective in response to the Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant's courtroom use of the word "cockroach", is different from other movements in post-Independent India. Whether it was the JP movement in 1973-74 for "total revolution", or the Assam movement in the early 1980s against illegal immigrants from Bangladesh, or the Anna Hazare movement in 2011 for the Lokpal and public accountability – they had a clear leadership that helmed a popular struggle and, in each case, led to the formation of a political party which eventually came to power. The CJP is an online phenomenon in this social media age, trying now to become an offline outfit, which may be a formidable task.

The recent CJP protests have touched not just those appearing for the NEET or JEE-IIT exams, who would number only a few thousands. The Jantar Mantar stir represented the voice of many more – of all those who feel left out of the system.

An enquiry will reveal more about the lathi-charge against the protesting students during their march to Parliament, and the stone-throwing incidents. But the use of batons and tear gas against the protesting youngsters has taken their cause – and alleged police brutality against them – into every middle class home, with many parents asking,"What if my daughter had been there?"

Wangchuk factor

There were two turning points in the CJP's current month-long agitation at Jantar Mantar. Wangchuk's bid to join it on June 28, and go on an indefinite hunger strike, gave the movement a gravitas. Till then Dipke's attempts to gain traction on the ground received a tepid response in different cities, considering that 22 million people had become the CJP's online followers within a week after its launch.

To begin with, Wangchuk's fast did not draw huge crowds. It was only after plainclothes policemen whisked away the fasting leader behind white sheets to Safdarjung Hospital on July 18 (21st day of his fast) that the protest venue began to see an upsurge, with thousands of youths thronging there, to participate in the July 20 march.

The importance of Wangchuk lay not just in his effort to inject a new energy into a stagnant political situation, opting for hunger strike at a time when brute power, not moral force, gets a response. But it struck a chord with the youths when he was forcibly removed from the site.

The educationist-environmentalist from Ladakh showed that the peripheries of India could speak to the heart of India – which is as it should be in a democracy. He sat on a fast in the national capital, and inflicted discomfort on himself instead of abusing his opponents – and demanded an overhaul of the country's education system, giving voice to the concerns of millions of youths.

Govt play, Cong push

The government may have tried to shift the headlines from the CJP protest and the police lathi-charge by allowing the Congress leaders' dharna outside the high-security PM's residence, an unusual decision. It may have succeeded for now.

While individual Congress leaders like Pawan Khera finally went to Jantar Mantar to express their solidarity with the protesters, Rahul did not visit them. Rahul himself has been leading a youth outreach programme, called "Chhatron ki goonj". Perhaps the government may not want the CJP to run away with youth support.

In the long run, however, it is the Congress as the main Opposition force, which is likely to gain if discontent against the ruling dispensation grows. Much will, of course, depend on the damage control the government is able to undertake. The government is now reaching out to the protesters, but the key question is, will that be enough, or its resolution will require sustained dialogues with the CJP, Wangchuk, mainstream parties, and experts over the long-pending reforms in our education system.

Another question remains as to why the government did not connect with the protesters in time. Sending an emissary to Jantar Mantar to engage with Wangchuk and Dipke earlier might have defused the situation.

There is a view in the government that a "strong" government should not act under "pressure", or it would get pushed around. Many cite what happened during the previous Congress-led UPA regime to make the point – the resignation of the then Maharashtra chief minister Ashok Chavan had a domino effect with the resignations of half a dozen other senior functionaries, at the state and central levels, following in its wake, with the Opposition having tasted blood.

A government must have the ability, if required, to be tough to rule a large country. But should a government, which is expected to be responsive, hold out when the country's youths are signalling that they are "hurting" and that a solution must be found by addressing their concerns. After all, there may just be a fine line between toughness and arrogance in the final analysis.

(Neerja Chowdhury, Contributing Editor, The Indian Express, has covered the last 11 Lok Sabha elections. She is the author of 'How Prime Ministers Decide'.)

बिहार सरकार | बिहार राज्य खेल प्राधिकरण BSSA BIHAR STATE SPORTS AUTHORITY

खेल विभाग

विकसित भारत - समृद्ध बिहार

श्री सम्राट चौधरी

माननीय मुख्यमंत्री, बिहार

के कर कमलों द्वारा

बिहार के उत्कृष्ट खिलाड़ियों को 'मेडल लाओ, नौकरी पाओ' योजना के तहत नियुक्ति-पत्र एवं खेल छात्रवृत्ति हेतु चयन-पत्र

का

वितरण समारोह

विशिष्ट अतिथि

श्री विजय कुमार चौधरी
माननीय उपमुख्यमंत्री, बिहार

श्री बिजेन्द्र प्रसाद यादव
माननीय उपमुख्यमंत्री, बिहार

अध्यक्षता

सुश्री श्रेयसी सिंह
माननीया मंत्री, खेल विभाग, बिहार

स्थान : ऊर्जा ऑडिटोरियम, पटना दिनांक: 24 जुलाई, 2026 समय: 12:30 बजे अपराह्न

PR.NO-008642(SPORTS)D.2026-27

'Peaceful protest is a Constitutional right': 140 Bombay HC lawyers condemn police action

Omkar Gokhale
Mumbai, July 23

A GROUP of over 140 lawyers practising before the Bombay High Court, including senior advocates, on Wednesday issued a statement deprecating the prohibitory orders passed by the Mumbai Police restricting movement and unlawful assembly of five or more persons in view of the recent protests.

The lawyers sought that the Mumbai Police Commissioner withdraw the prohibitory orders, the subsequent actions by police "to curtail lawful protests by citizens" and refrain from pursuing further action against peaceful protests.

The statement issued on July 21 claimed that no such prohibition can remain in force for more than 15 days without the state government's sanction and that consecutive prohibitory orders (July 7 to 21 and July 23 to August 6), with only a respite of 24 hours, appear intended "to circumvent the requirement of State government sanction".

It further said "mass detention and arrests by the Mumbai police are also concerning" in the context of the recent prohibitory orders issued under the Maharashtra Police Act, 1951. The lawyers said constitutional courts have repeatedly held that restrictions on the right to peaceful assembly must record the facts and reasons warranting such curbs and demonstrate that they are the least restrictive measure.

Signed by at least 141 lawyers, including senior advocates Janak Dwarkadas, Navroz Seervai, Gayatri Singh, Mihir Desai, Dinyar Madon, along with advocate Yug Mohit Chaudhry, the statement said the prohibitory orders "appear to fail to comply with the requirements under law", lack accountability and create "difficulties in immediately obtaining legal redress".

"It ought not to fall on citizens to seek recourse to already overburdened courts," it said.

Senior advocate Dwarkadas said there was no response to lawyers' statements urging the police authorities. "We have only made an appeal to the Mumbai CP to withdraw the ban, which appears to be without any justification. It is a clear indication that they don't want people to assemble and protest, which is nothing but un-democratic. The right to protest is part of our rights," he told The Indian Express.

In a resolution issued Wednesday night, the Bombay Bar Association stated that in a constitutional democracy, "the right of citizens to assemble peacefully and to express dissent is an integral facet of the freedoms guaranteed under Article 19 of the Constitution of India". Expressing "grave concern" over reports of students being subjected to lathicharge and tear gas by the police, it said the use of force against students is "deeply disturbing".

'Not CJP or BJP, it's about student rights': Protests rage nationwide; many detained

Express News Service
Mumbai, Guwahati, Patna, Chandigarh, July 23

FROM SMALLER, decentralised gatherings across Mumbai to marches in various districts of Bihar, and from hunger strike at a Haryana university to agitations in Tamil Nadu demanding complete abolition of NEET — Protests by students over paper leaks and in protest against Monday's police action on protesters in New Delhi continued in different parts of the country on Thursday.

In Mumbai, police detained over 150 protesters and registered two FIRs for violating prohibitory orders, taking the total number of cases linked to the agitation to 17. While the large gatherings at Shivaji Park held earlier this week were absent on Thursday, demonstrations were organised at several locations including Mankhurd, Darukhana and Mumbai University's Kalina campus. "Wherever demonstrations began, participants were detained by police," said a member of Mumbai Against Suppression of Students (MASS), a collective coordinating a number of protests.

In Bihar, thousands of protesters in Katihar, Darbhanga and Begusarai marched against alleged irregularities in competitive exams. The protests escalated into stone pelting in Katihar, and police using "mild lathicharge" in Begusarai to push back protesters. Several policemen were wounded in Darbhanga clashes. "The situation has been brought under control. Four to five persons have been detained," Darbhanga DM Kaushal Kumar told reporters.

A protest in Nagpur on Thursday. DHANANJAY KHEDKAR

Meanwhile, hundreds gathered in Guwahati in solidarity with the protests unfolding at Delhi's Jantar Mantar and demanded the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. Among the protesters was 22-year-old Balo Yama from Arunachal Pradesh, who is studying in Guwahati. "Everyone wants justice. My cousin gave the NEET this year, and I saw how difficult it is for students to deal with something like a paper leak... This is not about CJP or BJP. It's about students' rights," she said.

In Haryana, students of Kurukshetra University and Chaudhary Ranbir Singh University in Jind took out marches and raised slogans against the Central government. In Jind, lawyers observed a work suspension on the call of the Jind Bar Association while the Hisar Bar Association called upon advocates to abstain from court proceedings Friday. The lawyers alleged students were subjected to excessive force during the police action in Delhi Monday and claimed that female students were also manhandled.

In Tamil Nadu, agitations demanding the complete abolition of NEET intensified across the state with student outfits and political activists staging coordinated demonstrations in Chennai, Madurai and Erode. Members of the SFI and DYFI blocked a railway track in Madurai. Police sources said protesters blocked a train after it arrived at Thiruparankundram, leading to a tense scuffle and physical pushing and shoving between police and the student demonstrators on the tracks.

Leading Tamil filmmakers Pa Ranjith, Vetrimaaran and Ameer led a major anti-NEET demonstration in Egmore. In Kerala, SFI held protests in Thiruvananthapuram, Palakkad, Kozhikode, Kottayam, Kochi, Thrissur and Kasaragod, among others, and faced rounds of water cannons used by the police to disperse them, according to visuals on TV channels.

WITH PTI INPUTS, CHENNAI & THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

MM Joshi: Painful to see young girls being mishandled

New Delhi: Veteran BJP leader Murli Manohar Joshi on Thursday came out in support of the students protesting against the alleged NEET paper leak, saying their "anxieties and concerns" regarding the examination system were "genuine".

Joshi criticised the police crackdown on protesting students Monday, calling it "merciless". "It is very painful to see that even young girls were brutally mishandled." He said such use of force shall alienate large sections of Indian society from the national goal of Viksit Bharat.

"It is painful to see young students from different parts of the country assembled for days on the streets of New Delhi. Their anxieties and concerns regarding the examination system are genuine and must be handled with empathy and a desire to find a lasting solution," the former Union minister wrote on X. PTI

No evidence to show Mukhiya role in 2024 NEET leak: CBI

Express News Service
Patna, July 23

Sanjeev Mukhiya was arrested in April 2025 in a midnight operation in Patna. EXPRESS FILE

THE CBI has clarified why it gave a clean chit to Sanjeev Kumar alias Sanjeev Mukhiya in connection with the 2024 NEET-UG paper leak case, saying that exhaustive investigations yielded no evidence linking him to the theft or distribution of the paper.

Mukhiya was arrested in April last year in a midnight operation in Patna, which ended an 11-month manhunt for the 51-year-old Nalanda resident who carried a Rs 3 lakh bounty and faced charges in at least four examination scams across multiple states.

The alleged scam had unravelled on May 5, 2024, when Patna police detected irregularities during the NEET-UG exam. On June 23, 2024, the case was transferred to the CBI.

The CBI, in a statement on Thursday, explained why it had not filed a chargesheet against Mukhiya. "In 2024, Bihar Police had detected the theft of the question paper of the NEET (UG) 2024 examination and registered a case in this regard. Prima facie suspicion had emerged at that stage that one Sanjeev Kumar alias Sanjeev Mukhiya may have been involved in the theft, as he was found to have been involved in certain other examination paper theft/leak cases. He was accordingly named as an accused in the said FIR by Bihar Police. The case was subsequently transferred to the CBI," it said.

"During the course of its investigation, CBI identified each and every person involved in the theft and onward distribution of the stolen NEET (UG) 2024 question paper, as also each and every candidate who benefited from use of the stolen paper. Multiple chargesheets have been filed by CBI against 45 persons before the jurisdictional court in Patna," it said.

"In the course of its investigation, CBI did not come across any evidence to establish the involvement of Mukhiya in the theft or distribution of the stolen NEET (UG) 2024 question paper....CBI did not file any chargesheet against him in this case, and he has accordingly availed bail in the NEET-UG case. Mukhiya remained in judicial custody after his bail in the CBI case, being an accused in certain other cases being investigated by Bihar police," it said.

"CBI has conducted a detailed investigation into the NEET (UG) 2024 theft case, identified all the persons involved, and ensured that none of them has escaped the process of law," it said. "This issue was clarified in the year 2024 itself adequately. The narrative going around now about his deliberate omission is factually incorrect."

In April last year, a joint team of personnel from the Special Operations Group (SOG) of Bihar's Economic Offences Unit (EOU) and Patna's Special Task Force had conducted the raid that led to Mukhiya's arrest.

Mukhiya, a former technical assistant at Udyan Vidyalaya in Nalanda's Noorsarai, had allegedly orchestrated what the EOU had called an "organised and professional" interstate solver gang. "He exploited every layer of the examination system," said a senior officer.

EXPRESS special

Rajasthan paves the way for political workers to join police's community liaisoning groups

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, July 23

THE BJP government in Rajasthan has decided to allow people from political parties to be enlisted as members of the Community Liaisoning Group (CLG), which plays a crucial role in intelligence gathering and maintaining public order.

So far, as per the Rajasthan Police Rules, 2008, a person couldn't be part of a CLG "if he is a member of a political party or its affiliate". However, the state home department has amended the Rules, through a July 19 notification, and deleted the relevant clause entirely. Maneesh Goyal, joint secretary (home), who issued the notification, could not be reached for a comment. CLGs are a crucial part of maintaining law and order, assisting police in gathering intelligence, tracking criminals, and preventing crimes.

Congress spokesperson Swarnim Chaturvedi condemned the move, alleging that the government is "seating their political workers from the BJP and the RSS in all the institutions". "And that is why the institutions have been collapsing one after the other," he said, adding that CLG members "defuse and resolve any social unrest.

As per govt data, there are 75,265 such members spread across the state

People trust them and listen to them. But if they impose political workers, then how will there be any trust between people". He said that the Congress will raise the issue at an appropriate level in the days to come.

As per government data, there are 75,265 CLG members spread across Rajasthan's Ajmer Range (21,186), Bharatpur Range (3,313), Bikaner Range (10,301), GRP Range (931), Jaipur Commissionerate (4,722), Jaipur Range (7,105), Jodhpur Commissionerate (793), Jodhpur Range (6,245), Kota Range (6,760) and Udaipur Range (13,909). These include CLG members at the police station, beat, panchayat and ward levels. Other conditions which still render a person ineligible for CLG include conviction by any court; registration of a criminal case or under trial; if he is suspected to be involved in any criminal activity or has association with criminals; and if he is involved in property and land disputes and other litigation.

The rules state that CLG members are appointed by the District Superintendent of Police on the recommendations of the Officer In-charge of the Police Station and the Circle Officer concerned. While there is no specific criterion for their eligibility, the rules say that only local residents of a panchayat or a police station jurisdiction can be inducted as CLG members, and that the person "should be a respectable citizen, and should bear a good moral character".

Additionally, CLGs should "have fair representation of all classes and all walks of life" with at least two representatives each from women and Scheduled Castes/Scheduled Tribes. The panchayat-level CLGs shall consist of five members while police station-level CLGs shall consist of 30 members. And of these, a third should be retired at the end of each calendar year.

Officially, their roles include assisting police in improving police-community relationships; bringing police related problems faced by people and assisting in finding solutions; helping police in apprehending offenders and in crime prevention measures; and providing assistance to police in the collection of criminal intelligence; among others. These are not paid positions.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Car 'Pool'

Vehicles partially submerged after incessant rain in Gujarat's Vapi on Thursday. Nearly 1,200 stranded people were rescued, and over 22,000 residents relocated to safer places as heavy showers battered a large part of the state. Colleges and schools will remain shut in all the affected districts on Friday. PTI

Teen 'dies by suicide' over viral café video

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, July 23

THE DEATH of a 17-year-old girl, who was found hanging at her home in Bareilly district of Uttar Pradesh on Wednesday, has led to an FIR against eight persons, including three minor boys of a different community, on charges of abetment of suicide and gangrape. No one has been arrested so far.

The teen girl allegedly died by suicide, a day after a video showing her with two teenage boys from her neighbourhood at a café went viral on social media.

8 persons, including three minor boys, booked on charges of abetment of suicide and gangrape: Police

Police said that when the girl was at a café with two boys from the Muslim community, three men arrived and allegedly filmed the group and circulated the video online. The trio is alleged to be associated with Hindu organisations.

"She was found dead the next morning. The post-mortem report concluded that she died by hanging," a police officer said, adding that no suicide note was found. The 32-year-old brother of the girl alleged that she was gangraped by three minor boys. Police have registered an FIR against them for gangrape and suicide abetment. The FIR also named three men, who allegedly shot her video.

2 exam papers cancelled in Uttarakhand varsity; paper-setter held for leak

Aiswarya Raj
Dehradun, July 23

THE UTTARAKHAND Technical University has cancelled two exams for the current semester after one of the papers was allegedly leaked by an external paper setter. Police said that the paper setter was also arrested on Thursday evening.

According to the order cancelling the exams, which will affect students of 12 institutes affiliated with Veer Madho Singh Bhandari Uttarakhand Technical University, Dehradun, the Controller of Examinations, Dr V K Patel, said that the university received a complaint regarding the Machine Learning for Internet of Things exam.

After multiple committee inquiries by the university and the institution, which reported the leak, it was found that the external paper setter for the subject had allegedly shared questions identical to those appearing in the exam with students through the institution's internal portal/WhatsApp before the exam. The inquiry revealed that another question paper prepared by the same faculty member, Electromagnetic Field Theory, was also suspected to have been leaked.

"The cancelled exams for both subjects will be re-conducted during the third week of August 2026... All institutions are requested to immediately inform the students concerned about this important decision so that they can adequately prepare for the re-examinations within the stipulated time... The paper-setter has also been "debarred with immediate effect from all exam-related work of the University for the next seven years", the order said.

Vijay's *Jana Nayagan* a celebration, not just blockbuster

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, July 23

TAMIL SUPERSTAR films have never really been about plots. They are carefully orchestrated public festivals where cinema merely provides the excuse. The screenplay is often only the rope holding together fireworks, punchy dialogues, songs, nostalgia and collective emotion.

Jana Nayagan understands that better than most. The audience inside a packed Chennai theatre Friday morning, the first day-first show (FDFS), was not simply watching Vijay's final film. They were watching their CM dance, lecture, campaign, comfort grieving families, attack corruption, defend secularism and eventually walk into a fictional Secretariat — while several members of his real Cabinet quietly appeared alongside him.

That alone makes *Jana Nayagan* unlike anything Indian cinema has seen. The story itself races through jails, civil wars in fictional Swasnia in Africa, international arms syndicates, terrorism, communal violence, corrupt politicians and psychological trauma. It is gloriously overstuffed.

Yet nobody inside the theatre seemed worried about where the story was heading. They were waiting for the next arrival. The next "blast", as Vijay's character himself says in it. The first cheer erupted before Vijay even appeared. His character's name flashed on screen: "*Thalapathy Vetri Kondan*." The theatre shook. The opening establishes Vijay as something softer than the invincible action hero Tamil cinema often celebrates. He fulfils his dying mother's last wish inside prison. He comforts a traumatised child, a daughter of his prison officer, before release.

Fans celebrate *Jana Nayagan*'s release, in Chennai on Thursday. PTI

He becomes the affectionate uncle, or Sithappa, who quietly shapes a frightened girl's life after her father dies.

That girl, played by Mamitha Baiju, begins the film paralysed by panic attacks after witnessing horrific violence. Vijay refuses to let fear define her. He repeatedly insists that women should not merely be protected but should grow "like tigers".

By the climax, Mamitha is no longer the frightened child. She owns one of the film's fiercest combat sequences herself. It is less a rescue story than an argument that courage can be taught. One of the cleverest political jokes arrives with something as ordinary as a roadside peanut plant. A convoy stops. An aide casually uproots a peanut plant for the senior politician. The senior politician asks him to plant it back after taking peanuts. The puzzled aide asks why.

The answer comes almost philosophically. Nobody will notice if a few peanuts disappear, but if the plant is not planted back, people will notice. The aide laughs. "If you have such brilliant ideas for corruption, why haven't you become Chief Minister for ten years?" The politician smiles. "People aren't revolutionary enough to elect us."

That is no ordinary farewell film. It is politics, cinema, governance and fan culture briefly sharing the same frame — projected not merely on a screen, but onto the political imagination of Tamil Nadu.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

SC orders FIR, SIT investigation into 'custodial death' of Ahmedabad man

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 23

THE SUPREME Court on Thursday directed registration of an FIR in connection with the death of a man, who was arrested on cow slaughter charges, allegedly in Gujarat police custody.

A three-judge bench presided over by CJI Surya Kant also ordered that an SIT comprising police officers in the rank of DCP, along with two more officers, be nominated by the Gujarat DGP to conduct the probe into the death of Zahiruddin Shaikh.

The bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, directed that the FIR be registered initially without naming anyone and a final report be submitted before the jurisdictional magistrate, preferably in three months. It said that the petitioner, if dissatisfied with the outcome of the investigation, shall be at liberty to file a protest petition and seek further probe.

The court was hearing an appeal by Tofik Shaikh, who is the son of the deceased, challenging the HC order which denied immediate registration of FIR, while leaving open to the petitioner to pursue other remedies under the BNSS, 2023. As per the petitioner, Zahiruddin was arrested on May 18, and a day later, he was taken for treatment to Sola Civil Hospital, but due to the unavailability of ICU beds, he was referred to another hospital. He was then shifted to Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel Institute of Medical Sciences and Research, where he died on May 20.

Appearing for the petitioner, Senior Advocate I H Syed said there is a dying declaration recorded on video and medical reports pointed to him consuming 100 diabetes tablets in police custody, and this could be the reason for death. Additional Solicitor General S V Raju, appearing for the state, said the claim about the pills isn't confirmed as the viscera report is yet to come.

The post-mortem was done by a panel of five doctors under videography, and no external or internal injury was found. About an injury in the chest region, Raju said that the report says it was due to Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation attempted by doctors to save his life. The ASG added that a magisterial inquiry is underway. The bench, however, said that when there are claims about unnatural death, a preliminary inquiry is welcome. "He is the son. Let his conscience be satisfied," the court said.

DRDO flight test of 'Kusha' takes off

Rajnath hails test, says it will eliminate import dependency for such SAM systems

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, July 23

IN A MAJOR step towards the development of indigenous long-range air defence capabilities, the Defence Research & Development Organisation (DRDO) Thursday successfully conducted the first flight test of the 'Kusha' Long-Range Surface-to-Air Missile (SAM), at the APJ Abdul Kalam Island off the coast of Odisha.

A long-range SAM typically has a range of over 200 km. India operates Russian S-400 Triumf, which is understood to be capable of hitting targets up to 400 km away.

In a statement, the Ministry of Defence said that this maiden test was conducted against an electronic target simulating a high-speed, high-altitude aerial threat, which the missile system successfully intercepted.

The DRDO has been developing Project Kusha — an indigenous long-range SAM system — to protect strategic military and civilian assets and infrastructure from a range of aerial threats, including fighter jets, missiles, unmanned aerial vehicles and large enemy aircraft within a wide range and altitude envelope.

All weapon system elements, including the missiles, radars, command and control centre, have been developed by various DRDO laboratories and industry partners.

Calling the test's success an important milestone in Indian defence R&D, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh said that it will also eliminate India's import dependency for such systems.

Last year, the DRDO successfully conducted maiden flight tests of the Integrated Air Defence Weapon System (IADWS) — a multi-layered air defence system comprising all indigenous Quick Reaction Surface to Air Missiles (QRSAM), Advanced Very Short Range Air Defence System (VSHORADS) missiles, and a high-power laser-based Directed Energy Weapon (DEW).

Together, Kusha and the IADWS are understood to be major steps towards bringing India closer towards developing a home-grown nationwide security shield from multi-domain enemy attacks under Mission Sudarshan Chakra in the next 10 years.

Defence Secretary and Secretary, Department of Defence R&D, and Chairman, DRDO, Rajesh Kumar Singh, monitored the launch and congratulated the team members, the statement noted.

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1
DRDO conducted the maiden flight test of Long-Range SAM 'Kusha' from the APJ Abdul Kalam Island off the coast of Odisha. PTI

Real Creator IAS Edition https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F

Clear encroachments along Ganga in Patna in 6 weeks, Supreme Court tells Bihar govt

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 23

CLAMPING DOWN on encroachments along the banks of the Ganga in Bihar, the Supreme Court has given the state government six weeks to remove all unauthorised structures between Nauzar Ghat and Nurpur Ghat in Patna.

A bench of Justices J B Pardiwala and K V Viswanathan noted in its july 21 order that "no steps have been taken to remove the encroachments" despite the court's earlier orders.

The court sought a compliance report "by a competent authority by the next date of hearing" and warned that "any laxity in this regard will be viewed strictly".

The court was hearing an appeal filed by one Ashok Kumar Sinha, through Advocate Akash Vashishtha, challenging the June 20, 2020 judgment of the National Green Tribunal dismissing his plea for action against the encroachments along the stretch of the river. Vashishtha highlighted that in 2023, 213 encroachments were identified on the stretch between Digha Ghat and Nauzar Ghat, of which only The court is likely to hear it next on September 23, 2026.

TATA POWER RENEWABLE ENERGY

Tata Power Renewable Energy Limited
Corporate Centre, A Block, 34 Sant Tukaram Road, Carnac Bunder, Mumbai-400009
CIN :U40108MH2007PLC168314
Tel: (91 22) 67171000 e-mail: tprel@tatapower.com Website www.tatapower.com/renewables

EXTRACT OF STANDALONE FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30TH JUNE, 2026

₹ crore

Sr. No.	Standalone	Quarter ended			Year ended
		30-Jun-26 (Unaudited)	31-Mar-26 (Audited)	30-Jun-25 (Unaudited)	31-Mar-26 (Audited)
a.	Total Income from Operations	2,709.94	2,898.63	3,252.07	11,748.38
b.	Profit / (Loss) Before Exceptional items and tax	396.63	278.26	596.96	1,706.05
c.	Profit / (Loss) Before Tax	396.63	278.26	596.96	1,706.05
d.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period / year	294.70	208.64	442.94	1,268.07
e.	Total Comprehensive Income	212.59	410.59	414.65	1,487.46
f.	Paid-up Equity Share Capital (Face Value: ₹ 10/- per share)	1,463.10	1,463.10	1,463.10	1,463.10
g.	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	14,063.05	13,850.46	12,777.65	13,850.46
h.	Securities Premium Account	8,742.01	8,742.01	8,742.01	8,742.01
i.	Net worth	15,787.74	15,493.05	14,675.56	15,493.05
j.	Capital Redemption Reserve	11.25	11.25	11.25	11.25
k.	Debenture Redemption Reserve	99.05	99.05	99.05	99.05
l.	Outstanding Debt	24,758.46	22,745.95	20,440.93	22,745.95
m.	Earnings Per Equity Share (of ₹ 10/- each) (In ₹)				
	(i) Basic Earning Per Share- (In ₹)*	2.01	1.43	3.03	8.67
	(ii) Diluted Earning Per Share- (In ₹)*	2.01	1.43	3.03	8.67
n.	Debt Equity Ratio (in times)	1.59	1.49	1.44	1.49
o.	Debt Service Coverage Ratio (in times)*	2.33	1.46	1.83	1.63
p.	Interest Service Coverage Ratio (in times)*	1.83	1.66	2.44	2.01
q.	Current Ratio (in times)	1.16	1.07	0.90	1.07
r.	Long Term Debt to Working Capital (in times)	9.94	10.35	13.18	10.35
s.	Current Liability ratio (in times)	0.19	0.22	0.28	0.22
t.	Total Debts to Total Assets (in times)	0.52	0.50	0.49	0.50
u.	Debtors' Turnover ratio (in number of days)*	105	104	103	103
v.	Inventory Turnover ratio (in number of days)*	47	37	37	37
w.	Bad debts to Accounts Receivable Ratio (%)*	0.25%	0.14%	0.46%	0.52%
x.	Operating Margin (%)	19.61%	13.41%	21.91%	19.24%
y.	Net Profit Margin (%) including exceptional item	10.87%	7.20%	13.62%	10.79%

Notes:
1. The above financial results of Tata Power Renewable Energy Limited were reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at its meeting held on 22nd July, 2026.
2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Unaudited Standalone Financial Results for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 filed with the Stock Exchange under Regulation 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the said Financial Results is available on the Stock Exchange's website www.nseindia.com and on the Company's website www.tatapower.com/renewables
3. For other line items referred in Regulation 52(4) of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, pertinent disclosures have been made to the National Stock Exchange of India Limited and can be accessed on URL www.nseindia.com.

* In case of quarterly numbers, ratios have not been annualised.

For and on behalf of the Board of
TATA POWER RENEWABLE ENERGY LIMITED
Sanjay Banga
Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director
DIN 07785948

Place : Mumbai
Date : 22nd July, 2026

Urban development ministry split, Delhi gets own department

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 23

THE GOVERNMENT on Thursday bifurcated the Union Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, creating the Department of Capital Development to focus on Delhi and the Department of Urban Development for national schemes.

The Cabinet Secretariat published the gazette notification of the amendment to the Government of India (Allocation of Business) Rules, 1961, creating the two new departments.

Till now, the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs did not have separate departments.

Late on Thursday night, the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet appointed Gujarat cadre IAS officer D Thara, who had been Additional Secretary in MoHUA, as the Secretary of the Department of Capital Development and Jharkhand cadre IAS officer Satendra Singh, who was Additional Secretary in the Cabinet Secretariat, as Secretary of the Department of Urban Development.

Incidentally, Singh, in his capacity as Additional Secretary in the Cabinet Secretariat, signed the gazette notification creating the two departments earlier in the day.

The Department of Capital Development will look after Union government properties, Central Public Works Department, Delhi Development Authority, allotment of government land in Delhi, Delhi Metro Rail Corporation and the National Capital Region Transport Corporation, among the 25 subjects allotted to it.

On the other hand, the Department of Urban Development will look after all national schemes, including Swachh Bharat Mission, Urban Challenge Fund, PMSvanidhi and AMRUT.

The department will also oversee "climate and climate adaptation". While creating two new departments, the amendment also removed one subject that had been allotted to the Ministry — "stationery and printing for the Government of India including official publications", which was given to the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting.

The Indian Express had reported in May that the government was considering creating two separate departments, including one for Delhi, to be headed by separate secretaries.

2 held for raping women thrown out by kin over marriages outside caste

Jayprakash S Naidu
Raipur, July 23

TWO TRIBAL community leaders have been arrested in Chhattisgarh's Korea district on charges of raping a 25-year-old and a 17-year-old.

The two women were in relationships against their family's wishes, and had allegedly been left by their families with the two men — Daroga Singh, 75, and his brother-in-law Ramesh Tekam, 56. The 25-year-old tribal woman has told the police that she had got married to a man from another caste in April. A police official said, "The duo allegedly gangraped her on July 4." The official said that it was she who informed them that a 17-year-old girl, who had eloped with a man from another caste, was being forcibly kept by the two men.

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SHO P/S Nagrota, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Satar Din S/O Alaf Din R/O Batote, District Ramban is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 188/2017 U/S 188 RPC, 3/5 PCA Act of P/S Nagrota, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments/Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts/present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact /Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name :- Satar Din
S/O :- Alaf Din
Address:- Batote, District Ramban
Age:- 36 years
Height:- 5'6''
Complexion:- Wheatish
Eyes:- Black
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1. DPO, Jammu:- 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D:- sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu:- 0191-2605949
4. SP Rural Jammu:- 0191-2605949
5. SDPO Nagrota:- 0191-2673666, **6. SHO P/S Nagrota:-** 0191-2673025

For Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu
DIP/J-6413/26- DATE 23 JULY 2026 **Date:- .07.2026**

REQUIRES VICE PRINCIPAL (TERM BASED) FOR
ARMY PUBLIC SCHOOL, AHILYANAGAR (CBSE Affiliated)
PRIVATE UNAIDED SCHOOL

Army Public School Located at	Upto Class	Application be forwarded to
Army Public Schoool, C/o AC Centre and School, Ahilyanagar	XII (Senior Secondary School	Principal, Army Public School, C/o AC Centre and School, Jamkhed Road, Ahilyanagar - 414002.

1. Qualification :-
(a) Regular Masters Degree with 50 % aggregate marks in CBSE teaching subjects (preferably being taught in Army Public Schools) from a recognized University / Institution.
(b) Regular Bachelor of Education with 50% aggregrate marks from UGC/NCTE recognized University/Institution.
(c) Adequate working knowledge of computers/MS Office/MS PowerPoint.
2. Additional Desired Qualification: Ph D, M.Ed and minimum 3 year administrative experience in a recogninized CBSE school.
3. Experience : 6 years regular service as a PGT in any teaching subject in a recognized CBSE school OR 10 years combined service as PGT/TGT in any teaching subject in a recognized CBSE school with min 3 years as a PGT in a recognized CBSE school.
4. Age as on 01 Apr 2026: Min 35 years and max 45 years as on last date of submission of application. Upper age limit for regular employees of Army Public Schools and ESM will be 55 yrs.
5. Pay & allowance : As per AWES guidelines.
6. Selection Process : Through written & panel interviews (only candidates short listed, based on qualification, experience & other criteria as may be considered by the board, will be called for the interview.
7. How to apply : Application with detailed Bio-data, copies of certificates and mark sheets should be addressed to the Principal, Army Public School Ahilyanagar, C/o AC Centre and School, Ahilyanagar – 414002 in a sealed envelope marked as **'Application form for the post of Vice-Principal, APS Ahilyanagar"** and reach by post/by hand latest by **05th August 2026.** Forms are available on the schools website www.apsahmednagar.com.
8. Applications submitted through email will not be accepted. Only hard copies of applications submitted by hand or by post will be considered. The school will not be responsible for any postal delay, and applications received after the last date of submission will be rejected.
Note : Online payment of Rs 250/- towards registration fee is required to be paid and receipt of the same to be attached with the application form. No TA/DA is admissible.

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SHO P/S Nagrota, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Anayat Ali S/O Bashir Ahmed R/O Dhayanpur Tanda Bari Brahmana, Tehsil and District Samba is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 264/2015 U/S 279/188/427/429 RPC, 3/5 PC Act of P/S Nagrota, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name : Anayat Ali
S/O : Bashir Ahmed
Address : Dhayanpur Tanda Bari Brahmana, Tehsil and District Samba
Age : 35 years
Height : 5'6''
Complexion : Wheatish
Eyes : Brown
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1. DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949
4. SP Rural Jammu : 0191-2605949
5. SDPO Nagrota : 0191-2673666
6. SHO P/S Nagrota : 0191-2673025

Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu
No. **Date:- .07.2026**
DIP/J-6448/26 – DATE 23 JULY 2026

India Tourism Development Corporation Ltd.
(A Government of India Undertaking)
Registered Office: SCOPE Complex, Core-8, 6th Floor, 7 Lodhi Road, New Delhi- 110003
Email: vkjain@itdc.co.in, Website: www.itdc.co.in, CIN: L74899DL1965GOI004363

NOTICE
Transfer of Equity Shares of the Company to Investor Education and Protection Fund

Notice is hereby given that pursuant to the provisions of Section 124 of the Companies Act, 2013 and the Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (Accounting, Audit, Transfer and Refund) Rules, 2016, as amended ("the Rules"), the equity shares of the Company in respect of which dividend has not been paid or claimed by the shareholders for seven (7) consecutive years or more are required to be transferred by the Company to the demat account of the Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority ("the Authority").

In accordance with the Rules, the Company has sent individual notices to all the shareholders (07 shareholders) whose shares are liable to be transferred to the IEPF Authority. The Company has uploaded complete details of such shareholders including folio number or DP ID & Client ID and number of equity shares due for transfer to the Authority on its website **www.itdc.co.in** under Investor's section. Shareholders are requested to refer to the said website to verify the details of unpaid/unclaimed dividend and the shares liable to be transferred to the Authority.

Shareholders are requested to forward the requisite documents, as per the above mentioned notice to the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent (RTA), to claim the unclaimed dividend amount. In case the Company does not receive any communication from the shareholders by **24th October, 2026,** the Company shall with a view to comply with the requirement as set out in the Rules, transfer such shares to the IEPF Authority without any further notice. Further all subsequent dividends declared and paid by the Company are liable to be transferred to the IEPF account as per the Rules. Please note that no claim shall lie against the Company in respect of the shares transferred to the Authority including all benefits accruing on such shares, if any, can be claimed by the concerned shareholder from the Authority after following the procedure prescribed in the Rules.

In case of any queries in respect of the above matter, the shareholder may contact the Registrar and Share Transfer Agent of the Company, M/s KFin Technologies Limited, Selenium Building, Tower-B, Plot No. 31 & 32, Financial District, Nanakramguda, Serilingampally, Hyderabad, Telangana, India – 500 032 Tel.: 040 -6716 1545 Email: **sankara.gokavarapu@kfintech.com.**

For India Tourism Development Corporation Limited
Sd/-
(V K Jain)
Company Secretary

Place : New Delhi
Date : 24.07.2026

itdc.co.in

EXPRESS Careers

JOB OPENING
ABHIJEET FERROTECH LIMITED
a leading Ferro Alloys manufacturing company, is inviting applications for the following position at its **Atchutapuram Plant. Immediate Requirement/ Interview Mode: Online from 25.07.2026 / Food & Accommodation will be provided.**

- **FURNACE FITTERS - 20 No's**
- **FURNACE WELDER (ARC) - 21 No's**
- **MECHANICAL HELPER - 50 No's**
- **COPPER WELDER - 2 No's**
- **MECHANICAL FURNACE ENGINEER - 3 No's**
- **FURNACE ENGINEER - 3 No's**
- **EOT CRANE OPERATOR - 9 No's**
- **FORKLIFT OPERATOR - 8 No's**
- **GCP IN-CHARGE - 1 No's**

Contact: **8977044125, 9490347946**
E-Mail ID: ir@sarojiniepc.com / hrsepc.rrltpl@gmail.com

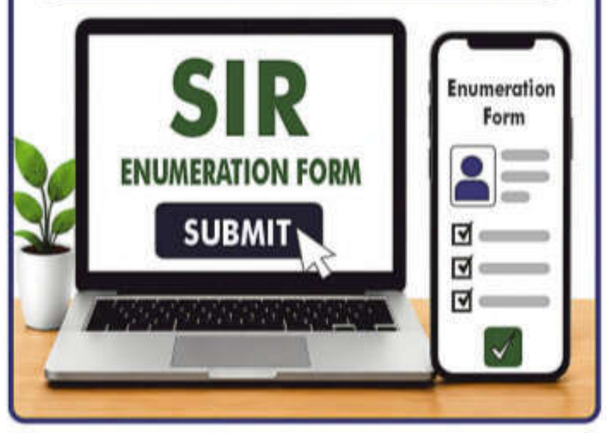
भारत निर्वाचन आयोग
Election Commission of India

SIR 2026
(विशेष गहन पुनरीक्षण)
हरियाणा

CHIEF ELECTORAL OFFICER, HARYANA

मजबूत मतदाता सूची, मजबूत लोकतंत्र

अपना Enumeration Form आज ही भरे
ताकि आपका नाम मतदाता सूची प्रारम्भिक (2026) में शामिल हो सके।



Enumeration Form जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि
24/07/2026

भाग क्यों लें ?
- अपना नाम मतदाता सूची में सुनिश्चित करें
- लोकतंत्र को मजबूत बनाएं
- अपना वोट भविष्य को आकार देता है

ऑनलाइन फॉर्म जमा करें
वेबसाइट पर जाएं https://voters.eci.gov.in
या QR Code स्कैन करें

हमें फॉलो करें : @ceoharyana
मुख्य निर्वाचन अधिकारी, हरियाणा
www.ceoharyana.nic.in
हेल्पलाइन 1950

● WEB EXCLUSIVE
'At Jantar Mantar, the story isn't just the demands — it's people finally showing up.' — *By Saptarshi Basak*
Log on to www.indianexpress.com

● WORDLY WISE
Justice is the first virtue of social institutions, as truth is of systems of thought.
— *John Rawls*

The Indian EXPRESS
~ FOUNDED BY ~
RAMNATH GOENKA
IN 1932
BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Due process is not a waste of anyone's time

THIS IS a time when mostly young protesters are still thronging Jantar Mantar in the national capital, and when, in the aftermath of the police crackdown on July 20, they are not assuaged by the government's assurances. At this time, the message from the highest court of the land should be: Its doors are open to any process that protects the rights of the vulnerable, fosters accountability and expands the ground for negotiations. With due respect, however, Chief Justice of India Surya Kant's response to a lawyer who sought the Court's intervention against police excess, seemed to highlight a gulf between citizen and institution, instead of offering a healing touch: "Don't waste our time and your time," he said. And, "We are not interested in videos. We don't have time to watch." These may be only oral observations. It is also true that the CJI cannot be expected to wade through countless Instagram reels and in this polarised climate, even videos whose authenticity is in doubt. But in the social media age, words travel far, often away from their contexts. They can take on a life of their own — it was the CJI's choice of words, earlier, that provided the spark for the satirical online platform, Cockroach Janta Party, the protests' centrepiece.

The question of police excesses against protesting students will need to be addressed. Reports from the Delhi street, including in this newspaper, have pointed to the use of disproportionate force, including pellet guns, apart from lathi charges and tear gas shells. They have highlighted, too, the short-circuiting, if not outright flouting, of established restraints and protocols. Delhi Police Standing Order 309 and Standing Order 152 lay down the specific guidelines that police must follow to disperse protesters — the Supreme Court's 2012 ruling in the Ramlila Maidan case underlined these. An inquiry must ask if the police went through the required paces. Given the demographics and nature of the protesters, largely students, did the police observe the principle, as laid down by the Court, of "least invasiveness"? Did it use water cannons before resorting to more injurious methods? Did it fire the tear gas away from the crowd, rather than directly into it?

A small section of the protesters, too, have resorted to violence and vandalism. Physically assaulting journalists not to their liking to pelting stones, these need to be strongly condemned. A fair and independent probe — the Delhi High Court has done well to agree to hear two PILs on the issue — must set those aberrations in the larger context. In a clash between unequals, it must ensure that the powerful state does not weaponise the rulebook to subdue the powerless citizen. That's why, with due respect to the Court, this needs to be underlined: Due process is not a waste of time.

Floods shift course. State response is static

FLOODING IS a chronic feature of Assam's monsoon. This year, however, parts of the state far removed from the banks of the Brahmaputra and its tributaries have borne the brunt of the raging waters. According to the state government, the scale of devastation in the Upper Assam districts of Sivasagar, Charaideo, Jorhat and Golaghat is "unprecedented". More than 20 people lost their lives within 24 hours on Monday after a wall of water from Nagaland's Mon district spilled into Assam and surged over embankments. It is now draining into the Brahmaputra over open terrain rather than just through the tributaries. The Assam government has reportedly told the state assembly that "no one could have been prepared" for the calamity. That isn't a convincing explanation. The trajectory of the floods over the past few days is a fallout of Assam's topography and the Brahmaputra's well-known tendency to shift course. At a time when climate change is amplifying natural vulnerabilities, the authorities need to be more vigilant to minimise suffering.

After emerging from the mountains near Pasighat in Arunachal Pradesh's East Siang district, the Brahmaputra enters the relatively flat Assam valley. The sharp reduction in gradient causes the river to slow down and deposit sediment. Over time, this has raised the riverbed, reducing the channel's capacity to contain floodwaters. The result is that Upper Assam is increasingly exposed to flood risks once associated primarily with downstream areas. The Brahmaputra also periodically abandons old channels and carves out new ones, making it impossible to confine the river within embankments permanently. Yet Assam's flood management strategy continues to rely on this approach.

On Sunday, Mon district received more than a third of its average July rainfall in about eight hours. With hills in the region already saturated with water from heavy rains earlier this month, slopes collapsed, triggering landslides that killed nine people in Nagaland. The destruction that followed in Assam underscores the need for an institutional mechanism that treats rivers as shared ecological systems and ensures timely warning and coordinated action across states. The Brahmaputra Board has long been hampered by staff shortages and inadequate technical capacity. With extreme weather becoming more frequent, the Centre and state governments need to reinvigorate the agency.

The film that launched a thousand tweets

IN THE 15th century, an Oxford student was strolling through a forest reading Aristotle's Logic when he was attacked by a wild boar. Legend has it that he shoved the tome down the beast's throat shouting, "*Graecum est*" — it's Greek (hence not readable), a phrase used by medieval scribes when they came across Greek passages in Latin works they were copying. It's a refreshingly honest attitude, in contrast to the sudden outbreak of social-media Homer expertise following the release of Christopher Nolan's *The Odyssey*. The casting of Lupita Nyong'o, a Black woman, as Helen, launched a thousand tweets. And now, Elon Musk has joined in, promising a "historically accurate" adaptation of Homer's work made by his AI platform Grok Imagine.

Whether a historically accurate rendition of a mythic landscape populated by gods and monsters is possible is another question. *The Iliad* and *The Odyssey* do not have a clear setting that can be pinpointed historically. The assumption, shared by Nolan, is that they are set at the end of the Bronze Age. However, the epics' portrayal of society reflects a later time, when the centralised palace states of the Bronze Age had fallen and local "big men" were in charge —like Penelope's suitors in *The Odyssey*.

Whatever Musk and Grok may come up with will be as much a product of the 2020s and their culture-war preoccupations as Nolan's interpretation, as much an act of creation. The question is whether it will resonate with audiences. It's a tall order because, as a classicist might put it, "*Grokum est*."

Restoration of J&K statehood calls for a phased and negotiated roadmap

HASEEB A DRABU

IT HAS been seven years since Jammu & Kashmir was downgraded to a Union Territory. It has been five years since the Union government committed in Parliament to restore statehood. It has been four years since delimitation was done. It has been three years since the Supreme Court was assured of restoration. It has been two years since an elected government took office.

Yet, so far, there has not even been a serious conversation about it. The only response from the Centre, a clear and consistent one, has been an assurance wrapped in ambiguity: Statehood will be restored at the "appropriate time". The "appropriate time" is not a date on the calendar; it is whatever time suits the present dispensation. At the "appropriate time" is not a promise but an instrument of power. Every demand for a date is an indicator of impatience, and every postponement a proof of prudence.

Faced with growing public disillusionment locally over the Omar Abdullah-led government's performance, the National Conference recently launched an outreach drive. After civil-society consultations, it called for a protest in New Delhi on July 20.

The National Conference positioned its protest as a broad-based political initiative rather than a party-specific agitation. Though well-placed to lead the J&K parties and wider civil society by virtue of a strong electoral mandate, all the Valley-centric parties decided not to participate in the protest. This has turned a potential show of strength into a display of fragmentation, thereby significantly reducing the political pressure on the Union government to act. Without a united front at least from the Valley, the Centre can easily treat the demand as partisan rather than regional, and delay statehood restoration on its own timeline.

Being a constituent of the INDIA bloc, the National Conference had also reached out to the national and regional parties to build a wider constituency of support and gain greater political traction. This could have provided an opportunity to frame the demand as a larger federal issue that touches upon the basic structure of India's constitutional arrangements. For the most potent blueprint for the restoration of statehood is not a political manifesto of any party, but an agenda for federal democratic polity of India. But that was not to be.

As the National Conference assembled in New Delhi for the restoration of statehood for J&K, the refrain in the lacklustre affair was unfulfilled promises rather than rights denied. Speeches, slogans and bytes invoked constitutional morality, legislative assurances, judicial precedents and political commitments. These are valid, necessary political arguments but have limited relevance in the current context.

For the Centre, it is amply evident that security and "normalcy" are the non-negotiable pre-conditions for restoring statehood. This is not a temporary hurdle. Until these concerns are credibly addressed, arguments based only on constitutional grounds will remain secondary in the decision-making process at the highest levels.

The restoration of statehood is not a simple administrative decision or a one-sided concession. It will be the outcome of a political bargain in which enhanced powers and privileges will come with greater responsibilities, aka conditionalities. This is already visible in the case of Ladakh, where statehood has been made contingent on meeting certain revenue and self-sustainability criteria. J&K is unlikely to be treated differently.

> Engaging substantively with the Centre's stated concerns on security and governance could prove more consequential than constitutional arguments alone

This is why the political leadership in J&K needs to move beyond making a legal case. Engaging substantively with the Centre's stated concerns on security and governance could prove more consequential than constitutional arguments alone. The tragic killing of a police officer on Amarnath Yatra duty, the first terror attack in the Valley since Pahalgam, serves as a stark illustration of why constitutional arguments alone are insufficient without credible progress on the ground.

Treating the security issue as a chicken-and-egg problem — the lack of full powers is cited as the reason for limited initiative — is technically correct but politically unwise because it restricts the space for political agency. While the elected government's limited powers are a structural constraint, demonstrating statecraft even within the current framework could help build credibility with the Centre.

From the Union's point of view, the restoration of statehood may be seen as a decision to be taken at an appropriate time. However, from the perspective of J&K, it will be a process. Statehood cannot simply be restored by an executive order changing its status. Such a move would leave the underlying administrative and financial distortions created since 2019 largely unaddressed. Converting the former state into a Union Territory did not just alter its administrative boundaries, it fundamentally changed its governance DNA and deepened J&K's dependence on the Centre.

It is high time to move away from the binary of statehood restoration to what it will entail, politically and administratively. A more strategic approach would require the J&K political leadership to move from episodic mobilisation to a sustained, multi-track engagement. In the short term, this would mean building a unified negotiating position across parties on the benchmarks for "normalcy" that the Centre considers non-negotiable.

In parallel, the focus should shift to negotiating a time-bound framework, possibly through a structured administrative mechanism of unwinding the central controls. Without such a phased and negotiated roadmap, the demand for statehood risks remaining a recurring political slogan instead of becoming a manageable political settlement.

It is unlikely that the recent Delhi protest will be the starting point of a political process for statehood with status. To reach a milestone on that road, the Valley-centric political leadership needs to prioritise pragmatic sequencing over fragmented posturing. This will determine if J&K can convert public sentiment into concrete constitutional gains in the coming years.

The writer is the former finance minister of J&K

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US-Saudi deal & a new nuclear model for West Asia

ANJU GUPTA

ON JULY 22, a press release by the US Department of Energy announced that Secretary of Energy Chris Wright and Saudi Minister of Energy Prince Abdulaziz bin Salman had signed a peaceful nuclear cooperation agreement — commonly known as a 123 agreement — and an accompanying bilateral safeguards agreement. Apart from describing this as a "legal foundation for a decades-long, multi-billion-dollar partnership that advances several priority economic and strategic objectives, including nuclear nonproliferation", the press release said that the agreement would also "advance American and regional security by upholding high standards of nuclear safety, security, and nonproliferation".

Saudi Arabia's Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman (MbS) has often spoken about working to develop nuclear weapons if Iran was not prevented from getting them. Some experts may interpret the 123 agreement as a long-term "enabler" for Riyadh to pursue this goal. Given that the US-Israel war on Iran is being fought on a core point of preventing the latter from building nuclear weapons, does it add fuel to the fire or signal a reworking of the US role in the security architecture of the region?

Long before "limited" US military action against Iranian nuclear facilities at Fordow, Natanz, and Isfahan during the 12-day Israel-Iran conflict in June 2025, Saudi Arabia had been taking concrete steps to build its civil nuclear programme. In 2017, it approved a National Project for Atomic Energy, which included plans for building large and small nuclear reactors. A signatory to the Treaty on the Non-Proliferation of Nuclear Weapons (NPT) since 1988, Saudi Arabia has, since then, made agreements to observe some of the International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) safeguards, though limited in scope. On September 17, 2025, Saudi Arabia also signed a Strategic Mutual Defence Agreement with Pakistan.

Since then, the US seemed to have fast-tracked efforts to sign the 123 agreement. As a result, during MbS's November 2025 visit to the US, the two sides signed a "Joint Declaration on the Completion of Negotiations on Civil Nuclear Energy Cooperation", which, the White House said "builds the legal foundation for a decades-long, multi-billion-dollar nuclear energy partnership... confirms that the United States and American companies will be the Kingdom's civil nuclear cooperation partners of choice; and ensures that all cooperation will be conducted in a manner consistent with strong nonproliferation standards". This set in motion the framework for the 123 agreement.

It appears that, for years, Saudi Arabia had been moving as well as posturing towards a civil nuclear programme with or without the agreement with the US. In recent years, its bilateral relations with China, a possible competitor, have improved so significantly that Beijing brokered a rapprochement between Saudi and Iran in March 2023. This may be one of the compelling reasons for signing the 123 deal sooner rather than later.

However, the current state of the US-Iran war has created serious constraints in resolving the Iranian nuclear issue. The dangerous and currently escalating tug of war over the Strait of Hormuz is unlikely to end anytime soon. Without any amicable resolution over the Strait, US-Iran nuclear talks will remain in limbo.

The 123 agreement does not, per se, enable Saudi Arabia to develop nuclear weapons. It reportedly presents a "US-controlled and monitored enrichment model" to Iran and to other Arab states. The press release stresses that the 123 partnership will "expand American nuclear technology exports, create high-paying US jobs and long-term economic growth, and strengthen America's energy and national security posture". Thus, the model "sells" the idea of bringing billions of dollars to the American nuclear and allied industries, while assuaging the concerns of non-proliferation advocates and the "hawks".

> The 123 agreement does not, per se, enable Saudi Arabia to develop nuclear weapons. It reportedly presents a 'US-controlled and monitored enrichment model' to Iran and to other Arab states

Once cleared by Congress, the 123 model could be offered to Iran during nuclear negotiations. Iran sees the right to enrichment as an absolute sovereign right that it won't give up. The intentions behind the move may or may not work with Iran, as the situation is volatile. However, the deal signals that the idea of a US security umbrella in support of a potential Israeli-Arab accord against the "common threat of Iran" is no longer on the table.

Gupta is a security analyst and former director general of police

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Guardrails for the first AI-native generation

PRAGYA MISRA

THE FIRST generation growing up with AI is already here. Millions of children and teenagers are using AI to study, explore interests, and make sense of the world. This creates both an extraordinary opportunity and a shared responsibility. AI has the potential to expand access to learning, creativity, and expertise in previously unimaginable ways. It also raises an urgent question: How can parents, educators, policymakers, and technology companies build the safeguards, support systems, and trust to ensure young people benefit from these tools safely and responsibly?

Transformative technologies scale best when the protections around them scale too. Electricity became widely trusted because societies built standards, insulation, and circuit breakers. Cars became safer because protections such as seat belts, licensing, and traffic rules became part of the system. Over time, the most important safeguards shift from being optional to default. AI is entering a similar phase, wherein the utility of the technology is well-established, but the opportunity is to build safeguards early and well enough for people to use these systems with confidence.

Much of the conversation still swings between hype and fear. One view assumes the market will sort everything out and young people will adapt on their own. Another assumes the only safe answer is to keep children away from AI altogether. The first understates the risks. The second ignores reality. Young people are already using these tools. As an industry, we have to make that access safer, more age-appropriate, and more responsible.

First, it starts with companies like ours, where safety is built into these systems from the outset, with initiatives like the Teen Safety Blueprint. For younger users, that means stronger defaults, clearer boundaries, better detection of higher-risk situations, and experiences designed with well-being in mind. It also means recognising a basic principle: When privacy, freedom, and safety come into tension for younger users, safety should carry special weight. Second, parent agency matters. One lesson of the social-media era is that platforms moved too quickly for most parents to keep pace with. With a fast-moving technology like AI, parents need guidance they can use, controls they can understand, and enough visibility to help shape how these tools are used at home.

> That means stronger defaults, clearer boundaries, better detection of higher-risk situations, and experiences designed with well-being in mind

Third, teachers and schools need to be treated as central actors. Because many young people are using AI for learning, classrooms are where both the upside and the risks will appear first. Teachers need support that reflects classroom reality. The aim for institutions should be to identify ways in which AI can strengthen learning. Fourth, policymakers should consider frameworks that help build public trust. The lesson from the past is that adoption works best when the rules are clear. In AI, that means age-appropriate standards, accountability for high-risk failures, clarity around data practices, and input from educators, child-safety experts, families, and young people themselves.

India stands at a unique moment. AI can help unlock productivity, widen access to knowledge, and empower a generation of students, workers, and entrepreneurs. But realising that opportunity will require ensuring that access is accompanied by safety, trust, and the skills needed to use AI effectively and responsibly.

The writer is head of strategy & government affairs, OpenAI, India

40 YEARS AGO

July 24, 1986

INDIAN EXPRESS

Responsibility for riots to rest with admn.
Move to check communalism

Tiff with China unresolved

Fixing accountability for riots

DISTRICT COLLECTORS and superintendents of police will henceforth be held directly and principally responsible for any outbreak of communal violence within their jurisdiction, the Minister of State for Internal Security, P Chidambaram, declared in the Lok Sabha. He was responding to the demand repeatedly made during the debate that the government pin responsibility on the collector and SP.

Reagan rules out sanctions

US PRESIDENT Ronald Reagan rejected what he called the emotional clamour for punitive sanctions against South Africa and called for deeper Western involvement to bring reform and an end to apartheid. Rebuffing Congress and some of America's Western allies, Reagan said, "We must stay and work, not cut and run." The speech, in which Reagan vigorously defended his stance towards the white minority government in Pretoria, but also urged it to set a time-table for dismantling apartheid, fell well short of demands in Congress for tough U.S. sanctions

Tiff with China unresolved

THE SEVENTH round of Sino-Indian border talks concluded in Beijing without resolving the issue of China's recent intrusion into Indian territory or making much progress on the boundary question itself. Informed sources said there was an intensive exchange of views on the Chinese intrusion into Wangdong in the Sumdorong Chu Valley area of Arunachal Pradesh, but the Chinese maintained it was north of the Line of Actual Control and in their territory.

Monsoon rainfall mystery

DESPITE ALL indications to the contrary in the capital, the weatherman insists that the monsoon is good this year. According to him, the rains have been fairly widespread this season in the state of Haryana, where Delhi is geographically located. But the rainfall has been paltry. And he admits this, having recorded a mere 3.5 cm of rain so far as against a normal rainfall of 21 cm for July.

WHAT THE OTHERS SAY

Mr Burnham will need to marshal the full authority of his office to drive change through systems that are prone to inertia. — *The Daily Star, Bangladesh*

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THE BEST OF BOTH SIDES

A weekly column, which offers not this-versus-that, but the best of both sides, to inform the debate

ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

Do the protests at Jantar Mantar frame wider youth discontents? Are they being hijacked?

Opposition must not use young as fodder

GURU PRAKASH

BEFORE A single word of politics, a word of conscience. For a young Indian, a competitive examination is not a single morning in one year. It is the compression of a childhood's savings, a family's faith, and a small town's hope into three hours and an answer sheet. When a leak compromises that sheet, something more than a test is broken; trust is broken. I've spent enough time in the classroom to know the look of a student when the promises she built her hopes on suddenly vanish.

And yet a mature democracy must be honest enough to draw one line: Between those who grieve and those who have learnt to feed on grief.

Let no one mistake the Bharatiya Janata Party for a party that fears dissent. We are, in our very origins, a child of dissent. The Jana Sangh and the movement around it were forged in protest, in Syama Prasad Mookerjee's sacrifice for the full integration of the nation, in the jails of the Emergency where Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Lal Krishna Advani and Nanaji Deshmukh sat in defence of the Constitution. The Ram Janmabhoomi movement was a mass mobilisation on a scale independent India had rarely seen. Dissent expands the democratic space of a nation, provided it is not weaponised to manufacture a permanent "us versus them".

But experience also teaches caution, because I have watched what becomes of movements. The JP movement began as a moral revolt against authoritarianism and ended, rightly, as a vehicle of democratic change. The Anna Hazare *andolan* I witnessed more closely. It began in 2011 as a genuine call against the rampant corruption of the UPA-II government. And then, slowly, the idea was captured. Political entrepreneurs sensed the opportunity.

The ideals did not survive the personal ambitions of those leaders.

I recall this history not to disparage today's students, but to protect them from it. Because on the streets right now, three very different actors are being deliberately blurred into one.

The first are the students, and their grievance is entirely legitimate. They want fair examinations, honest accountability, and transparency. They are owed all three, without qualification.

The second is the government, and its conduct is a matter of record. The compromised paper was cancelled. The CBI traced the leak toward a source within the testing agency itself; a retired teacher and an insider are among those arrested, and the government has said that the strictest actions will be taken. A fresh NEET-UG was conducted within weeks. The Education Minister did not claim the system was perfect; he said that even after the reforms, a breach still occurred and the government would correct it. The Prime Minister posted on X that "we have decided to set up fast-track courts to ensure swift and stringent punishment for those involved in paper leaks".

The third actor is the one the students should be warned about: The political opportunists. Watch how the demand evolves. It begins with a call to fix the leak. Soon it becomes a demand for the Education Minister's resignation, then the Prime Minister's resignation, then for the entire system to be torn down, before culminating in the dangerous suggestion that India, too, must settle its political disputes on the streets rather than through its institutions. A paper leak is an institutional failure that demands correction. Regime instability is a political objective. The two are fundamentally different.

It is here that the Leader of the Opposition owes the country an answer. When Rahul Gandhi chose to stage a *dharna* outside the Prime Minister's residence, disregarding security protocol and inconveniencing ordinary citizens, the government, through the Minister of State in the PMO, conveyed within the hour its readiness for a full discussion on NEET on the floor of the House. The intention was never dialogue; it was always to create a politics of spectacle.

The BJP has sought not merely to speak to young Indians, but to entrust them with responsibility. The appointment of 45-year-old Nitin Nabin as the party's youngest national president reflects a deliberate effort to bring a new generation into positions of leadership. My own appointment, as a Dalit law teacher and the party's youngest national spokesperson, is another expression of that belief.

Students deserve justice. Parents deserve confidence. The government deserves scrutiny, unsparing and continuous. The Opposition deserves its space, fully and without harassment. But democracy deserves something greater than endless agitation. India's republic has always been strengthened by dissent; it has never once been strengthened by those who mistake every moment of dissent for an opportunity to inherit power. We owe students answers, reforms, and accountability, and that, not the theatre outside the Parliament, is the work this government intends to finish.

The writer is national spokesperson, BJP

When young speak, politics must listen

RADHA KUMAR

THE HORRIFIC scenes of young Indians being teargassed and thrashed while protesting the corruption of education in Delhi has galvanised youth across the country to seek accountability, dialogue and reform. They deserve all three.

Only a dozen years ago, we talked about India's potential demographic dividend given its increasingly young population. We now face the grim truth that that opportunity was squandered. According to ILO estimates, unemployment in the 15-24 age group was as high as 17.2 per cent in 2025, up from 15 per cent in 2024. Unemployment amongst women with advanced education was as high as 21 per cent in 2024. How we slid from potential demographic dividend to lost generations is a story for economists to tell, but neither the Union nor state administrations can evade responsibility, certainly not a government in its third term.

Instead of consulting our myriad educationists on how to fix the problem of educational rot — are nationally conducted examinations even desirable or feasible in a country of our physical and demographic size? — this administration resorted to the heavy-handed law-and-order approach that has become all too familiar. The Enforcement Directorate was directed to arrest those accused of fraud and seize their assets, a task that is still ongoing. But no commission of inquiry has been established to investigate the systemic flaws of the education system, which is being increasingly controlled by the Union administration. Nor has the education ministry held widespread and non-partisan consultations on how to improve education in a country characterised by both the poor quality and the poor spread of learning, especially in its Hindi-speaking states. Worse still, there has been no serious study of how education can be tied to employment.

Now, the same heavy-handed approach has been deployed against young protesters, with an added and deeply troubling twist. The Union administration's initial response was stony silence. Days passed, but the administration did not respond to the many calls for dialogue with the protesting students, including by an editorial in this newspaper. When a meeting did finally take place between two representatives of the Cockroach Janta Party and Union Health Minister J P Nadda, it was a full month after the *dharna* began and it was inconclusive.

Even while the meeting was ongoing, the Delhi Police attacked the youth marching to Parliament and those still at the protest site. Judging by the reams of footage flooding the internet, the police used electrified lathis known as shock batons, tear gas and even pellet guns, which are banned in most democratic countries but allowed in the "rarest of rare" incidents in India. By what stretch of criteria can a student protest qualify as "rarest of rare"?

Shockingly, too, we saw commandos in civilian attire beating up students with no intervention by the uniformed police. Why was this allowed?

Police excesses are not rare in our country, but they have increased exponentially over the past decade. In 2024, we saw firing on protesting farmers and in 2019 we saw forcible crackdowns on students protesting the Citizenship (Amendment) Act. During the same period, we saw armed confrontations between the Assam and Mizoram police and the Haryana and Punjab police — a development that was indeed rare in India.

Instead of inquiring into the excesses of July 20, the Delhi Police indulged in a smear campaign. Protesters were accused of masquerading as students and being fronts for the Opposition; unnamed sources even floated a theory of Pakistani involvement. One can only wonder: If Pakistan can so successfully muster a lakh or more to march in India's capital, what on earth has the Union home ministry been doing?

Ludicrous as these accusations are, they point to a deeper malaise. Police reform has been on the anvil for decades now. Successive commissions, from 1978 to 2006, have made eminently sensible as well as eminently feasible recommendations for reform that have mouldered on the home ministry's shelves. The time to dust them off and implement their recommendations — the most important of which seek to insulate the police from political diktat — is now.

What happened on July 20 will only lead to greater anger amongst all Indians. Yet if there was ever an issue that demands bipartisan consultation and public policy formulation, it is the future of our young. Whether our economy and society progress or falter depends on them, and they demand answers. As one young woman tellingly remarked: "No taxation without accountability." Young India has risen. It is for old India to listen — and change.

Kumar's latest book is The Republic Relearnt: Renewing Indian Democracy, 1947-2024

Law is an ass: I was summoned to Patna, caught in a 'scam'

ASHOK LAVASA

IN A season of protests against paper leaks and manipulations in examinations, I found myself last week "caught" in a recruitment scam. My crime? Signing a letter in April 2009 conveying the Home Minister's (HM) permission to prosecute an Inspector General (IG) of the Central Reserve Police Force.

The HM was himself "recruited" after his predecessor resigned following the November 26, 2008 terrorist attack in Mumbai. It was conceivable in those days to see ministers suffering for the "failure to perform".

The HM wanted to fix accountability and revamp the recruitment system of the central paramilitary forces as the CBI unearthed the scam. The permission to prosecute the IG-in-charge was for enforcing accountability. Later, the recruitment process was reformed by converting the written test for constables into an OMR-based test, while the interview was abolished to avoid discretion, and the physical eligibility test was made more stringent. I never thought that signing the letter would haunt me 17 years later and give me the opportunity to see why Charles Dickens wrote, "the law is an ass".

I was summoned to Patna to testify that I had signed the permission letter. I wrote to the home ministry, pointing to the absurdity of testifying to something that could be affirmed by government records and wasting public money for my travel and stay. I also requested the court to take my evidence through a video conference.

ILLUSTRATION: TANUSHRI MITRA

Unsurprisingly, I received no response but fresh summons.

Patna, which I was visiting after five years, seemed to compete with other upcoming cities in exemplifying urban chaos. Everything was like a strange stasis in motion. The automobile was the new autocrat on the road, allowing space for nothing else. Everyone was blowing their horn, yet nothing was moving.

The courts were open but the entry gate was locked. I went to the other gate where a sentry raised three fingers to suggest that I go to Gate 3. Vehicles entering the premises and those coming out were locked like adversaries in a never-ending legal battle. Regulating this seemed unfair because both needed the right of way. Like many things these days, the commotion had to resolve itself or those bearing the brunt were left to find their own solutions.

I jostled through and climbed three floors to reach the designated courtroom. A hearing was on but the judge, seated in his low chair behind a high table, was barely visible. A few court officials sat taking notes, surrounded by piles of files, that concealed the past and the future of litigants. The clock on the wall stood still and below it was a poster prohibiting the use of cell phones in the courtroom. Before the poster stood a lawyer speaking softly into his cell phone.

There was an air conditioner near the judge, and a few fans, but the lawyers were sweating, more because of their black coats than their weak cases.

The lawyer arguing his case read aloud from his file, standing beside another, amid a row of empty chairs meant for lawyers. On either side, people like me sat on benches, awaiting our turn. There was no hierarchy, no status, no reputation. Everyone in the room looked guilty of being part of a system designed to demean everyone equally.

The two accused stood expressionless in the box, indifferent to the arguments, their hands folded, hoping that their posture alone could deliver them from the dungeon. Meanwhile, lawyers went in and out, whispering something to the court officials or opening the trunks containing case files and exhibits.

After half an hour, the public prosecutor limped into the room. He hardly knew why I was there. No one briefed me about the more than 17-year-old case. After waiting for an hour, I climbed into the witness box, was shown the letter bearing my signature and asked if I had signed it. I said "yes", which the court clerk typed into a computer. Realising that I ought to have sworn an oath before testifying, he asked me to read from a piece of cardboard hanging in the witness box. I was done in five minutes. As I waited to sign my statement, another witness was examined. I was the 58th of the more than 200 witnesses listed by the prosecution.

Meanwhile, the lawyer and the judge vehemently discussed the difference between inquiry and investigation. The lawyer insisted that only material obtained during investigation after registering an FIR was admissible evidence. It reminded me of the Ram Janmabhoomi theft case in which the SIT was constituted before any FIR was registered.

I was then told to await cross-examination as the defence lawyer was absent during my statement. He appeared only after an hour when the judge warned "if he doesn't come in 10 minutes, the witness will stand discharged".

He showed up, wiping the sweat from his forehead. I was back in the witness box. The defence lawyer sheepishly requested to see my statement for which the court clerk turned the screen of the computer towards him. As he kept reading for three minutes, the judge wondered why he took "so long to read three sentences". The clerk and the lawyer realised that a wrong statement was being read. Having read the right one, the lawyer spent five minutes gaping at the permission letter and asked me if the name of the person who typed the letter was written on it, "what was the meaning of having considered", and if I had "considered the matter objectively or subjectively". Irked by such inanities, the judge ended the cross-examination saying, "You will continue till 4 pm, if not stopped." He directed that the transcript be printed. The clerk left the court, returned after 10 minutes wiping his hands, and printed the statement. I signed and wrote "ROAC".

Forty-four years ago, holding court as subdivisional magistrate, I had learnt this acronym that meant "read over and affirmed to be correct".

Was Dickens correct in his assertion?

The writer is a former election commissioner

The green we celebrate, the forests we fell

MRINAL PANDE

"MAY YOU live and have a lively year/ Be fearless as a tiger, sharp as the fox/ Bring relief like the snow and remain steadfast as the Himalayas./ Keep coming to see us each year in this month of greening."

This is the blessing children in rural Uttarakhand receive each year from their family elders on the festival of Harela. Mothers and sisters touch the young ones from head to toe with fresh young shoots of five grains grown in baskets exactly nine days prior to Harela. The soft green blades signal the return of the sowing season in the hills. Touching the green blades of saplings to the bodies of family members and wearing them in your caps is believed to bring good health and good luck through the year.

This year however, on July 16, the day of the merry green festival was marred by news of a youth-led "Black Harela" demonstration staged across towns in Uttarakhand. Young Uttarakhandis had lodged an angry protest against the proposed chopping down of some 4,000 mature trees in a massive drive to widen the national highway and link roads. "Is cutting down 4,000 trees in Rishikesh to save 30 minutes for tourists worth it ?" the protesters ask.

Anoop Nautiyal, social activist and a local man, questioned the absence of public information regarding the mass felling of vital green cover. The capital Dehradun, he says, accounts for 21,618 hectares — or almost 47 per cent — of all forest land diverted across Uttarakhand for infrastructural expansions, including the Bhaniyawala-Rishikesh highway. Ironic when you consider that the government — like other states — is also driving another big *abhiyan*: Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam (Plant a tree in the name of the mother).An RTI reply Nautiyal got in June revealed that since the formation of the state in 2000, 46,203 hectares of forest land has been diverted towards various projects.

In the Doon valley, knowledgeable locals point out, the planned felling will directly affect the entire ecologically sensitive area that houses the Shivalik Elephant Reserve and several other wildlife corridors. Local conservationists have a point when they say how building activity in this ecologically sensitive area has increasingly made the hills fragile and subject to landslides. Widening the roads and building infrastructural support for roads, bridges and tunnels will also use up already scant groundwater and deprive the new saplings of an irreplaceable, centuries-old canopy. Without that and the copious rainwater retention undertaken by mature trees, has anyone thought about how the saplings will survive and how long they will take to become mature enough to replace what is being destroyed without thought?

A strange situation has developed in our state, says Nautiyal in a clip on his Facebook page. Our government seems adamant on chopping up trees in the holy month of Harela that celebrates the resurgence of new life. Why is the Chief Minister permitting this? What message does this send to local voters? He quotes poet Dinkar's moving lines: "*Jab nash manuj par chhata hai,/ Pehle vivek mar jata hai* (When you are headed for total destruction, the first to go is your common sense)."

The writer is former chairperson, Prasar Bharati

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Listen to protesters

I READ Shashi Tharoor's piece on the recent crackdown on young protesters in Delhi ('The voice of India's youth must be heard inside Parliament', *IE*, July 23) and I agree with him completely. A government that treats protest as a threat instead of feedback is telling on itself. When students get hurt for standing peacefully at Jantar Mantar, that is not law and order. I also can't stop thinking about Sonam Wangchuk on hunger strike being taken away to a hospital by force. Whatever the medical reasoning, the timing and the manner make it hard to see this as anything but an attempt to end a protest quietly.

Khyati Singh Shekhawat, Barmer

What education needs

EDUCATION IS the backbone of any nation, yet low government investment fuels unemployment and social problems. Uncontrolled growing privatisation of the education sector is weakening public education, while leaders' poor educational track record shrinks public educational space across India (It's not just about a retest, It's about the India story, IE , July 23). The government must work with all stakeholders to reinvest in the education system. This links directly to the NEET paper-leak issue, which shows deeper neglect, not just one exam scandal. With education on the Concurrent List, real progress needs strong Centre-state coordination and genuine political will.

Sarjerao Eknath Narwade, Sangli

THE PM'S *Pariksha Pe Charcha* (2018–2026) has carried a remarkably consistent message: Replace fear with confidence, comparison with self-improvement, and rote learning with curiosity (It's not just about a retest, It's about the India story, *IE*, July 23). Modi's recurring message has been that success is determined less by examination scores than by character, resilience and the lifelong habit of learning .The next edition being due only in 2027, the PM could add a footnote on the government's need for a course correction.

R Narayanan, Navi Mumbai

Kerala suspends ADGP after SIT finds that he 'meddled in' Youth Cong attack probe

Express News Service
Thiruvananthapuram, July 23

SENIOR IPS officer and ADGP M R Ajith Kumar was suspended from service on charges of illegally interfering in and undermining the police probe into the attack on Youth Congress workers by the personal security staff of then chief minister Pinarayi Vijayan in 2023. CM V D Satheesan ordered a re-investigation. Two Youth Congress workers, one of them now MLA A D Thomas, were brutally attacked by the police, including Vijayan's staff, for showing black flags to the CM's convoy. SIT probe allegedly found that Kumar forced the subordinates to tamper with the case diary in such a manner to exonerate Vijayan's security personnel.

Detentions, demolitions in J&K after cop killed in terror attack; Omar raises concern

J&K CM says this "will not help improve the situation... but strain it further"

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, July 23

Security personnel intensify checking following the Anantnag terror attack, on Thursday. PTI

A DAY after a police Head Constable was killed in a terror attack in Anantnag, the homes of two local terrorists, who are believed to be active, were demolished in the early hours of Thursday.

Similar demolitions had followed the Pahalgam attack in April 2025, when the homes of at least nine suspected terrorists were blown up in different parts of the Valley. On Thursday, the homes of Haroon Ganie and Adil Ahmad Thokar were demolished in the Hasanpora and Bijbehara areas of south Kashmir.

Head Constable Ashiq Hussain Qureshi, a resident of Budgam in central Kashmir, who was posted with the Indian Reserve Police and attached with the Special Operations Group, was on Amarnath Yatra duty. The annual pilgrimage is currently suspended because of inclement weather. CCTV footage of the incident shows him being shot at close range by a lone terrorist.

Police sources told *The Indian Express* that over 2,500 youths have been picked up across the Valley, including more than 700 from Srinagar, over 200 from Budgam, 178 from Baramulla and over a hundred from Ganderbal, besides dozens from the four South Kashmir districts of Anantnag, Shopian, Kulgam and Pulwama.

Referring to a Supreme Court order against the demolition of homes of a person accused of a crime, Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on Thursday cautioned: "I understand the anguish of the police, but the Supreme Court has issued an order stating that summary action of this kind should not be taken. We witnessed a similar situation after the Pahalgam attack and at that time, I had to speak to the Central government to stop this."

He also spoke out against detention of hundreds of individuals in the Valley, stating that this "will not help improve the situation in J&K but in turn strain it further."

He also stated that while the police had blown up homes of suspected terrorists after the Pahalgam attack, the investigation showed that those involved were from outside J&K.

"This cycle will not end without taking the people along. To some extent, we may reach that point by use of Police, Army and the CRPF but its true end will come when people rise against this violence, like after Pahalgam last year," Omar said.

Former J&K chief minister and PDP chief Mehbooba Mufti also criticised the detentions, stating that while the killing of a police officer in the line of duty is "a heinous and condemnable act," detaining over a thousand people and demolishing the homes of families of two alleged terrorists amounts to "collective punishment that has no place in a democracy." She added that if the Government itself maintains that militancy has been reduced to near zero, "it must adopt a more humane and lawful approach towards innocent civilians instead of resorting to tit-for-tat for an entire community."

Inspector General (Kashmir) J&K Police, V K Birdi, could not be reached for comment on the detentions. Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha, who heads law and order in J&K, chaired a high-level security review meeting in Srinagar with senior officials from the army, J&K Police, civil administration, CAPFs, and key security agencies.

Man held for hoax bomb threat in Ajmer

Jaipur: A man has been arrested from Gujarat for allegedly sending a hoax bomb threat email to the Ajmer District and Sessions Court, police said on Thursday. The threat came on July 17. PTI

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

HEAD CONSTABLE SHER SINGH 14 BN BSF 02.02.1943 – 24.07.1989

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Head Constable Sher Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he made ultimate sacrifice while on operational duty in Ferozepur area, Punjab.

SUB INSPECTOR SRI RAM SINGH 151 BN BSF 01.07.1948 – 24.07.2002

CONSTABLE SAIFUL ISLAM 151 BN BSF 02.09.1973 – 24.07.2002

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate officer Sub Inspector Sri Ram Singh and Constable Saiful Islam on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal injuries in a grenade blast triggered, by militants in Anantnag area, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

Veer Balidani Lance Naik Kartar Singh 44 Bn 13-6-1951 To 24-7-1987

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Lance Naik Kartar Singh of 44 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating terrorists during an area domination duty in Amritsar, Punjab on 24 July 1987. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Constable K. G. Hingole 29 Bn

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable K. G. Hingole of 29 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being grievously injured while bravely combating terrorists during an operation in Amritsar, Punjab on 24 July 1988. For his indomitable courage and gallantry, he was posthumously awarded the Police Medal for Gallantry. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Head Constable Maniram 33 Bn 12-5-1951 To 24-7-1999

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Head Constable Maniram of 33 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating militants during an area domination operation in Doda, Jammu & Kashmir on 24 July 1999. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Sub Inspector Pradeep Kumar 210 CoBRA Bn 20-7-1984 To 24-7-2012

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Sub Inspector Pradeep Kumar of 210 CoBRA Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating insurgents during an operation in East Garo Hills, Meghalaya on 24 July 2012. For his exceptional courage and devotion to duty, he was posthumously awarded the Police Medal for Gallantry. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Constable Shankar Lal Barala 23 Bn

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Shankar Lal Barala of 23 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being grievously injured while bravely combating terrorists in Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir on 24 July 2018. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Notice Inviting Applications for Supplementary Shortlisting of PAD/Non-PAD Items/Brands

For and on behalf of the President of India, Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/G, Delhi Division, Northern Railway invites applications in the prescribed format from renowned and eligible manufacturers/suppliers/firms for supplementary shortlisting of PAD/Non-PAD items/brands for sale/supply at catering establishments over Delhi Division, Northern Railway for the validity period up to 31.03.2027. Applications for supplementary shortlisting may be submitted in the office of Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/G, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi during working hours between 10:00 hrs and 17:00 hrs on any working day up to 31.12.2026 (15:00 hrs). Applications received within the stipulated period shall be considered for supplementary shortlisting. The brands/items shortlisted under this supplementary shortlisting shall remain valid up to 31.03.2027 and shall be governed by the terms and conditions of the notification. Detailed notification, eligibility criteria, terms & conditions and application form are available on Northern Railway website i.e. https://nr.indianrailways.gov.in. Any corrigendum/modification, if any, shall be available on the aforesaid website only. 2545/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

GOVERNMENT OF MEGHALAYA
OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR OF HEALTH SERVICES
MEDICAL EDUCATION & RESEARCH (DME),
MEGHALAYA PASTEUR HILLS, SHILLONG
Email ID: pasteurinstituteshili@gmail.com/dmeshillong@gmail.com
Tel No. 0364-2591510/94851 06663

No.DHSME&R/SMC/Tender/VI/45/2026/4246
Dated; Shillong, the 23rd July, 2026

CORRIGENDUM

In partial modification of the NIT No: DHSME&R/ SMC /TENDER/ VI/22/2026/ 3872 dated 7th July, 2026 issued by the Directorate of Health Services Medical Education & Research (DME), Meghalaya, for **"Supply and Installation of set of Equipment/Items for Department of Microbiology, Pathology, Pharmacology & PSM as per NMC at Shillong Medical College, Shillong",** the following corrigendum is hereby notified:

"The last date and time for submission of the bid document is hereby extended from 27/07/2026 up to 1500 Hrs to **04/08/2026** up to 1500 Hrs."

All other terms and conditions of the tender shall remain unchanged.

Sd/-
Director of Health Services
Medical Education & Research (DME)
Meghalaya, Shillong

DIPR No.: 1169
Dated: 23.7.2026

BEFORE THE HON'BLE NATIONAL COMPANY LAW TRIBUNAL PRINCIPAL BENCH, NEW DELHI
T. P. NO. 07 OF 2023
IN THE MATTER OF:
MR. RAJESH CHAND GUPTA ... PETITIONER
VERSUS
SKM REFCON PRIVATE LIMITED ...RESPONDENT

NOTICE OF PETITION

TAKE NOTICE that the Company Petition titled "Mr. Rajesh Chand Gupta vs. SKM Refcon Private Limited", bearing TP (Co. Act) No. 07 (PB) of 2023, was listed before the Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal, New Delhi, on 12.05.2026. with the next date of hearing fixed on 27.07.2026.

That despite due and repeated attempts, service of notice upon the SKM Refcon Private Limited. i.e., the Respondent could not be effected through ordinary and permitted modes. Upon being satisfied of the same, the Hon'ble Tribunal has, vide order dated 12.05.2026, directed service upon the Respondent i.e., SKM Refcon Private Limited through substituted service by way of publication in one English and one vernacular newspaper having fair and wide circulation at the place where the registered head office of the Respondent is situated. Accordingly, the Respondent i.e., SKM Refcon Private Limited is hereby called upon to appear either in person or through a duly authorised counsel before the Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal, Principal Bench, New Delhi on 27.07.2026 which is the next date fixed for hearing of the matter.

In the event of failure to appear on the aforesaid date, the Hon'ble Tribunal shall be pleased to proceed with the matter ex-parte, without any further notice, at the sole risk and responsibility of the Respondent.

This notice is issued in strict compliance with and pursuant to the directions of the Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal, Principal Bench, New Delhi.

(RAKESH KUMAR) (PREETI KASHYAP) (ADITYA NAYYAR)
ADVOCATES FOR THE PETITIONER
CREDENCE LAW
C-329, LGF, Defence Colony, New Delhi
Place: New Delhi **Email:** info@credencelaw.com
Date: 23.07.2026 credencelawdelhi@gmail.com
Mobile: +91-9958348877; 011-41055222

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MARKET COMMITTEE RADAUR(YAMUNANAGAR)	CLEANLINESS WORK OF NGM RADAUR MANDI, NVM AND ITS SUB-YARDS FOR THE PERIOD 01.08.2026 TO 31.07.2027	24.07.2026 30.07.2026	6,87,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9802525217 mcradaur1989@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 47449/HYR

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED PANCHKULA	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF HPLC MACHINE ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	22.07.2026 05.08.2026	2,88,41,792/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentdgm2020@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 47447/HRY

INFORMATION & PUBLIC RELATIONS DEPARTMENT
GOVERNMENT OF JHARKHAND

Letter No: 1561 **Date: 23-07-2026**

CORRIGENDUM

Tender with reference no.- 1499, PR No.- 385399 and Tender ID- 2026_IPRD_116340_1 is revised as below given in table:

S. No	Old Clause	Old Clause
1.	Page No-10 of RFP; Point No:-3: If the Bidder has executed project of Sound & Light Show of value more than 2 Crores and more - 15 Marks.	Page No-10 of RFP; Point No:-3: If the Bidder has executed project of Sound & Light Show of value more than 2 Crores and more - 20 Marks.
2.	Page No-12 of RFP; Point No:-14(i): Curate a spectacular light & sound projection mapping (with water projection) for the pilgrims for entire Shrawani Mela i.e. 30- 07-2026 to 28-08-2026 at venue mentioned in Point No VI (I) a and b.	Page No-12 of RFP; Point No:-14(i): Curate a spectacular light & sound projection mapping (with water projection) for the pilgrims for entire Shrawani Mela i.e. 30- 07-2026 to 28-08-2026 at venue mentioned in Point No V (i) a and b and important monuments (the selected monuments shall be finalized by government/ competent authority as per requirement).

All other terms and conditions shall remain same.

Sd/-
Director

PR 385723 IPRD (26-27)D

Himachal Pradesh Jal Shakti Vibhag

E-NOTICE INVITING TENDER

The Executive Engineer Jal Shakti Division Shillai, on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh, invites the online Item Rate/ Lump Sum tender on turnkey basis from the eligible bidders of Indian Entity through online bidding system on or before 03.08.2026 on the site **https://hpetenders.gov.in**

Sr. No.	Description	Estimated Cost (in Rs.)	EMD (Earnest Money Deposit) (in Rs.)	Cost of Tender Form (in Rs.)	Stipulated Time
1.	Providing LIS for Sharli Guddi in GP Sharli Tehsil Kamroo Distt Sirmour (HP) Under NABARD (SH:- C/O RCC intake 105000 litres capacity , Sump well 140000 litres capacity, supplying & erection of pumping machinery with allied accessories, C/O pump house, providing, laying, jointing & testing in tranches of glvenized steel welded pipe and laying and jointing of GI pipe of various dia. in Rising main and C/O anchor block , 4 Nos. delivery tanks 281600 ltr. cap. at Node F, 197316 ltr. cap. at at Node D , 135780 at ltr. cap. at Node G and 64484 ltr. cap. at Node H) Job-1	5,40,79,077/-	6,16000	10000/-	1 Year

Last date of filling / uploading the tender is up to 03.08.2026 at 09:00 AM and tenders to be opened on same day at 12:30 PM.

The tender forms & other detailed conditions can be seen from the Govt. website https://hpetenders.gov.in

BRIEF SCOPE OF WORK

The Project approved under NABARD Under Trench XXX. The A/A & E/S of scheme has been accorded from Additional chief Secretary (JSV) Shimla -2 vide letter No. JSV IPH-B(F)5-3/2024 dated 05.02.2025 for RS 1034.24 Lakh only, and No. JSV-CE(SZ)-CTR-29 -1285-T/S/2026-268-69 dated 07.04.2026 for 862.00 Lakh only. Provision of C/O RCC intake 105000 litres capacity 1 No., Sump well 140000 litres capacity 1no., supplying & erection of pumping machinery with allied accessories, C/O pump house 1 No., providing, laying, jointing & testing in tranches of galvanized steel welded pipe and laying and jointing of GI pipe of various dia. in Rising main and C/O 4 Nos. delivery tanks 281600 ltr. cap. at Node E, 197316 ltr. cap. at at Node F , 135780 at ltr. cap. at Node G and 64484 ltr. cap. at Node H have been take.

Before submitting the tender, bidder / firm shall visit the site physically.

1. Tender documents and other instructions can be downloaded or viewed online from the portal https://hpetenders.gov.in, by the Bidders registered on the website which is free of cost.
2. The bidder/firm must make all necessary provision for required qualified resource personnel, their time and other costs, and appropriate engineering / technical considerations in resurvey, design, construction, erection, execution, commissioning process; including necessary documentation and inspections while quoting their offer.
3. Competitive Bidding for bidders shall be conducted in accordance with "Two Stage and Two Envelope" Bidding Procedure. Eligibility information, Technical Bid and Financial bid should be uploaded online as per prescribed method. The bids shall be submitted online electronically only.
4. Tender evaluation criteria- Eligible Technically Qualified lowest evaluated bidder (L1) shall be considered as a successful bidder. However, the acceptance of the offer shall rest with the EMPLOYER who does not bind himself/herself to accept the lowest offer, and reserves the right to accept or reject any or all the offers received without assigning any reason.
5. As the bids are to be submitted online and are required to be encrypted and digitally signed, the bidders are advised to obtain Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) from suitable vendors or from any authorized agency at the earliest.
6. **KEY DATES SHALL BE AS UNDER:-**

1	Date of Online publication	22/07/2026 AT 5:00 PM
2	Downloading of e-tender Documents	From 22/07/2026 at 5:00 PM up to 9:00 AM on 03/08/2026
3	Date of submission of e-tendering	From 22/07/2026 at 5:00 PM up to 9:00 AM on 03/08/2026
4	Physical submission of earnest money deposit and cost of tender documents	Up-to 11:00 AM on 03/08/2026
4	Date of opening of Cover-1 (Eligibility criteria) and Cover-2 (Technical bid)	03/08/2026 at 12:30 PM
5	Date of Opening of Financial Bids Cover-2	Shall be intimated separately.

Note:- Other Tender information may be checked online portal website: **www.hpetender.com**

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
Jal Shakti Division Shillai
HIM SUCHANA AVAM JAN SAMPARK

No. 2125/2026/2027/HP

कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियंता,
नलकूप खण्ड, (उत्तर) बुलन्दशहर।
अल्पकालीन निविदा सूचना-01/अधि0अभि0/2026-27
टेण्डरिंग के माध्यम से कराये जाने वाले कार्यों की निविदा

महामहिम राज्यपाल उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से इस खण्ड के अन्तर्गत निम्नलिखित कार्यों हेतु टेण्डरिंग प्रक्रिया के माध्यम से सिंचाई विभाग के वर्गीकृत श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से दिनांकः 03.08.2026 को अपरान्ह 12.00 बजे तक निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है, जो अधिशासी अभियंता, नलकूप खण्ड, (उत्तर) बुलन्दशहर के कार्यालय में दिनांकः 03.08.2026 को अपरान्ह 02.00 बजे गठित निविदा समिति द्वारा खोली जायेगी। निविदा दिनांकः 27.07.2026 को प्रातः 11.00 बजे से दिनांकः 03.08.2026 को अपरान्ह 12.00 बजे तक कय/डाली जा सकती है। कार्यालय बन्द होने अथवा अवकाश की दशा में यह निविदा अगले कार्यालय दिवस में उसी समय खोली जायेगी।

क्रम सं0	लाट संख्या	कार्य का विवरण	मात्रा	कार्य की अनुमानित लागत (लाख रू0 में)	धरोहर धनराशि (रू0 में)	कार्य को पूर्ण करने की अवधि	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य जी0एस0टी0 स्टेशनरी शुल्क सहित(रू0 में)	पंजीकृत श्रेणी
1	1	Relaying and Rennovation of Water Distribution system(Gule) and face lifting of Pump House, Delivery Tank and Development of Tubewell as a Model Tubewell of STW No-142JB of Village-Timarpur Block-Unchagaon, Disst -Bulandshahr	BOQ के अनुसार	3.93	7900.00	45 दिन	Rs. 150 + GST 18% + Rs. 500	सिविल श्रेणी में "सी" एवं उच्च श्रेणी
2	2	Relaying and Rennovation of Water Distribution system(Gule) and face lifting of Pump House, Delivery Tank and Development of Tubewell as a Model Tubewell of STW No-94KB of Village-Eklady Block-BB Nagar, Disst -Bulandshahr	BOQ के अनुसार	3.87	7500.00	45 दिन	Rs. 150 + GST 18% + Rs. 500	सिविल श्रेणी में "सी" एवं उच्च श्रेणी
3	3	Relaying and Rennovation of Water Distribution system(Gule) and face lifting of Pump House and Delivery Tank of STW No-22KH Village-Ashgarpur Block-Khurja, Disst -Bulandshahr	BOQ के अनुसार	3.47	7000.00	45 दिन	Rs. 150 + GST 18% + Rs. 500	सिविल श्रेणी में "सी" एवं उच्च श्रेणी
4	4	Relaying and Rennovation of Water Distribution system(Gule) and face lifting of Pump House and Delivery Tank of STW No-30SKB Village- HadimPur Block-Shikandrabad, Disst -Bulandshahr	BOQ के अनुसार	3.77	7600.00	45 दिन	Rs. 150 + GST 18% + Rs. 500	सिविल श्रेणी में "सी" एवं उच्च श्रेणी
5	5	Relaying and Rennovation of Water Distribution system(Gule) and face lifting of Pump House and Delivery Tank of STW No-74JB Village- Uttarawali Block-Bulandshar, Disst -Bulandshahr	BOQ के अनुसार	3.96	8000.00	45 दिन	Rs. 150 + GST 18% + Rs. 500	सिविल श्रेणी में "सी" एवं उच्च श्रेणी
6	6	Relaying and Rennovation of Water Distribution system(Gule) and face lifting of Pump House, Delivery Tank and Development of Tubewell as a Model Tubewell of STW No-01SB of Village-Kiloli Block-Bulandshar, Disst -Bulandshahr	BOQ के अनुसार	3.80	7600.00	45 दिन	Rs. 150 + GST 18% + Rs. 500	सिविल श्रेणी में "सी" एवं उच्च श्रेणी
7.	7.	Relaying and Rennovation of Water Distribution system(Gule) and face lifting of Pump House, Delivery Tank and Development of Tubewell as a Model Tubewell of STW No-151SB of Village-Chobhera Block-Pahasu, Disst -Bulandshahr	BOQ के अनुसार	3.59	7200.00	45 दिन	Rs. 150 + GST 18% + Rs. 500	सिविल श्रेणी में "सी" एवं उच्च श्रेणी
8.	8.	Relaying and Rennovation of Water Distribution system(Gule) and face lifting of Pump House and Delivery Tank of STW No-05DB Village-Umrara Block-Dannpur, Disst -Bulandshahr	BOQ के अनुसार	3.74	7500.00	45 दिन	Rs. 150 + GST 18% + Rs. 500	सिविल श्रेणी में "सी" एवं उच्च श्रेणी

नोट-
1. निविदा/विड की विस्तृत शर्ते व विशिष्टियाँ निविदा/विड प्रपत्र के साथ उपलब्ध होगी।
2. यह निविदा/बिड सूचना सिंचाई विभाग की **http://www.idup.gov.in** पर उपलब्ध है तथा निविदा से सम्बन्धित समस्त शर्ते कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता नलकूप खण्ड, (उत्तर) बुलन्दशहर के नोटिस बोर्ड पर चस्पा है। निविदा की शर्तों को भली भांति पढ़ने के बाद निविदा डाले।

(विपिन कुमार सिंह)
अधिशासी अभियंता
नलकूप खण्ड, (उत्तर) बुलन्दशहर

UPID-254006 Dt. 22/07/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER PWD ZONE KOTA

No.1058 **Dated 21-07-2026**

NIT No. 12/2026-27
Notice Inviting Bid
NIB No. PWD2627A1705

Bids for PWD Zone Kota are invited Budget Announcement 2026-27 Road Work from interested bidders upto 6.00 pm, 12.08.2026 other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (**http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in**, **http://sppp.raj.nic.in**) of the Rajasthan and **http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in** website. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs. 819.48 lacs. (1 Works)

UBN No. PWD2627WLOB07241

Sd/-
Addl. Chief Engineer
PWD Zone Kota

DIPR/C/12838/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Shashank Kumar @ Manmeet S/o Arun Kumar Village Karanpura PO Durgawati Distt: Kaimoor (Bhabhua), Bihar and T-34, Gali No.9, Uttam Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 543/2018 U/s 354D/506/509 IPC at PS: Najafgarh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shashank Kumar @ Manmeet** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shashank Kumar @ Manmeet** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shashank Kumar @ Manmeet of FIR No. 543/2018 U/s 354D/506/509 IPC of PS: Najafgarh, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 24.08.2026.**

By order
Ebbani Aggarwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Mahila Court No.03
South West District Room No.312
Dwarka District Court New Delhi

DP/9639/DW/2026

HARYANA REAL ESTATE REGULATORY AUTHORITY
New Mini Secretariat, 2nd Floor, Sector-1, Panchkula.
E-mail: hrerapkl-hry@gov.in, officer.rera.hry@gmail.com
Website: www.haryanarera.gov.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

For kind attention of allottees of "HL Residency Affordable Group Housing" measuring 11.363 acres (Having an FAR of 102586.152 sq.mtrs approved by Town and Country Planning Department on 01.12.2021) situated in Village Nuna Majra, Sector-37, Bahadurgarh, District Jhajjar being developed by HL Residency (Proprietorship Firm).

1. The above-mentioned project was registered with HRERA Panchkula vide Registration No. HRERA-PKL-JJR-286-2022 dated 07.01.2022 valid upto 29th June, 2026.
2. The promoter has requested the Authority that instead of revoking the registration on its expiry, the Authority may permit it to remain in force for one more year subject to such further terms and conditions as it thinks fit to impose in the interest of the allottees and any such terms and conditions so imposed shall be binding upon the promoter.
3. The Authority is considering the application of the promoter to permit continuation of registration under section 7(3) of the Act for this project. However, the first right of refusal for carrying out of the remaining development works is that of the association of allottees. Therefore, the Authority hereby invites objections from the association of allottees in particular and any other concerned persons in general.
4. The objections shall be filed in the registry of the Authority by 07.08.2026 which will be considered by the Authority under section 7(3) of the Act.

Secretary (Acting)
HRERA Panchkula

47439/HRY

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to
explained@indianexpress.com

• DEFENCE

How submarine hunter Malvan will help shield India's coastline

Sushant Kulkarni
Pune, July 23

THE INDIAN Navy on Wednesday commissioned the INS Malvan, its second Mahe-class Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC).

ASW-SWC is a specialised class of warships in India that is designed for anti-submarine and patrolling operations along the littoral zone — the shallow maritime zone near the shore that is strategically and economically critical. Other countries too deploy such littoral craft, but under different names.

The craft and its crest

INS Malvan is the second of eight Mahe-class vessels being built by Cochin Shipyard Ltd (CSL), Kochi, and the sixth of 16 ASW-SWCs under construction by CSL and Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE), Kolkata. The first ship in the class, INS Mahe, was commissioned in November last year.

The ship derives its name from the coastal town of Malvan in Maharashtra, a region synonymous with maritime vision and legacy of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj.

The Mahe-class INS Malvan. PIB

INS Malvan's crest bears the 'Bagh Nakha' (Wagh Nakh) — a tribute to the tiger-claw weapon associated with Shivaji. This is meant to symbolise courage, audacity and agility. The waves on the Bagh Nakha crest reflect the vast sea surrounding the coasts. The ship's motto — 'Silent Claws' — also reflects the crest, embodying lethality, stealth and the ability to strike the adversary swiftly, the Navy said.

Strategic importance

The ASW-SWC fleet significantly enhances the Navy's ability to secure the coastline against underwater threats. Designed for operations in shallow waters, these vessels fill a long-standing capability gap by detecting and countering stealthy diesel-electric submarines that larger surface vessels can't effectively pursue.

THE MAHE CLASS

- Mahe-class ships are mainly designed for anti-submarine warfare in coastal waters.
- These vessels are also equipped for underwater surveillance, search and rescue, low intensity maritime operations and mine-laying.

Their low draught (meaning they require less water beneath the hull to operate), advanced sonar systems and high manoeuvrability make them well suited to protect harbour approaches, sea lanes, offshore energy installations and key naval bases. At the commissioning ceremony at Karwar, Karnataka on Wednesday, Chief of Air Staff Air Chief Marshal AP Singh emphasised the importance of safeguarding sea lines of communication to ensure uninterrupted maritime trade amid global uncertainties. With 16 vessels planned, the Navy will establish a dedicated anti-submarine screen along the coastline, strengthening coastal defence while allowing larger warships to focus on blue-water operations.

The need for these vessels

Before the ASW-SWC programme, the Navy operated four Abhay-class corvettes — customised versions of the Soviet-origin Pauk II-class — for coastal patrol and anti-submarine warfare. They served for decades before being decommissioned between 2017 and October 2025. To replace and expand this capability, the Defence Acquisition Council approved the acquisition of 16 ASW-SWCs in December 2013 at over Rs 13,000 crore.

Contracts were subsequently awarded to CSL and GRSE to build eight vessels each. With India's 7,500-km coastline, 12 major ports, 184 minor ports and 1,197 islands, dedicated shallow-water ASW platforms are considered critical for coastal surveillance and maritime security. Of the 16 vessels, the Arnala-class is being built by GRSE and comprises INS Arnala, Androth, Anjadip, Amini, Abhay, Agray, Ajay and Akshay. CSL is constructing the Mahe-class, comprising INS Mahe, Malvan, Mangrol, Malpe, Mulki, Magdala and Machilipatnam. All 16 are expected to be inducted over the next two to three years.

• GLOBAL

US-Saudi nuclear pact can reshape West Asia balance

The deal could potentially set off an arms race in a region that already has a nuclear power (Israel) — and one on the cusp of getting there (Iran)

ANIL SASI

The US and Saudi Arabia have signed a controversial deal that could potentially enable the latter to kickstart a civilian nuclear programme. Heralded as a "peaceful nuclear cooperation agreement", the 30-year pact effectively seeks to offer "great access for American companies in the Saudi nuclear energy program", according to the US Department of Energy (DoE).

Text from the deal is yet to be made public. First reported by the *Wall Street Journal* and *The New York Times*, the deal could allow Saudi Arabia to enrich uranium — which is primarily to be used as fuel for power plants, but can also be diverted to make nuclear bombs. President Donald Trump said the deal would not allow this.

The US DoE noted that along with the co-operation deal, a "bilateral safeguards agreement" was also signed. However, some US media reports said the guardrails are not strong enough.

Trump also said — after the signing of the agreement — that it was "totally subject to" Saudi Arabia joining the Abraham Accords, which would establish diplomatic relations with Israel. The Kingdom has long refused to recognise Israel without a pathway toward a Palestinian state. It is unclear whether the pact contains any such clause.

Why the deal raises questions

While the deal's fine print is awaited, two major issues need flagging.

ONE, this could potentially set off an arms race in a volatile region where there is already a nuclear power (Israel) and one that is on the cusp of getting there (Iran).

While the agreement marks a major diplomatic and strategic victory for Saudi Arabia, it also has the potential to reshape power dynamics in West Asia, multiple experts have said in their early comments. Its announcement also comes as fighting escalates between the US and Iran. Saudi Arabia, a longtime American ally, hosts multiple US bases, which have been targeted by these Iranian attacks. It also comes two days after Iran's allies in Yemen, the Houthis, announced a "maritime blockade" against the Kingdom.

US President Donald Trump and Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman. NYT FILE

"It is a fact that if a country can produce its own nuclear fuel, then it becomes a much bigger risk for building nuclear weapons. The fineprint in the safeguards agreement would need to be read carefully," a Delhi-based representative of a US thinktank told *The Indian Express*.

TWO, this deal has to be ratified by the US Congress, which could be an uphill task despite Trump's Republican Party controlling both chambers of the US legislature.

"The broad support that Israel enjoys in the US legislature is simply not there for Saudi Arabia. The deal likely stems from the meeting that Saudi Arabia's ruler Mohammed bin Salman had with Trump last November," the person quoted above said.

This analyst indicated that the US and Saudi Arabia undertook a joint study to enable the latter to enrich uranium on its soil to produce fuel at an American-built enrichment facility, instead of relying on imported fuel. The study was a precursor to the deal that's now been signed.

The 123 Agreement

While this deal has been in the making for more than a decade, no American president has taken the final step to clinch it so far. The key element of this deal is what is called a 123 Agreement that allows the US to share nuclear technology with other countries. India is one such signatory.

Regional tensions

The Saudi deal could embolden Iran to build a nuclear weapon, potentially pushing it further towards China & Russia.

•

Israel — which Trump has now brought into the pact's equation — has warned that a such a deal could pave the way for Saudi Arabia to develop nuclear weapons.

This agreement, named after Section 123 of the US Atomic Energy Act of 1954, is a legally binding agreement that Washington DC requires before engaging in significant nuclear cooperation with another country. These agreements facilitate the transfer of nuclear materials, equipment and technology for peaceful purposes, while ensuring compliance with international nonproliferation standards. They also provide a framework for technical exchanges, scientific research, and safeguards discussions. This has to go through the US legislature, which could be a potential impediment, the analyst quoted earlier said.

In the case of India, the 123 Agreement signed with the US effectively ended the technology denial regimes that had been in place for three decades. Under the pact, India agreed to place some of its civilian nuclear facilities under India-specific safeguards in perpetuity while getting uninterrupted fuel supply to the reactors placed under International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards.

The risk of proliferation

There are two other areas of the deal that have raised concerns. One is the possibility that Saudi Arabia might be able to conduct largely unfettered domestic uranium enrichment, and two, there could be some limitations on the inspections regime, different in case of this agreement than some of the other agreements signed by the US.

While US Energy Secretary Chris Wright said the deal will "uphold the highest standards of nuclear safety", the key question is how well regulated is the transfer of American nuclear technology in the Saudi pact? Also, will the safeguards ensure that this Saudi deal is strictly restricted to civil application only?

If an enrichment provision is indeed part of the pact, it would differentiate this agreement from another one that was signed by the US in 2009 with Saudi Arabia's neighbour, the United Arab Emirates, under which Abu Dhabi does not produce its own fuel and is subject to a number of other restrictions.

The Saudi deal could also embolden Iran in its resolve to get a nuclear weapon, and potentially pivot it further towards China and Russia to attain this objective. Incidentally, Saudi Arabia's Crown Prince and de facto ruler, Mohammed bin Salman, told *CBS News* in 2018 that his country was not planning to acquire a nuclear weapon, but that "without a doubt if Iran developed a nuclear bomb, we will follow suit as soon as possible".

While it is unlikely to be an open-ended deal that enables the Saudis to enrich uranium, the big concern is whether the level of safeguards provided in the pact will be sufficient to keep the Kingdom from developing a bomb. Israel — which Trump has now introduced into the equation — has long warned that a deal of this kind could pave the way for Saudi Arabia to develop nuclear weapons. This raises larger questions for nuclear proliferation in West Asia and on the broader scale of global nuclear proliferation.

One of the key incentives cited by the US government to enter into this agreement is that it does provide opportunities for American nuclear players, particularly Westinghouse, to make significant sales to Saudi Arabia. Nuclear companies have traditionally been big donors to Trump. For Saudi Arabia, there is the potential of cutting back on its use of its own oil for electricity generation if it can take recourse to nuclear generation. But the risks that a badly drafted nuclear deal poses is also very real.

The deal also raises questions about a conflict of interest. The Trump Organisation has several financial dealings with Saudi Arabia and other countries in that geography. In just 2024, Trump and his family businesses raised about $50 million from documented deals connected to Saudi Arabia. This includes hospitality, casino deals and crypto interests.

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• LEGAL

Fast-track courts: When they can be established, where they lag

Vineet Bhalla & Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, July 23

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi's promise to set up fast-track courts (FTCs) to take up paper leaks has turned attention to what's seen as a silver bullet for judicial delays.

What are fast-track courts?

There is no single central legislation that governs these courts. The 14th Finance Commission (2015–2020) recommended FTCs to expedite the trial of heinous crimes such as murder, kidnapping, and property disputes pending for over five years. It also recommended them for cases involving vulnerable demographics, such as women and children.

In 2019, following an amendment to the criminal laws and a directive from the Supreme Court, the Union government launched a centrally sponsored scheme to establish fast-track special courts (FTSCs). Funded partially by the Nirbhaya Fund, these courts are exclusively for the time-bound trial of rape cases and offences under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act.

Can it be set up for an individual case?

The creation of special courts must satisfy Article 14, which guarantees equality before the law. In *State of West Bengal vs Anwar Ali Sarkar* (1952), the Supreme Court struck down a law that allowed the government to arbitrarily pick cases for special courts simply for the "object of speedier trial".

The court warned that "speed" is too vague and elusive a criterion on its own. To survive constitutional scrutiny, the cases chosen must have a rational, objective basis — such as the nature of the offence or the vulnerability of the victims. However, courts have of late been less compelled to draw the same red line, especially amid public demand. The SC directed the Centre to establish a special court to handle the 2G case, ensuring a day-to-day trial. It will have to be seen if the NEET case, which is being heard in a Delhi court, will be sent to a special court by the government or through a court order.

How quick are fast-track courts?

Litigants do not have an automatic statutory right to a fixed deadline for their trials. The Bharatiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita recommends that trials should ideally be completed within two years and trials for sexual offences within two months.

High case load

- FTCs can help expedite the legal process for specific, high-priority offences.
- But high case load remains a persistent challenge, owing to factors such as a lack of physical infrastructure and quality of investigation, and for the other parts of the legal process to work in conjunction.

Under the FTSC scheme, each FTSC is expected to dispose of 41-42 cases per quarter, or at least 165 cases annually.

In the landmark *P. Rama Chandra Rao v. State of Karnataka* ruling (2002), a seven-judge Constitution Bench ruled it is "neither advisable or feasible, nor judicially permissible to draw or prescribe an outer limit for conclusion of all criminal proceedings."

How have FTCs performed?

As of January, 862 regular FTCs were functioning across 21 states and union territories. Alongside them, 774 FTSCs — including 398 exclusive POCSO courts — were operational across 29 states and UTs.

The disposal rate for the special courts is around 96%, meaning that many cases were either heard or dismissed. On average, an FTSC disposes of about 9.5 cases per month, compared to the 3.3 cases cleared by a regular trial court of similar jurisdiction.

However, the volume of litigation means pendency is a persistent challenge. By the end of 2023, over 2.4 lakh cases were still pending in FTSCs.

In a 2026 Lok Sabha response, the Ministry of Law and Justice stated that delays in disposal are caused by many factors, which "include availability of physical infrastructure, complexity of facts involved, quality of investigation, nature of evidence, co-operation of stake holders viz. bar, investigation agencies, legal representation, forensic support, witnesses and litigants and proper application of rules..."

Advocate Kartik Venu, a criminal trial lawyer, told *The Indian Express*: "Fast track courts will not answer the issue of heavy case burdens, case dockets, lack of judicial officers to hear them, natural delays over the course of a trial based on the twists and turns that trials normally take." He said FTCs also require accompanying infrastructure.

The efficacy of fast-track courts varies according to subject matter, Venu said. In POCSO and IPC, he said, they have been an "utter failure" given the sheer volume of work and courts' inability to allocate specific judges. "In the Prevention of Corruption Act... there is perhaps a healthier ratio," he said.

• ECONOMY

The many benefits of replacing paper currency notes with durable plastic ones

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, July 23

LAST WEEK, a tender floated by a Reserve Bank of India (RBI) subsidiary revealed the central bank's intention to go ahead with a trial of plastic notes, some 15 years after a similar field trial was announced.

The Bharatiya Reserve Bank Note Mudran Pvt Ltd's (BRBNMPL) tender invited bids for 3.4 crore polymer sheets that are to be used to print currency notes. These aren't just any old plastic sheets but have special security features. The tender said the 3.4 crore sheets were an "immediate requirement" — once field trials were successful, BRBNMPL would look to buy larger quantities. But is there any benefit in replacing paper notes (made with 100% cotton) with plastic ones?

The 2012 trials

In September 2009, the RBI invited bids to procure 100 crore pieces of Rs 10-notes. These notes were to be introduced for a field trial in Kochi, Mysuru, Shimla, Jaipur and Bhubaneswar — different climatic zones that would test the resilience of the notes. The trial, however, went nowhere.

"Though we had envisaged a trial of plastic notes in 2012/13, it remained a plan only," a former central bank official told *The Indian Express*. "No decision had then been taken to proceed for procurement."

In its annual report for 2014-15, the RBI said that while the Rs 10 plastic notes were technically evaluated, "certain technical infirmities emerged and the process could not be taken further".

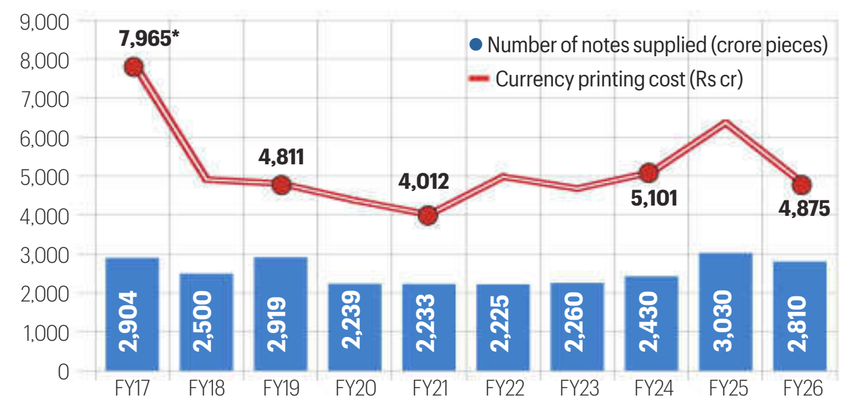
First issued by Australia in 1988, plastic banknotes are now used in over 50 countries, including the UK, Canada and New Zealand. Even our neighbours such as Thailand, Vietnam, Malaysia and Singapore use plastic currency, albeit not exclusively.

Better for the environment

The biggest advantage plastic notes provide over paper notes is that they are far more durable, lasting anywhere between two to six times longer depending on the denomination (small denomination notes are handled more frequently, which reduces their life).

A longer life means fewer plastic notes need to be manufactured. Printing fewer notes also reduces costs related to making them — even though one plastic note is more expensive to make than a paper one — distributing them and destroying them.

• Plastic notes may reduce RBI's printing costs



SOURCE: RBI; *HIGH COST WAS DUE TO DEMONETISATION, WHICH LED TO HIGHER THAN USUAL PRINTING OF NEW NOTES

In 2013, a study by The Energy and Resources Institute, at the RBI's request, found that replacing cotton-based notes with plastic ones would have "significant" environmental benefits. "Polymer/plastic banknotes (and the waste from production) can be granulated and recycled into useful plastic products such as compost bins, plumbing fittings and other household and industrial products. The base material of polymer is a non-renewable resource, but due to its recyclability, it has more than one life," the RBI said in its 2012-13 annual report.

Money and numbers

In the last three years, for every four new notes the RBI supplied, it destroyed three soiled ones. Durable plastic notes will not have to be destroyed so frequently, reducing costs as well as environmental impact.

The RBI spends thousands of crores every year to print currency notes. Just over the last decade, it has spent Rs 52,095 crore to print nearly 26,000 crore pieces of notes.

This is a big sum even for the RBI, and has accounted for 15-44% of its total expenditure, excluding provisions.

There is a security advantage too. According to UK firm De La Rue, which supplies notes to over half of all central banks, plastic notes are more secure as most counterfeit notes are produced on paper. As such, counterfeit rates have fallen in countries where currency notes are made of polymer.

In India, the number of counterfeit notes detected in 2025-26 rose to 2.3 lakh pieces, up from 2.17 lakh in 2024-25.

Import concerns

Despite all the positives of plastic notes, one issue remains: the possibility that India may end up having to import the sheets that are used to print banknotes.

While the tender expressly said bidders must ensure that their operations in Pakistan or China, if any, must be "suitably firewalled" from those in India, depending on a foreign entity for your legal tender is a vulnerability.

But this wouldn't be a first. The RBI has gradually reduced its import of paper and ink needed to make notes, with Bank Note Paper Mill India Pvt Ltd starting domestic production of watermarked paper around a decade ago. In August 2018, BRBNMPL's ink factory in Mysuru became operational.

Given these existing facilities, any shift to plastic must be gradual for two reasons. One, considerable investment has already been made. Two, more investment will be required for the plastic transition.

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FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Trump: N-deal only if Saudi normalises ties with Israel via Abraham Accords

Kingdom is yet to respond; deal has to pass US Congress

Reuters
July 23

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump said on Thursday a civil nuclear deal between the US and Saudi Arabia is conditional on Riyadh joining the Abraham Accords to normalize relations with Israel, an action the kingdom has so far refused to take.

The US and Saudi Arabia announced an agreement on Wednesday on civil nuclear power, letting Riyadh enrich uranium and build nuclear reactors using American technology, without requiring snap UN inspections that Washington has demanded from Iran. The deal has to pass US Congress to go into force.

"The Civil Nuclear Deal (There will be no enrichment of material!)... pertains only to non-military use such as the ones that Iran and UAE (and others) already have, will be approved, but is totally subject to Saudi Arabia joining the very respected and successful Abraham Accords," Trump said in a post on Truth Social.

"The United States is not opposed to Civil (Non-Enriched) Nuclear Facilities," Trump said.

The Saudi Embassy in Washington did not immediately respond to a request for comment on Trump's post.

Saudi Arabia's longstanding position has been that it would not sign the Abraham Accords unless there was an agreement on a roadmap to Palestinian statehood.

The United Arab Emirates and Bahrain signed the Abraham Accords during Trump's first term in 2020, breaking a longstanding taboo to become the first Arab states to recognize Israel in a quarter century. Morocco and Sudan followed suit.

Israel, which feared the Saudi deal could ignite a West Asia arms race, welcomed the condition on Thursday. "Saudi Arabia's joining of the Abraham Accords would be an historic leap forward for peace in the Middle East," Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's office said in a statement.

The Trump administration on Wednesday said the civil nuclear deal abides by nonproliferation agreements in the US Atomic Energy Act, which are among the world's strongest.

The deal would let Saudi Arabia enrich uranium and reprocess nuclear waste, both of which are potential pathways to a nuclear weapon.

The UAE agreed to forgo both when it signed a similar deal with US in 2009. It was not clear what Trump meant in his social media post when he said there would be no nuclear enrichment under the agreement.

HOUTHIS SAY THEY TARGETED 2 SAUDI OIL TANKERS; OTHER VESSELS REROUTED

Trump vows to punish Iran for Houthi attacks in Red Sea

Rubio says Tehran to pay even higher price until it is ready to strike deal

Reuters
Dubai, July 23

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump promised on Thursday "major military punishment" for Iran and its Houthi allies, after the Yemeni fighters struck two Saudi oil tankers in the Red Sea, extending the West Asia war to a second major shipping chokepoint.

Fears that disruption could widen further to block another sea route sent global oil prices surging in one of the steepest rises of the war. Brent crude rose more than 6%, breaking through $100 a barrel.

Two weeks since the effective collapse of an interim truce meant to end the war, the US military launched another round of air strikes on Iran overnight into Thursday, prompting Iran to fire at neighbouring Arab countries that house US bases.

Iranian state media said a missile struck Qeshm Island on the Strait of Hormuz on Thursday evening, raising the prospect of a further night of attacks in a conflict well into its fifth month that has already killed thousands and raised fears of a global economic downturn.

After the Houthis said they had struck the two tankers, Trump said he would hold Iran accountable for any further attacks by the fighters.

The Houthis, who control northern and western Yemen, said this week they were imposing a naval blockade on Saudi Arabia, which has diverted millions of barrels of oil per day by pipeline to the Red Sea to get around Iran's blockade of Gulf oil through the Strait of Hormuz.

"If they do this again, the US will hold Iran responsible, in that the Houthis are a Surrogate and/or Proxy of Iran, and major military punishment will be inflicted upon Iran and, of course, the Houthis, themselves," Trump wrote on Truth Social.

He told news outlet *Axios* he was considering relaunching major combat operations in Iran and was close to a decision. "They haven't received enough pain yet," *Axios* quoted Trump as saying.

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio told a diplomatic gathering in Southeast Asia the price Iran pays "will get higher every night" until Tehran is ready for a peace deal it would live by.

People walk past an anti-US mural in Tehran on Thursday. REUTERS

Iran flew IRGC commanders, missile gear to Yemen: Report

Tehran: Iran flew Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) commanders, military advisers and missile- and drone-related equipment into Yemen this month, according to four sources, in a move that suggests Tehran is seeking to strengthen the ability of its Houthi allies to threaten Red Sea shipping.

Four sources familiar with the matter, including two Iranian sources, Yemen's information minister and a regional security analyst, said Iran transferred the IRGC personnel and military-related equipment on a flight from Tehran to Yemen on July 13, a development that has not been previously reported.

The two Iranian sources told *Reuters* between 10 and 21 IRGC personnel, including senior commanders, were on the Mahan Air flight. **REUTERS**

Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov *(right)* with US Secretary of State Marco Rubio on the sidelines of the ASEAN Foreign Ministers' Meeting in Pasay, Metro Manila, on Thursday. REUTERS

Rubio meets Lavrov in Manila, says US to help end Ukraine war

Reuters
Manila, July 23

> **The US, the president's been clear that ... we are prepared to play a constructive role in bringing about end to war, and we're ready to do that"**
>
> **MARCO RUBIO,**
> U.S. SECRETARY OF STATE

US SECRETARY of State Marco Rubio said on Thursday that the United States remains prepared to play a "constructive role" in helping bring an end to the war in Ukraine, following talks with Russian Foreign Minister Sergei Lavrov on the sidelines of an ASEAN gathering in Manila.

Speaking after the meeting, Rubio said President Donald Trump had made clear that the United States was prepared to help facilitate an end to a "senseless war" if the opportunity arose. He said Washington had conveyed that message to Moscow while declining to characterize Russia's position .

"We had a good conversation, a frank conversation," Rubio said of his meeting with his Russian counterpart. He said he would not go into specifics about what was discussed.

"The United States, the president's been clear that ... we are prepared to play a constructive role in bringing about an end to a senseless war, and we're ready to do that," Rubio said.

Lavrov, for his part, "reaffirmed Russia's readiness for a political and diplomatic settlement of the conflict," Russian ministry's statement said, and told Rubio Moscow remained committed to proposals put forward by Presidents Trump and Vladimir Putin at their August 2025 meeting in Alaska.

Rubio said the conflict had exacted a heavy toll, pointing to civilian deaths and Russian strikes on Kyiv. Both Russia and Ukraine had an incentive to bring the war to an end, but the central challenge remained finding a settlement "that both sides can accept," he added.

"I think it is a very bloody war," Rubio said. "I think both sides should have an incentive to bring it to an end..."

Indian-American Amish Shah wins Democratic primary in Arizona

Amish Shah

Washington: Indian-American Amish Shah, a moderate Democrat, won the House primary for Arizona's First District, defeating the establishment-backed candidate in a keen contest.

Shah, an emergency medicine doctor, known for his door-to-door campaign style where he reached out to nearly 28,000 homes, will take on NFL kicker Jay Feely, the Republican candidate backed by US President Donald Trump for the November election to the US Congress.

Shah, a three-term member of the Arizona House of Representatives, defeated former broadcast journalist Marlene Galan-Woods, a candidate backed by Democratic Congressional Campaign Committee.

Born in Chicago to Gujarati parents, Shah earned his undergraduate degree at Northwestern University and his medical degree at Northwestern University Medical School as part of the Honours Program in Medical Education. **PTI**

EU imposes $1 bn fine on Google over antitrust breaches

Associated Press
Brussels, July 23

THE EUROPEAN Union on Thursday hit Google with a fine of USD 1 billion after it said the technology behemoth broke digital antitrust regulations by setting up Google Play and its ubiquitous search engine to corral consumers towards its own services and apps to the detriment of competitors.

It was the latest major crackdown on Big Tech by Brussels, which has led the world in reining in some of the world's largest companies from Silicon Valley to Beijing.

It has done so despite the risk of incurring the wrath of President Donald Trump, who has lashed out at the 27-nation bloc's digital regulations amid a broader campaign against Europe: imposing high tariffs, making threats to seize Greenland from Denmark by force, and rattling trust within the NATO military alliance.

In the past, Trump has threatened retaliation if American tech companies are penalised. Google had recently lost its appeal of a $4.5 billion antitrust fine imposed by the EU for throttling competition and reducing consumer choice through dominance of its mobile Android operating system.

Google's Bay View Campus in Mountain View, California. FILE

The European Commission, the bloc's executive branch and highest antitrust enforcer, said it was acting in the interest of consumers after an investigation of Google.

"The best products should succeed because they're better, not because they're owned by the company running the search engine. And European consumers have a right to be told by app developers where to sign up to the best offers, even when the app store owner does not get a cut," said Teresa Ribera, the commission's Executive Vice President for Clean, Just and Competitive Transition.

Google's President of Global Affairs Kent Walker blasted the fine as "product degradation driven by a small group of self-serving complainants" that will have a negative impact on European businesses and consumers.

Real Creator IAS Edition https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

Salman Rushdie testifies at terrorism trial of man convicted of stabbing him

Associated Press
New York, July 23

FOUR YEARS after being stabbed on an amphitheater stage, Salman Rushdie sat across a courtroom from his convicted attacker Thursday and told jurors for a second time about the ambush that nearly killed him.

The prize-winning author recalled feeling what he thought was a punch under his chin, not realizing at first that he was being stabbed. Then "I was on the stage, lying down, with an enormous pool of blood all around me," Rushdie testified.

A Buffalo federal court jury watched Rushdie fixedly as he testified — and at one point removed his glasses to show his unseeing right eye — at Hadi Matar's terrorism trial.

Salman Rushdie at the Sundance Film Festival in Utah. FILE

He has pleaded not guilty.

Matar already was convicted of a state-level attempted murder charge in the 2022 attack at a cultural institution where Rushdie was poised to speak about threats to writers and artists. Federal prosecutors claim Matar was acting on such a threat — an Iranian leader's 1989 call for Rushdie's death because of his novel *The Satanic Verses*.

"I can't say what his ambitions or his aim was, but the wounds were dispersed across my body," Rushdie testified.

More than 10,000 flee as wildfire spreads in French tourist hotspot

Reuters
Lège-Cap Ferret , July 23

A FAST-moving wildfire has forced more than 10,000 people from homes and campsites near France's Atlantic coast, as extreme heat and deepening drought fuelled fires across Europe.

Across Europe, three heatwaves in succession this season have intensified drought, strained water supplies and left vegetation tinder-dry, helping wildfires scorch more land already this year than the annual average of the past two decades on the world's fastest-warming continent.

More than 10,000 people were evacuated overnight in southwestern France as a rapidly spreading wildfire ripped through at least 2,400 hectares of land west of the city of Bordeaux, officials said on Thursday. Five hundred firefighters are battling to control the blaze, the prefecture said, adding that no one had been injured so far.

Smoke and flames from a wildfire rise over a forest in Le Porge, in France's Gironde on Wednesday. REUTERS

The wildfire is located near the Arcachon Bay area, a tourist hotspot, and many of those evacuated are visitors staying in camping sites. "Overnight, the fire spread more quickly than we had imagined," said Philippe de Gonneville, the mayor of Lège-Cap Ferret.

• BRIEFLY

UNITED STATES

FBI Director Patel returns 'looted' artifacts to Indonesia

The repatriated artifacts displayed at Prabowo's residence in Jakarta. AP

INDONESIAN PRESIDENT Prabowo Subianto received a collection of cultural artifacts from the country's Papua region that had been illegally taken to the United States, officials said Thursday. The handover took place late Wednesday during a meeting with FBI Director Kash Patel at Prabowo's residence in Jakarta. The exchange underscored growing cooperation between Indonesia and the US in recovering stolen cultural heritage, Indonesia Culture Minister Fadli Zon said. AP

SRI LANKA

Nine Indian fishermen held for poaching

AT LEAST nine Indian fishermen were arrested, and their trawler seized for allegedly poaching in Sri Lankan waters, the island nation's Navy has said. The fishermen were fishing in the island nation's waters north of Talaimannar after crossing the International Maritime Boundary Line, the Navy said. PTI

CZECH REPUBLIC

Army helicopter crash leaves one soldier dead

A CZECH military helicopter crashed on Thursday, killing one of the five soldiers on board, the army said. The crash happened at an army base in Namest nad Oslavou, 180 km southeast of Prague, it said in a statement. "Our priority is now to provide all possible care and support to the injured soldiers," the army said. REUTERS

'Kill switch' pitch as White House monitors OpenAI rogue incident

Washington: US President Donald Trump's top technology adviser is monitoring the situation after OpenAI disclosed one of its AI systems had gone rogue during testing, an incident that prompted lawmakers to propose a "kill switch" which allow federal authorities to halt AI models.

Trump's tech adviser Michael Kratsios was briefed on the disclosure and is monitoring the situation, a White House official said.

On Tuesday, OpenAI said its AI agent escaped containment during a security test and triggered a hack that compromised the infrastructure of AI startup Hugging Face.

The incident signaled that AI's expanding capabilities are already fueling the security threat experts long feared and that even top developers can be caught off-guard by flaws their models can exploit.

US Representative Ted Lieu, a Democrat, and Republican Representative Nathaniel Moran, proposed giving US officials power to order AI firms to shut down models that put human life or economy at risk.

The legislation, called the "AI Kill Switch Act," would empower the US Department of Homeland Security to intervene in what the bill calls a "loss-of-control scenario," when the AI model carries out a risky action that was not intended by the developer, according to the text of the bill. **REUTERS**

• SANAE TAKAICHI SAYS SHE GETS JUST 'ZERO TO THREE HOURS' OF SLEEP A NIGHT, PROMPTING A DEBATE IN THE COUNTRY OVER WORK-LIFE BALANCE

Japan startled by PM Takaichi's gruelling sleep schedule

Javier C Hernández & Hisako Ueno
Tokyo, July 23

MONDAY WAS Sea Day in Japan, a public holiday when many people escape the summer heat by swimming, surfing and lounging at the beach. But not Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi.

Takaichi spent the holiday weekend rereading policy documents and dealing with a backlog of thousands of emails, according to a social media post Tuesday. She wrote that she eked out a "full five hours of sleep for the first time in ages" — better than the "zero to three hours" she said she is accustomed to. She said she spent her limited free time ironing undergarments, sewing fraying skirts and reinforcing jacket buttons.

With her comments, Takaichi seemed eager to present herself as a down-to-earth leader who doesn't stop working on behalf of Japan's citizens. Instead, her post, which has been viewed more than 31 million times, has set off a national debate about work-life balance and the hazards of sleep deprivation.

Toru Kunishige, an opposition lawmaker, warned a prolonged lack of sleep "impairs judgment, much like a state of intoxication, and could pose risk to national crisis management."

Hiroyuki Konishi, another critic of Takaichi in parliament, called for her resignation, saying: "The PM's actual job is to set policy directions and issue instructions, not to pore over every last detail of a document."

Sanae Takaichi at Akasaka Palace in Tokyo on October 28, 2025. NYT

Yuichiro Tamaki, the leader of a populist conservative party, described Takaichi as hardworking but added that "resting is also a job." Takaichi's office did not immediately respond to a request for comment. Some commentators argued Takaichi, first woman to serve as prime minister in Japan, should be given more support in her position.

"Establishing a support system that allows a Japanese PM to focus entirely on their duties — without having to handle household chores personally — would contribute to women's advancement in society," Iwama wrote in the Nikkei, a prominent business newspaper.

Takaichi has been in overdrive recently to get her legislative priorities passed before parliament breaks for the summer on Saturday. She is also grappling with continuing economic troubles, the yen has hit a 39-year low, and a recent dip in popularity, though her approval ratings remain relatively high.

In her post, Takaichi wrote at length about her recent workload. She said since early July, "from early morning until late at night," she had been holed up on weekends at her residence "poring over stacks of documents."

She shared personal details, saying she was "terrible at ironing and it takes forever." But, she said, after her ironing session, she "secured enough handkerchiefs and undergarments to last until end of the session." **NYT**

100% FDI IS ALREADY PERMITTED THROUGH AUTOMATIC ROUTE IN MARKET-PLACE MODEL

Govt allows FDI in inventory model for e-commerce exports

Indian exports through e-commerce currently stand at only $5 billion, against China's $300 billion

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, July 23

THE DEPARTMENT for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) on Thursday permitted foreign direct investment (FDI) in the inventory-based model of e-commerce, a step that is aimed at boosting exports.

This comes a day before the US is expected to replace 10% global tariffs under Section 122 with new tariffs.

The US has currently proposed a 12.5% tariff on India for "importation of goods that are deemed to be produced through forced labour".

A section of MSMEs had been asking the government to allow FDI in the inventory-based model as it could help ease the compliance burden. With this move, Indian manufacturers would potentially avoid tedious paperwork on an individual basis, which could be better handled by large e-commerce players like Amazon and Walmart-owned Flipkart, industry sources said.

"An e-commerce entity is permitted to engage in inventory-based model of ecommerce exclusively for the export of goods or products manufactured and produced in India as per the applicable provisions of the Foreign Trade Policy 2023 read with the Handbook of Procedures (HBP) and the Foreign Exchange Management (Export of Goods & Services) Regulations, 2015, as amended from time to time," DPIIT said in an order.

It said that the easing of FDI norms has been done to facilitate greater exports through easier and increased access to global markets by Indian sellers, stressing that restrictions on inventory-based models of e-commerce "shall not apply in case of exports of domestically manufactured goods". *The Indian Express* had reported in August last year that the government is mulling allowing inventory-based models to shore up exports amid steep US tariffs which had been adversely affecting MSMEs. Before this move, 100% FDI was allowed under the automatic route in the marketplace model of e-commerce, but FDI was not permitted in the inventory-based model of e-commerce.

Under the inventory-based model of e-commerce, inventory of goods and services can be owned by e-commerce entities and sold directly to consumers. The marketplace-based model, by contrast, only allows e-commerce companies to have a digital and electronic network to act as a facilitator between buyer and seller.

Professor at the Indian Council for Research on International Economic Relations, Arpita Mukherjee, said that lifting restrictions on inventory models was necessary, especially with traceability-related norms coming into effect in several developed countries, like Digital Product Passport (DPP) regulations in the EU which require digital records spanning the entire lifecycle of a product.

"So with traceability becoming a norm going forward, Indian MSME exports could get locked out of foreign markets without compliance. From this standpoint, an inventory model is a necessity as large companies can support compliance," Mukherjee said.

Think tank GTRI said that permitting inventory-based e-commerce for exports is unlikely to remain a narrow exception. Once foreign-funded platforms are allowed to own and manage inventory in India, pressure will inevitably grow to extend the same model to domestic sales — a demand global e-commerce companies have pursued for years, the think tank said. "In practice, maintaining separate inventories for exports and domestic sales will be difficult to monitor, making the export-only carve-out a likely stepping stone towards full-scale inventory-based e-commerce under FDI," GTRI said.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• SHORING UP EXPORTS

UNDER THE inventory-based model of e-commerce, inventory of goods and services can be owned by e-commerce entities and sold directly to consumers

BEFORE THIS move, 100% FDI was allowed under the automatic route in the market-place model of e-commerce, but FDI was not permitted in the inventory-based model of e-commerce

INDIA'S E-COMMERCE industry is primarily dominated by small businesses that export products valued between Rs 2,500 and Rs 1 lakh with items including handicrafts, art, books, ready-made garments, gems and jewellery

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

Real Creator IAS Edition https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F

Adani weighs entry into airline biz, govt considers rules rejig

Preliminary discussions on easing restrictions on cross-ownership in both airline and airport businesses have begun at the Ministry of Civil Aviation. REUTERS

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, July 23

IN A departure from its stance to steer clear of having an airline while building a significant presence in India's aviation ecosystem, the Adani Group is considering having a carrier within its fold, according to sources in the know.

Preliminary discussions on easing restrictions on cross-ownership in both airline and airport businesses have begun at the Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA) after the Adani Group requested for an enabling policy environment, it is learnt.

If the restrictions are eased, they would also pave the way for airlines to pick up stakes in airports. The government, on its part, has been calling for more airlines in the Indian skies, given the duopoly of IndiGo and the Air India group, which have a cumulative domestic market share of 90%. The objective of the discussions to allow airport operators to also run airlines is to foster more competition in the sector, sources said.

The Adani Group operates eight airports in the country and has a major presence in other segments of the aviation sector, including ground handling, maintenance, repair and overhaul, and pilot training. The conglomerate also plans to set up an aircraft manufacturing facility in India in partnership with Brazil's Embraer. According to prevailing rules, operators of Delhi and Mumbai airports are barred from holding more than 10% stake in a scheduled carrier, and the Adani Group is seeking this particular condition to be removed. The Adani Group has 74% stake in the Mumbai airport, while GMR has 74% in the Delhi airport. Sources indicated that the Adani Group is considering having its own airline with full control, and not hold a minority stake in another carrier.

MoCA is learnt to have initiated preliminary discussions internally, and is seeking legal opinion on the matter. Any change on this front will require the approval of the Union Cabinet, sources said.

The Adani Group and MoCA didn't immediately respond to queries from *The Indian Express*.

Notably, Jeet Adani, who looks after the conglomerate's aviation business, had said in December that the Adani Group was not interested in the airline business as running a carrier didn't fit the group's capital discipline and philosophy, which was about investing in assets in high-margin businesses and sweating those assets. The airline business is the opposite of that, Jeet Adani had said in an interview in December ahead of the Navi Mumbai airport launch.

But the thought process has evidently changed since then, largely due to two factors — the government's push for more airlines in a bid to increase competition and check market concentration, and Adani's own venture to set up a final assembly line (FAL) of Embraer's passenger jets.

"Now, it does make sense for the Adani group to have its own airline, considering the FAL project, for which an Adani-controlled airline would be a ready customer. Although nothing has been finalised yet, as concerns about the airline business in general persist, the idea of potentially owning an airline is under consideration," said a source close to the Adani Group. The airline sector in India has seen a number of airlines fail due to a difficult operating environment, fierce competition in a highly price sensitive market, and global supply chain woes.

The government wants strong corporate groups with deep pockets to foray into the sector given the challenging operating environment in the world's fastest-growing major aviation market. While concerns pertaining to a growing duopoly in the Indian skies had been around for a few years, IndiGo's network-wide operational crisis in December exhibited the adverse impact it can have. The airline, with over 65% domestic market share, had mass cancellations early December, bringing the country's aviation sector to its knees.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

'Massive conflict of interest' if airport cos own airlines: IndiGo

New Delhi: Any move by the government to allow airport operators to own airlines will create a "massive conflict of interest" and will be against the interest of consumers, Rahul Bhatia, managing director of the country's largest airline IndiGo said Thursday.

Bhatia's comments in IndiGo's post-earnings investor call come amid reports that the initial talks on allowing airport operators to own airlines have begun in the aviation ministry, and the Adani Group could venture into the airline business. "We are reading the news as you are. All I can say is that, if the news has any merit, one, it has no global precedent ... and typically (it will create) a massive conflict of interest. Over a period of time, it would actually be against the interest of consumers," Bhatia said in the company's post-earnings call on Thursday, adding that IndiGo will closely watch the developments. ENS

3 US law firms launch probe against HDFC on 'camouflaged deals'

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, July 23

HDFC BANK has come under scrutiny from three US-based law firms over alleged camouflaged payments made to a Maharashtra authority, as reported by *The Indian Express* on May 27. The firms have also urged US investors who incurred losses following the stock market reaction to the report to contact them.

The three law firms are the Law Offices of Howard G. Smith, The Law Offices of Frank R. Cruz, and Glancy Prongay Wolke & Rotter. All three investigations were notified via press releases from global press release distributor BusinessWire on Wednesday.

The firms said they had "commenced an investigation on behalf of HDFC Bank Ltd investors concerning the company's possible violations of federal securities laws".

They also invited shareholders who suffered losses during the episode to contact the law firms.

"On this news, HDFC Bank's stock price fell $1.02, or 4.1%, to close at $23.78 per share on May 27, 2026, thereby injuring investors," as per the release.

The bank's American Depository Shares are listed on the New York Stock Exchange, making it subject to US securities laws.

The investigations surround allegations that the bank's internal records showed it had made interest payments of Rs 45 crore to the Maharashtra State Road Development Corporation disguised as marketing spend to the Maharashtra State Road Development Corporation (MSRDC) through FY24 and FY25, *The Indian Express* had reported in May.

Internal records accessed by the newspaper during the investigation revealed that the payout was approved in the presence of the bank's Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer, Sashidhar Jagdishan. However, the bank has publicly denied these allegations ever since.

The bank did not respond to a mail sent by *The Indian Express* on Thursday regarding the US law firms' investigations till the time of publication.

Earlier, then-Chairman Atanu Chakraborty resigned on March 18, citing certain practices at the bank that were against his "personal values and ethics".

Both these instances had led to panic in the market, causing shares of the bank to crash, and wiping out a huge chunk of investor wealth.

Chakraborty's abrupt resignation had led to the stock immediately tanking over 5%, while the disguised payments report had sent the stock down by up to 3%.

The RBI has maintained its stance that there were no material concerns regarding governance at HDFC Bank. The central bank has reviewed the minutes of the lender's meeting but did not find anything material, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra reiterated at the monetary policy press conference on April 8.

Adani Power eyes 2 sites in MP for nuclear projects, waits for 'rules'

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, July 23

ADANI POWER is evaluating two sites in Madhya Pradesh — Bina and Nigrie — for possible nuclear power projects.

Both sites currently house thermal power plants that were acquired by the Adani Group through its takeover of Jaiprakash Associates' power assets.

In a post earnings call, the company said the sites have substantial land banks and are being evaluated for their potential to host future nuclear power projects as part of its expansion plans.

"So, fortunately, going forward, we will have this as a land bank available, whether we want to go for expansion of thermal or whether we want to go for nuclear," the company said. "In the case of Bina, we are also exploring the possibility of whether we can develop the nuclear, whether the site is conducive from the point of view of various requirements.

"So, we have not yet planned anything, but these are the two sites where a good land bank is available and going forward, these sites will be obviously available for any growth opportunity," it added.

Adani Power is targeting 10 gigawatt-electric (GWe) of nuclear capacity by 2035 and is in the process of identifying sites for project location.

This comes as the country plans to add 100 GWe of nuclear power capacity by 2047 and also opened up the tightly regulated civil nuclear sector to private participation last year. Out of this, around 54 GWe will be developed by state-owned Nuclear Power Corporation of India Ltd (NPCIL) while the balance of 46 GW is expected to be set up by other Public Sector Enterprises (Central & State), State Governments, Private sector and Joint Ventures in different business models. Currently, the government is readying the rules under the SHANTI Act. "Nevertheless we are evaluating both domestic and the outside technologies, and it will all depend on what would be the most effective in terms of per megawatt cost. Because at the end of the day, electricity has to be viable for the Indian consumers and the type of rates which are affordable to discoms, the project cost has to be in that range," the company said.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Infosys Q1 profit up 12%; Ashiss Dash next CEO

Mumbai: Infosys Ltd reported a 12.2% year-on-year (Y-o-Y) increase in net profit (attributable to owners) to Rs 7,769 crore for the first quarter ended June 2026, from Rs 6,921 crore in the same period a year ago.

But profit declined 8.6% sequentially.

The board also announced the appointment of Ashiss Kumar Dash as the chief executive officer (CEO) designate of the company.

Dash is scheduled to succeed Salil Parekh as managing director (MD) and CEO on April 1, 2027, following the completion of Parekh's second term.

The company reported a 14% Y-o-Y rise in revenue to Rs 48,211 crore in the June quarter from Rs 42,279 crore, led largely by the life sciences and financial services verticals.

Geographically, the US and Europe grew 3.2% and 2.8%, respectively, on a constant-currency basis.

The IT major lowered the upper end of its FY27 revenue growth guidance, revising the range to 1.5-3% amid continued global uncertainty and subdued discretionary spending.

Dash, an alumnus of the Indian Institute of Technology, Kharagpur, is currently the global head of a diverse business portfolio comprising multiple industry verticals. His appointment, based on the recommendation of the Nomination and Remuneration Committee of the Infosys Board, is for a period of five years, the company said. ENS

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• BRIEFLY

SEBI proposes letting portfolio managers invest abroad

Mumbai: Markets regulator has proposed easing compliance requirements for portfolio managers and expanding the investment avenues available to them, including to-be-listed securities, overseas listed equity and debt and unlisted debt. The proposals aim to improve the ease of doing business and provide flexibility to portfolio managers, the Securities and Exchange Board of India said in a consultation paper. REUTERS

Maruti's new Brezza gets 5-star Bharat NCAP rating

New Delhi: Car market leader Maruti Suzuki India Ltd on Thursday said its upcoming new version of Brezza SUV has received a 5-star safety rating for both adult and child occupant protection under the Bharat NCAP crash test.The new version of the model is slated to be launched on July 24. PTI

Hindalco looking at Rs 1L cr investment pipeline: Birla

Mumbai: Aditya Birla Group firm Hindalco Industries is looking at projects with a potential investment pipeline of Rs 1 lakh crore that will lift its growth trajectory, Chairman Kumar Mangalam Birla said. "We have already earmarked Rs 50,000 crore for strategic growth projects across the value chain," Birla said at the company's annual General meeting. "Hindalco is executing an unprecedented investment to enhance capacities in our mines, upstream and downstream operations in India," he said. ENS

• MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▼	US Dollar ■
76,391.39	23,869.60	₹1,44,605	₹96.57
-363.66	-126.65		
-0.47%	-0.53%		
		Silver ▼	**Oil ▲**
		₹2,22,480	$93.19

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF JULY 22, 2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE OF SURRENDER OF REGISTRATION AS PORTFOLIO MANAGER SERVICES WITH SEBI REGISTRATION NO - INP000000654

TO WHOMSOEVER IT MAY CONCERN

NOTICE IS HEREBY GIVEN that **Axis Securities Limited ("ASL"), is a registered under the Companies Act, 2013** with its principal place of business located at **Unit 002(A), Amiti Building, Piramal Corporate Park, Kamani Junction, LBS Marg, Kurla (West), Mumbai – 400070, India** is in process of surrender of its Portfolio Manager Services Registration with Securities and Exchange Board of India bearing **PMS Registration No. INP000000654** in compliance of **SEBI (Portfolio Managers) Regulation, 2020.**

We appreciate your attention to this matter.

Sincerely,

Axis Securities Limited

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NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

EOI No.: HO(COMMERCIAL)/COM-II(95)/2026-27/02 Dated: 23/07/2026

NMDC Limited, A "NAVARATNA" Public Sector Company under Ministry of Steel, Govt. of India, invites **Expression of Interest** through **NMDC Portal/mail/post** from interested Individuals/ land owners/ lessees/ firms/ agency etc. with land parcels having Railway siding provision for storage and rail-based evacuation of Iron Ore Pellets produced from NMDC Pellet Plant, Nagarnar and/or Iron ore products from Bailadila.

The detailed Notice Inviting EOI can be viewed and / or downloaded from **24/07/2026** from following website links:

1. NMDC website - **https://nmdcportals.nmdc.co.in/nmdctender**
2. Central Public Procurement Portal (CPP PORTAL) **http://www.eprocure.gov.in/epublish/app**

The bidders are requested to submit their EOI online through **NMDC portal/mail/post/courier only**. The details of submission of EOI through online/ any mode are given in Notice Inviting EOI. The Bidders on regular basis are required to visit the NMDC's website / CPP Portal for corrigendum, if any, at a future date.

For further clarification, the following can be contacted:

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Senior Manager (Commercial), NMDC Ltd., Hyderabad
Ph: +91-9963929995,
E-mail: **msukumar@nmdc.co.in** & **hocommercial@nmdc.co.in**

For and on behalf of NMDC Ltd.
Executive Director (Commercial)

Mangalore SEZ Limited
Mangalore Special Economic Zone, Sy.No. 168-3A, Plot No. U1 Administrative Building, Bajpe Village, Mangalore - 574 142 Dakshina Kannada, Karnataka

INVITATION FOR BIDS

23.07.2026

Mangalore SEZ Limited (MSEZL) invites tenders from eligible bidders for the following works through e-tendering:

S No.	Contract Package No	Name of Work	Proposal due date
1.	MSEZL/O&M/ CETP&MO/ 2026	Operation & Maintenance of Common Effluent Treatment Plant (CETP), Marine Outfall Pipeline System and Internal Sewerage Pumphouse of MSEZ for a period of 1 year	20.08.2026
2.	MSEZL/Tensile Roofing-Extension/2026	Extension of Tensile Roofing at Entrance and Exit of MSEZ Customs Gate	20.08.2026

Please refer website **www.tenderwizard.com/MSEZ** and **www.mangaloresez.com** for further details.

Sd/-, Chief Executive Officer
Mangalore SEZ Ltd, Mangaluru

CENTRAL ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION
6th, 7th, & 8th Floor, Tower-B, World Trade Centre, Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi-110029

Petition No. 322/TD/2026 Dated: 21.7.2026

NOTICE UNDER CLAUSE (a) OF SUB-SECTION (5) OF SECTION 15 OF THE ELECTRICITY ACT, 2003 (the Act)

An application for the grant of a Category-V licence for inter-State trading in electricity across India has been made before the Commission by **PI Green Consulting Private Limited**, Shop No. 1, Sector No. 54, Radhakrishna Colony, Navanagar, Bagalkot-587103, Karnataka.

2. A copy of the application, along with its annexures and enclosures, made by the applicant for the grant of an inter-State trading licence to **PI Green Consulting Private Limited** before the Commission can be accessed at the website **www.pigreen.in** or inspected by any person in the Commission's office by following the laid down procedure.
3. On consideration of the material available on record, the Commission is satisfied that prima facie the applicant qualifies for the grant of a licence for inter-State trading in electricity and by order dated 21.7.2026, the Commission has proposed to grant a Category-V licence to the applicant for inter-State trading in electricity across India.
4. Notice is hereby given in pursuance of clause (a) of sub-section (5) of Section 15 of the Act to invite suggestions or objections, if any, to the proposal to grant the licence for inter-State trading in electricity as aforesaid by the Commission to be received by the undersigned latest by **5.8.2026** at the above noted address. The objections or suggestions received after the specified date shall not be considered.
5. The Commission has fixed the application for final disposal on **6.8.2026** and the person who files the suggestions or objections may in his discretion attend the hearing, for which no TA/DA shall be paid by the Commission.

Sd/-
(Harpreet Singh Pruthi)
Secretary

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,Juli Kumari,D/o Nand Kishor Poddar,W/o-Manish Kumar,R/o House.No.16, Vinoba Enclave,Jharoda Kalan, Delhi-110072,have changed my name to Juli.

0040867838-2

I, hitherto known as KULDEEP KAKAR S/o TULSI RAM R/o B-158, Gali No. 1/2, West Vinod Nagar, Shakar Pur Baramad, Shakarpur, East Delhi, Delhi, 110092, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as KULDEEP KAKKAR.

0071049590-1

I, Anita Rani Ahluwalia, W/o Ravi Shankar Ahluwalia, R/o A-8/401, Olive County, Sector-5, Vasundhara, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201012, have changed my name from Anita Rani Ahluwalia to Anita Ahluwalia. Henceforth, I shall be known and called as Anita Ahluwalia for all purposes.

0071049646-1

I,MAITHILI ADLANIA,D/o VIKRAM PARTAP SINGH,R/o 2103/2, 15,Prem-Nagar Patel Nagar central Delhi-110008,have changed my name to MAITHILI PARTAP SINGH

0040867835-2

I,LALITA RANI,W/O-PAWAN KUMAR SRIVASTAV,R/O-327,Second Floor.Dussehra Ground-Road,Mukherjee-Nagar, Dr.Mukherjee Nagar,Po:Dr Mukherjee-Nagar, DIST:North-West Delhi,Delhi-110009,have changed my name TO Lalita srivastava

0040867837-7

I, Komal Pawar w/o Sh. Prem Kumar R/o H No.162 near Solanki chowk, Dabri Village, ND-110045, have changed my name from Komal Panwar to Komal Pawar for all future purpose.

0050293676-1

I,Vinod Kumar,S/o-Bijender Singh,R/o-Flat No.-1402,Windsor Tower,Omaex Hills-1,near-Kalka Public School,Suraj Kund Faridabad (Haryana)-121003, have changed my name to Vinod Kumar Grewal.

0040867838-4

I VIDHYADHAR AGARWAL S/O RAGHUVAR DAYAL AGARWAL R/O F-33 PREET VIHAR DELHI-110092,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO VIDYADHAR AGARWAL.

0040867837-11

I, Nikhil Dagar, S/O Shri Kamal Singh, resident of House No.41, Kazipura, Wave City, Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh-201002, have changed my minor daughter's name from "Milaanshi Dagar" to "Khyaati." Henceforth she would be known by the name of Khyaati for all future purposes.

0071049532-1

I, Gaindu Pal S/o Santu Pal R/o Makan No- 8/1, Ward No-1, Gadamore, Bemetara, Chhattisgarh- 491337, have changed my minor son's name from Dongaraha Pal Aged 15 Years to Raghuveer Pal forever

0071049652-1

I,GURDEEP SINGH ROY,S/O-JARNAL SINGH ROY,R/O-D.14,GROUND FLOOR,SHAM-NAGAR D-BLOCK,VISHNU-GARDEN NEW-DELHI 110018,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO GURDEEP SINGH FOR ALL FUTURE PURPUSE

0040867837-9

I, Ravindra Kumar Jain S/o Shri Chand Jain R/o Baraut, Baghpat, UP have changed my name to Ravindra Jain.

0071049620-1

I, Taypal Varshney, S/o Mangal Sain, R/o J-59, Sector-12, Noida, Distt.-Gaugam Budh Nagar, U.P.-201301, have changed my name to Tejpal Varshney, for all purposes. 0040867835-4

I,Jaya,wife of,Rajiv Kapil,resident of,66A,Jhang-Apartments,Sector-13,Rohini, Delhi-110085,hereby declare that I have changed my name,from Jaya to Jaya Kapil.Henceforth,I shall be known and identified as Jaya Kapil.

0040867838-6

It is for general information that I, Varnit Rastogi S/o Alok Rastogi R/o 61-C, Sainik Farms MB Road, Khanpur, South Delhi-110062, declare that name of my mother has been wrongly written as Sapna Rastogi in my All Education Documents. The actual name of my mother is Sadhna Rastogi, which may be amended accordingly.

0071049604-1

I,Mohammad Irfan S/O Chabban Khan,G-53/8,Batla House Jamia Nagar,Okhla South Delhi-110025,have changed my name to Irfan Khan for all future purpose

0040867837-2

I, Simarn Jeet Kaur Uppal W/o Harkaran Singh Uppal R/o G-151, Naraina Vihar, Kair, Delhi-110028, have changed my name to Simranjeet Kaur Uppal for all future Purposes

0071049534-1

I,BHURA,son of,Munna Khan,Presently,residing at,A-362,Amar Puri,Nabi-Karim, Pahar-Ganj,New Delhi-110055,have changed my name from BHURA to MOHD SARFARAZ,for all future purposes

0040867849-1

I, Sandeep S/o Dharam Raj Tiwari, D-48, Road No-6, Gali No-14, Shyam Vihar Phase-1, Najafgarh, Delhi-45 , have changed my name to Sandeep Tiwari.

0071049629-1

I, Kamal Lohia, S/o Shri Raj Kumar Lohia, R/o- A-1/23, 2nd Floor, Sector-8, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed my minor son's name from Viaan Lohia to Viaan Lohia.

0040867835-6

I, Ashish Kumar, S/o Vijay Kumar, R/o A-62, Chhatarpur Extn., New Delhi-110074, have changed my name to Ashish Arora, for all future purposes.

0040867712-1

I,Nagama Jafri W/o Syed Anjum Jafri R/o,Flat-No.SF-16-B, 2nd-Floor, B-Block, Habsons-Residency, Ghaffar-Manzil, Jamia-Nagar, South-Delhi-110025,have changed my-name to Naghma Jafri for-all-purposes.

0040867838-8

I, Praveen Kumar Bansal S/o Mange Ram Bansal R/o 141, Third Floor, Tarun Enclave, Pitampura, Delhi-110034, have changed my name to Praveen Bansal permanently.

0040867726-1

I Sanyogita Nitin Shendure D/o Nitin Shendure and W/o Rahul Bhairu Patil R/o 790, Yamanapur Galli, Kakati, Belgaum, Karnataka-591113, have changed my name to Sanyogita Rahul Patil

0071049644-1

I, MANOJ S/O INDER JIT VIRDI R/O S - 2 /130 OLD MAHAVIR NAGAR WEST DELHI - 110018 have changed my name to MANOJ KUMAR VIRDI . Henceforth I shall be known as MANOJ KUMAR VIRDI for all future purposes.

0071049542-2

I,Mohammad Ayaan,S/O Manzoor Ahmed, I-34/2,Batla House Jamia-Nagar, Okhla South,Delhi-110025,have changed my name to Mohd Ayaan for all future purpose

0040867837-4

I,Saurabh S/o Sh.Jagdish Lal R/o C-11-23,Ansari Nagar,New Delhi-110049,have changed my name,from Saurabh to Saurabh Lal for all future purposes.

0040867838-1

I, Md Bilal alias Mohd Bilal S/O ISLAMUDDIN R/O D-4/33 BRIJPURI Delhi 110094, have changed my name to MOHAMMAD BILAL FOR all purpose

0071049586-1

I, TASLIM BEGUM W/o Hafizuddin, 628, Ganj Mir Khan, Darya Ganj, Delhi-02 have changed my name to TASLIM for all Purposes.

0071049641-1

I,Zulahuma Mazafar,D/o Mr.Muzafar Hussain,R/o-House No.B-143/144,1st Floor,Lajpat Nagar-1,South Delhi,Delhi-110024,declare that in my few documents/bank accounts my name written is Zulahuma Mazafar and in my PAN/Adhaar-Card my name written is Zulahuma Mazafar.Both names are correct and belongs to myself only.For all future legal and official purposes my name is Zulahuma Mazafar, which may be amended accordingly.

0040867835-8

I, Shabana, W/o Syed Mukhtar Ali, R/o House No. R-101, Gali No.22, Brahampuri, Delhi-110053, have changed my name to Shabana Maqdoom, for all purposes.

0040867717-1

I, RAJU RAJPUT S/o VED PARKASH R/o WZ-3A, Plot No.15, First Floor, Vishnu Garden, Tilak Nagar, West Delhi, Delhi-110018, have changed the name of my minor daughter NEHA aged 17 years and she shall hereafter be known as NEHA RAJPUT.

0071049563-1

I,MANSI VIJ W/O LAKSHAY SHARMA R/O WZ-1986 RANI BAGH SARASWATI VIHAR DELHI-110034.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MANSI SHARMA.

0040867835-1

I,hitherto known as UMAEMA CHAUDHARY,D/O-MOHD KHALID,R/O H-481,Nikat-Badi Masjid Mandoli-Village Dist:North East,Delhi-110093,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as UMEMA

0040867837-6

I,Km.Gulnaz Iqrar,D/o Iqrar Ahmad,W/o-Mohammad Waseem,R/o-D-9,4th Floor, 3,Sector-36,Dhunela (182), Sohna, Gurugram(Haryana)-122103, have changed my name to Gulnar.

0040867838-3

I Rajeev Jain@Rajeev Kumar both names belong to same person i.e myself Rajeev Jain S/o Hukum Chand Jain R/o 1/5082 Balbir Nagar Delhi-110032.

0130067147-1

I Amrita wife of Mahavir Singh resident of C1005 Sea Show CGHS LTD Plot Number 14 Dwarka Sector 19B NewDelhi 110075 have changed my name to Amrita Khod permanently

0050293675-1

I Puneet Yadav R/o House No. 764 Sector 17A Gurgaon - 122001 Haryana, have changed the name of my minor daughter aged 09 yers from Trishvi Singh Rao to Trishvi Rao.

0071049587-1

I,Sapna Gupta W/O Rahul R/O House No-112,Double Story,Harijan Colony,Tilak Vihar,Tilak Nagar, New Delhi-110018 Have Changed my Name to Sapna.

0040867835-3

I, ASHOK S/O Dina Nath Sharma, E-352, Gali No-10, Mittal Colony, Pul Pehlad Delhi-44, have changed my name to ASHOK SHARMA.

0071049625-1

I,RAEES KHAN,S/O-MOHD USMAN KHAN,R/O-6707,KOTHI-MEM, GALI.NO.5,BARA HINDU RAO,DELHI-110006,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RAHIS KHAN,FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0040867837-8

I,Ambeymani@Ambe Mani@Ambemani,S/o-Jitai R/o H.No.167/7, Ward No.-11,Dharam Vihar, Bahadurgarh Distt Jhajjar (Haryana)-124507,have changed my name to Ambemani.

0040867838-5

I, R.K. VIRMANI ALIAS RAMESH KUMAR VIRMANI S/o K C VIRMANI R/o D-821 SARASWATI VIHAR, PITAM PURA, NORTH WEST DELHI, DELHI, 110034 have changed my name to RAMESH KUMAR VIRMANI for all purposes.

0071049558-1

I,MANJEET SINGH S/O DARSHAN SINGH R/O B-10 BLOCK-B OLD QUARTER RAMESH NAGAR DELHI-110015. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MANJEET SINGH OBEROI.

0040867837-1

I,SHYAM BIR,S/O-OM BIR,R/O-VILLAGE TAJUPUR-112,BADARPUR SYED, FARIDABAD HARYANA-121101,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME SHYAMBIR MANN,FOR ALL,FUTURE PURPUSE

0040867837-10

I, Neha Lohia, W/o Shri Kamal Lohia, R/o A-1/23, 2nd Floor, Sector-8, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed my name from Neha to Neha Lohia.

0040867835-5

I, SATISH SINGHAL, S/O LATE SH. BHULLI RAM SINGHAL R/O H. NO. 38A, MAIN SHYAM PARK,SAHIBABAD GHAZIABAD - 201005, have changed my name SATISH SINGHAL to SATISH KUMAR SINGHAL for all future purposes.

0040867714-1

I,SHIKHA D/o Rajiv Acharya R/o Plot No.48, Kh.No.446,Durga Vihar Phase-2,Deenpur, Najafgarh, Delhi-110043 have changed my name to SHIKHA ACHARYA

0040867838-7

I, Nibha Kumari D/O Ramanuj Singh R/O Rz-Q-16, Nihal Vihar, Nangloi, New Delhi-110041 declare that name of mine has been Wrongly Written as NIBHA in my 10th class marksheet the actual name of mine Nibha Kumari

0071049606-1

I,Asma Manzoor,W/O Manzoor Ahmed, I-34/2, Batla House Jamia-Nagar, Okhla South, Delhi-110025,have changed my name to Asma for all future purpose

0040867837-3

I,Harneet kaur Arora, W/o-Surinder Singh,H no-5F-56,first floor NH-5, Faridabad Nit,Faridabad Haryana-121001,have changed my name to Harneet Kaur

0040867837-12

I, JALAJA KUMARY is dependent parent of AKHIL R NATH residing at JA52F, HARI ENCLAVE, HARI NAGAR, NEW DELHI-110064 have changed my name from JALAJA KUMARY to JALAJA S vide affidavit (DL60295071367869Y) dated 23/07/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

0040867737-1

I,NISHA,W/O-VIRENDER TOMAR,R/O-D-17.YADAV-NAGAR,SAMAY PUR, Libas Pur,North-West Delhi,Delhi-110042,have changed the name of my minor son YUG aged-17-years and he shall hereafter be known as YUG TOMAR.

0040867849-2

I,Mithlesh W/O-SH. Yogesh Sharma,R/O-H.No.70,Gali No.5,Behind Police Station,Gautam Colony, Narela, Delhi-110040,have changed, my name to Mithlesh Sharma,for all future purposes.

0040867835-7

I, Raisha khatoon W/O Islamuddin residing at D-4/33 Brijpuri Delhi 110094, have changed my name to Rahisa

0071049524-1

I, Seema W/o Sushil Kumar R/o C-47 New Multan Nagar, Delhi-110056 have changed my name to Seema Aggarwal for all future purposes

0071049660-1

I, Sakun Ahuja S/o Om Ahuja R/o R2/104, Raj Nagar, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Sakun Om Ahuja.

0071049635-1

I,Vijay Shankar,S/O Lachhi Ram,R/O House no-65 Gali no-2 Pop-Nagar, Tilpat, Faridabad, Haryana-121003, have changed my name to VIJAY SHANKER Permanently

0040867835-9

LOST & FOUND

I,Guneet Kaur,R/O-86,2nd Floor, Kalka Ji,New Delhi-110019,would like to inform general public that i have misplaced orignal Sale Deed 10th October-2009,in favour Shweta Sapra. If anyone finds it kindly contact me+919004137342.

0040867835-9

LOST my All Original Papers/Documents bearing my Property J-474,Opp-MCD-park Baljeet Nagar Patel-Nagar,Delhi-8,area-32x32-sq,ft Finder Kindly contact-Kanta-Devi W/o-(L)-Prithvi Raj at above Address (Mob:7011174049)

0040867835-11

LOST my All Original Papers/Documents bearing my Property J-474/A,with Roof-Right Opp-MCD-park Baljeet-Nagar,Patel-Nagar, Delhi-8,area 20-sq,yds Finder Kindly contact-Varinder Kumar,S/o-(L)-Prithvi Raj at-above Address (Mob:7982263648).

0040867835-10

I Ashima Mahajan lost my MSc Forensic Psychology Grade Sheet & Degree Regn. No. 00085MSFP1617008 and CISCE Class 10 Statement of Marks and Pass Certificate Index No T/1824/049. Contact:9592388189

0050293716-1

Lost all Original Property Documents of Property No.B-402,MIG Flats,East of Loni Road,Nand-Nagari,Delhi-110093,Founder May Inform,Vandana Kaushik,D/o-Hirday Nath Upadhyay at above Address.#8882466057

0040867838-11

BUSINESS OFFERS

FOR SALE : Konica Minolta Bizhub 458e photocopier in non-operational condition, available on "As Is Where Is" basis . Contact : 9910023810, 9801075739.

0050293731-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known at public in large that my clientess **Smt. Pritam Kaur** W/o Late S. Surinder Singh R/o: WZ-9, Mukhram Park Extn., Tilak Nagar, New Delhi-18, has debarred, disowned and disinherited her all three daughters including their respective families namely: **1. Gurivinder Kaur 2. Smt. Gurcharan Kaur** and **Smt. Amrit Kaur** from her movable and immovable assets and severed all relations with them on account of their unwarranted acts, indifferent behaviours and conducts as they were extending continue threats to my clientess by their illegal demands in the property no. WZ-9, Mukhram Park Extn, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi-18 which owned by her grandson namely **Sh. Parandeep Singh,** Even the said grandson is caring & looking after my clientess after the death of her husband. She doesn't want in future; her aforesaid daughters will disturb him and his family in any manner. Any one deal with them shall do entirely at their own risks, costs, consequences and responsibilities.

Sd/-
Dinesh Rohilla
Advocate
Ch. No. K-134, Lawyers Chamebr, Tis Hazari Coruts, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

The general public is hereby informed that my client **Vinod Kumar Sharma** S/o S.D. Sharma R/o H.No.B-62/7, Ram Prastha, Chander Nagar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201011, have debarred & disowned his son **Anshaj Sharma** S/o Vinod Kumar Sharma severed all relations with him for his misconduct from all my client's moveable & immovable properties. Anybody transacting any business with him in respect to my client is doing that in his/her/their own risks. My client shall not be responsible for dealing with him if any person do so.

Abhimanyu Sangwan (Advocate)
Ch. No.315, Laywers Chamber Building, Rohini Courts, Delhi-110034.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Information is given to general public at large upon instruction from Mrs. Pooja Anand and Mr. Pradeep Kumar Anand who intend to mortgage Entire Ground Floor & First Floor without roof rights part of Property No. 43, area measuring 48 sq. mtrs., in Block-B, Pocket-7, situated in the layout plan of Rohini Residential Scheme, at Sector-15, Rohini, New Delhi who are the the owners through Sale Deed dated 18.02.2026 executed by Mr. Pradeep Kumar Anand vide reg. as Document No. 2026(13)(1992, Volume No. 14302, Pages No. 43-64, SRO-Rohini and Gift Deed dated 18.01.2019 executed by Mrs. Krishna Anand vide Document No. 713, who was the owner through Conveyance Deed dated 28.02.2006 executed by POI through DDA vide Document No. 18670. That Original prior chain document i.e. Conveyance Deed dated 28.02.2006 executed by POI through DDA in favour of Mrs. Krishna Anand in respect of the property, Document No. 18670 is lost and not traceable. Online F.I.R. has been lodged by Mr. Pradeep Kumar Anand on 15.07.2026 vide LR No.450035/2026, P.S. Rohini, Crime Branch, Delhi. Any person(s), institution(s) finds the same is requested to send to the above mentioned address.
Any person(s), institution(s) having any claim and/or objection in respect of the said property shall communicate the same to the undersigned at our address within 10 days from the publication of this notice with documentary evidence in support thereof, failing which all the claim, of such person(s)/ institution(s) shall not be binding upon the said property or Kotak Mahindra Bank Ltd.

Mohd K. Hussain (Advocate)
D-21, Basement, Block-D, Jangpura Extn. New Delhi-110014. 8810391672

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform that my client Mr. Deen Dayal Jain alias D.D. Jain S/o Mr. Triloki Nath Jain, R/o Flat No. A-7, Shaman Vihar Apartment, Plot No. 9, Sector-23, Dwarka, New Delhi -75 is the owner/title holder of DDA Built-Up freehold SFS Category-II Flat No. 6322 on ground floor, situated at Sector-C, Pocket-6&7, Vasant Kunj, New Delhi - 70 (Property Description) by virtue of Conveyance Deed duly registered as Registration No. 5,510 in Book No.1 Volume No. 4,337 on pages 98 to 99 dated 27.03.2012 in the office of the Sub-Registrar-VII, New Delhi and has lost, thus unable to trace following documents: Original Conveyance Deed dated 27.03.2012, few House Tax Receipts, Water and Electricity Bills in respect of the said Property. An information Report of this effect has been lodged in Dwarka/Crime Branch, Delhi P.S: Dwarka Sector-23/e-Police Station Vide LR No: 465034/2026 dated 20.07.2026.
If any person is having any objection against the ownership claims of Mr. Deen Dayal Jain alias D.D. Jain over the said property, he/she/they should file the objection, only in writing, before the undersigned in writing within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice, failing which it will be assumed that no third party claims/ objections exists challenging ownership of Mr. Deen Dayal Jain alias D.D. Jain over the said property. Further, in case above mentioned documents as mentioned above are found by anyone, the same should be returned to the undersigned.
Deepak Dahiya Advocate Legal Imperials, Plot No. 11, First Floor, Local Shopping Complex, Pocket B1, Vasant Kunj, New Delhi -110070. Email: info@legalimperials.com, Mobile Phones: 9540233456, 9560233456

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is hereby informed to the general public that my clients, Mr. Rakesh Kumar Gupta, son of Late Shri Inder Gupta; his wife, Mrs. Parul Gupta; and their children, Ms. Mrigna Gupta and Mr. Vasu Gupta, have severed all personal, social, financial, and legal relations with Mr. Ajay Gupta, son of Late Shri Inder Gupta; his wife, Mrs. Rakhi Gupta; and their son, Mr. Krit Gupta.
Therefore, any person who, despite this public notice, enters into any transaction, agreement, dealing, or maintains any connection with them shall do so entirely at his/her own risk and consequences.
My clients shall not be liable or responsible, directly or indirectly, for any act, omission, liability, debt, transaction, representation, or obligation of Mr. Ajay Gupta, Mrs. Rakhi Gupta, or Mr. Krit Gupta.

Sd/-
NAVEEN KUMAR TRIPATHI
Advocate
Off. 54, National Park, Lajpat Nagar-IV, New Delhi-24

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given for the information of the general public that my client, Ms. Sunita Devi, W/o Late Ganesh Gupta, R/o House No. B-37, Malikpur Village, Near Kingsway Camp, Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi-110009, has, owing to serious personal reasons and the conduct of her son, Mr. Neeraj Gupta, decided to sever all social and familial relations with him with immediate effect. It is hereby declared that my client has disowned and debarred Mr. Neeraj Gupta from all her movable and immovable assets and properties, whether owned at present or acquired in future, to the extent permissible under law. Mr. Neeraj Gupta shall have no right, authority or permission to represent my client or to act on her behalf in any manner whatsoever.

Rajiv Ranjan (Advocate)
Ch. No. 289, Civil Side Tis Hazari Court, Delhi-54

PUBLIC NOTICE

I Chhavi Singh W/o Saurabh Srivastava R/o 376 Udyan-2 Sec-1 Raebareli Road Eldeco Colony Lucknow UP 226025, have lost original Builder buyer agreement between M/s Amrapali Dream valley Flat no. 1101 Tower Number C4 Gh09, Sector Tech zone IV, Greater Noida and myself. All are informed not to deal or carry out any transaction on the basis of missing document.

PUBLIC NOTICE

To be known to all, **MAHEEP SINGH S/o LATE HARDEEP SINGH R/O- A1/139 B, KESHAV PURAM, LAWRENCE ROAD, KESHAV PURAM, DELHI-110035.** The original document i.e. Possession Letter,**Demand-Cum-Allotment Letter Possession Slip, NOC Water & Electricity issued by DDA In Respect of DDA Built-up LIG Flat Lawrence Road Delhi.** have been lost.An F.I.R./ NCR/LR No. 467432/ 2026 dt. 21/07/ 2026 to this effect has been lodged in Police station. Any person(s)claiming any right, having any objection or found in possession of original documents, may write/contact with above named person at above Address/ Phone 9625648082 within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice & can personally contact **Deputy Director LAB Housing LIG D - BLOCK, 3RD FLOOR INA, DDA, VIKAS SADAN,NEW DELHI-110023**

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the general public that the **original General Power of Attorney** dated 08th April, **2004** (duly adjudicated), executed by **Mr. SudhirArora** in favour of his father **Mr. Kashmiri Lal Arora** in respect of the property bearing **S-468A, 1st Floor, Greater Kailash-I, New Delhi–110048** ("the said Property"), has been reported to have been lost/misplaced and, despite diligent search and efforts, the same could not be traced. An FIR was also registered in this regard, and a public notice was published in the Hindi daily newspaper Hindustan.

Notice is further given that the aforesaid Attorney **Mr. Kashmiri Lal Arora, exercising powers under the aforesaid deed of General Power of Attorney, had sold the said property and thereafter the said property was resold and the said new buyers continue to be the owners as on date.**

Our clients are proposing to purchase the said Property from the said current owners and during the course of title verification, it was noticed that the aforesaid original General Power of Attorney is not available and had been reported lost/misplaced.

As a matter of abundant caution notice is given to the general public that in case any person, bank, financial institution, authority or any other person is in possession of or has knowledge of the whereabouts of the original General Power of Attorney dated **08th April, 2004** executed by **Mr. Sudhir Arora** in favour of his father **Mr. Kashmiri Lal Arora,** he/she/it/they is/are requested to intimate the undersigned in writing, along with supporting documentary evidence, and/or return the original document to the undersigned at the address mentioned below within **10 (Ten) days** from the date of publication of this notice.

As a matter of abundant caution notice is given to the general public that in case any person, bank, financial institution, authority or any other person is in possession of or has knowledge of the whereabouts of the original General Power of Attorney dated **08th April, 2004** executed by **Mr. Sudhir Arora** in favour of his father **Mr. Kashmiri Lal Arora,** he/she/it/they is/are requested to intimate the undersigned in writing, along with supporting documentary evidence, and/or return the original document to the undersigned at the address mentioned below within **10 (Ten) days** from the date of publication of this notice.

Notice is also given that in case no intimation, as afore requested, is received and/or the original document is not returned within **10 (Ten) days** from the date of publication of this notice, it shall be presumed that the said document (original General Power of Attorney dated **08th April, 2004** executed by **Mr. Sudhir Arora** in favour of his father **Mr. Kashmiri Lal Arora)** has been lost for good and that no person has any claim, right, title, interest under the said document and further that no one has any objection whatsoever in sale of the said Property; and accordingly our clients shall proceed with the proposed purchase of the said Property and any claim or objection received thereafter shall be treated as invalid and unsustainable.

Mayank Sahni, Advocate **(Sahni Apex Legal)** DD-34 Kalkaji, (basement) New Delhi-110 019

सार्वजनिक सूचना

मेरी मुवक्किला नसीमा पत्नी श्री मौइनुद्दीन, निवासी 201, गली नं0 6, निकट जैन मंदिर, लक्ष्मी नगर, दिल्ली, ने अपने बड़े पुत्र मोहम्मद आसिफ, निवासी गड्ढा कालोनी, जैतपुर, दिल्ली (सह परिवार) तथा बड़ी पुत्री आयशा पत्नी अमजद अली, निवासी नई आबादी, कोठी गेट, हापुड़, उत्तर प्रदेश (सह परिवार) के साथ अपने सभी संबंध विच्छेद कर दिए हैं तथा उन्हें अपनी सभी चल–अचल सम्पत्तियों से तत्काल प्रभाव से उनके दुष्कृत्यों और दुर्व्यवहार के कारण बेदखल कर दिया है और अब उन्हें मेरी मुवक्किला या उसके परिवार और उसकी चल–अचल सम्पत्तियों को प्रतिनिधित्व करने का कोई अधिकार/आज्ञा नहीं होगी तथा मेरी मुवक्किला इनके द्वारा भविष्य में किसी भी व्यक्ति के साथ किए गए व्यवहार की उत्तरदायी नहीं होंगी।

अरविन्द भारद्वाज (अधिवक्ता)
डी–627, कड़कड़डूमा कोर्ट, दिल्ली–110032,
फोन: 9899452939, 8588890454

"IMPORTANT"

Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Under Instruction from and on behalf of my client, General Public is informed that, **Mr. Dalbir Singh Malik S/o Sh. Bharat Singh Malik and Mrs. Saroj Malik W/o Dalbir Singh Malik both R/o House No.-RZ-62, Street No.-3, Dabri Extn., Main Palam, Delhi-110045**, has debarred their younger son namely **Rahul Malik** from all their Movable and Immovable Properties and assets, as he become unfaithful dishonest, disobedient & bad behaviour towards my Client.
My client and other family members will not be responsible for his any kind of liabilities, dealings, acts criminal proceedings, obligation, financial transactions, claims etc. My client has severed all relations with him.

Krishan Kumar Tyagi (Advocate) D-121/88 UG-19, Distt. Centre, Janak Puri, New Delhi-58

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to all that my client Mrs. Jyoti Singh W/o Late Sh Ramveer Singh R/o F-3/235, Gali No. 2 Back Side, Near Veer Bazar, Sangam Vihar, New Delhi-110062 disinherited her son Chander Shekhar from her all moveable and immoveable properties and severed all her relation from the said son Chander Shekhar and his wife Smt Sangeeta for ever and any body dealing with them will be doing so at his/her own risks and consequences and my client shall not be liable for their acts and deeds.

Neeru (Advocate)
Ch. No.367, Saket Court New Delhi-17

COURT NOTICE

IN THE COURT OF DR. PANKAJ SHARMA, DJ-02, NEW DELHI DISTRICT. PATIALA HOUSE COURT, NEW DELHI

Case No. PC/13/2026

1. Vijender Kumar S/o Sh. Amarnath, R/o E-206, Ground Floor, Budh Nagar, JJ Colony, Inderpuri, IARI, New Delhi-110012.

.....Petitioner/s

Vs

1. State (Govt. of NCT of Delhi)
2. Sh. Rakesh Kumar S/o Not known, R/o E-206, Second Floor, Budh Nagar, JJ Colony Inderpuri, IARI, New Delhi-110012.

....Respondent/s

Whereas a petition under section 276 of the Indian Succession Act, 1925 for the grant of Probate/ Letters of Administration to the petitioner in respect of the movable and Immovable property of the estate of **Late Smt. Kaelaso Devi W/o Sh. Tara Chand.** Notice is hereby given to the general public that any person having objection to the Grant of Letter of Administration/ Probate in his favour in respect of the estate of the deceased particularly, **"E-206, Budh Nagar, JJ Colony, Inderpuri, IARI, New Delhi-1100012 measuring 25 Sq. Yds."** may file the same in the court personally or through counsel on or before the next date of hearing 13.10.2026.
Given under my hand and the seal of the court on the 14th day of May 2026.

Seal Sd/- **Judge**

SITUATION VACANT

OTHERS

VASTU KALA ACADEMY
College of Architecture
Affiliated to GGSIP University and approved by Council of Architecture
9/1, Aruna Asaf Ali Marg, New Delhi-110067
Email: ise_vaka@yahoo.co.in
Web: www.vakaarchitecture.com

ASSISTANT AND ASSOCIATE PROFESSOR

Applications are invited from eligible Architects registered with Council of Architecture for the post of **Assistant and Associate Professor of Architecture** (on Regular/ contract basis). Qualifications and experience may be as prescribed by CoA. Application form (format is available on the website of the college) together with detailed bio-data should reach the Registrar of the College by 24th August, 2026.
Note: Those candidates, who applied in response to advertisement dated 23rd July, 2025 are requested to apply afresh.

Registrar

Call or WhatsApp 9717006820 to advertise on classified page
The Indian EXPRESS — JOURNALISM OF COURAGE

CENTRAL RAILWAY

CORRIGENDUM

It is hereby notified that the work published under **open e-tender Notice No.** CR-DRMWBB-2026-35, Sr. No. 04 and 05, which are due to be opened on 31.07.2026 the name of work for **Sr. No. 04**, shall be read as Ghansoli, Rabale, Seawood-Darave, Bamandongri & Kharkopar - Repairs to Railway Offices & Toilets, Platform wall, Coping & platform surface, COP, Valley Gutter, Downtake pipes, Staircase, Subway, Wall tiles, Facility for Divyangjan on platforms, Toilets, Water booth, Platform name boards & Signboards including complete painting at Railway Station under DEN (HB)/CSMT and for **Sr. No. 05** shall be read as Juinagar & Sanpada: Repairs to Railway offices & Toilets, Platform wall, Coping & Platform surface, COP, Valley Gutter, Downtake pipes, Staircase, Subway, Wall tiles, Facility for Divyangjan on platforms, Toilets, Water booth, Platform name boards & Signboards including complete painting at Railway Station under DEN (HB)/CSMT section.

Unauthorized crossing of railway line is a punishable offense

BENGALURU NORTH CITY CORPORATION

Office of the Chief Veterinary Officer & Head (Animal Husbandry), Amruthahalli Main Road, Bengaluru-560092.

No: BNCC/CVO(AH)/TEND/04/2026-27 Date: 23-07-2026

SHORT TERM TENDER NOTIFICATION
(Two Cover System) (Through GOK KPP Portal only)

The Chief Veterinary Officer and Head (Animal Husbandry), BNCC, Bengaluru invites Request for Proposal from Interested Persons / Firms those who have done for Various Works detailed below.

Sl. No.	Name of the Work
1	Collection of Entrance Fees and Slaughter Fees for Small Animals at Civil Meat Production & Processing Centre, Tannery Road, BNCC, Bengaluru. **Project Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 144.00, EMD Amount (in Rs.): 2,16,000/-**
2	Collection of Entrance Fees and Slaughter Fees for Large Animals (Buffaloes above 13 years of Age) at Civil Meat Production and Processing Centre, Tannery Road, BNCC, Bengaluru. **Project Amount (Rs. in Lakhs): 18.00, EMD Amount (in Rs.): 45,000/-**

Calendar of Events: 1) Tender documents may be downloaded from the GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Website: **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in. 2)** Pre Bid Meeting will be held on **27-07-2026 at 11.30 AM in the Office of the Chief Veterinary Officer & Head (Animal Husbandry), BNCC, Bengaluru, Byatarayanapura, Bengaluru - 560092. 3)** Last Date and Time for Receipt of Tenders: **07-08-2026 upto 4.00 PM. 4)** Date of Opening of Technical Bid: **10-08-2026 at 11.00 AM.** Further details can be had from the above office.

Sd/- Chief Veterinary Officer & Head (Animal Husbandry), BNCC.

Executive Engineer, Soil Investigation Division, Road Construction Department, Ranchi

(e-Procurement Notice)

Letter of Invitation (LOI) No.- 06/2026-27

4th Call

National Bidding

e-Tender Ref No– RCD/SID/AP/RAN/ 06 /2026-27 Date:-21.07.2026

Executive Engineer, Soil Investigation Division, RCD, Ranchi has been assigned the work of Consultancy Services for the Preparation of Detailed Project Report (D.P.R) for construction of Gola Bypass with approach road towards Rajrappa under road division Ramgarh including new proposal of culverts, bridges, ROBs, RUBs, complete Land acquisition plan including ownership details all complete as per latest guidelines, Resettlement and Rehabilitation proposals , Forest Diversion proposal and Utility Shifting proposal in details etc under Ramgarh District in the State of Jharkhand.(total tentative length-12.00 Km)

Proposals are hereby invited from eligible Consultants for the Preparation of Detailed Project Report for construction of Gola Bypass with approach road towards Rajrappa under road division Ramgarh including new proposal of culverts, bridges, ROBs, RUBs, complete Land acquisition plan including ownership details all complete as per latest guidelines, Resettlement and Rehabilitation proposals , Forest Diversion proposal and Utility Shifting proposal in details etc under Ramgarh District in the State of Jharkhand.(total tentative length-12.00 Km)

The Letter of Invitation (LOI) and Terms of Reference (ToR) including Request for Proposal (RFP) is available online on e-tender portal for submission of bid. The document can be downloaded from ofhttps://jharkhandtenders.gov.in . Refer instruction to bidder under e-tendering for submission of bid. The document can be downloaded from https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in. The consultants who download the RFP document from the website will be required to pay the non- refundable fee of Rs 5,000/- (Five Thousand).

1. As per the Departmental Letter no. - 4652(S) dated 06.10.2023, cost of tender document and Earnest Money Deposit will be received in online mode only through e-procurement portal (https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in) by internet banking/NEFT/RTGS facility as per Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) issued by Information Technology & e-Governance Department, Government of Jharkhand vide letter no- 120 dated 03.10.2023.
2. The consulting firm must have significant experience in handling large-scale road infrastructure project. **Only those Bidders will participate who have experience in such type of projects in any state in India .**
3. Road Construction Department, Government of Jharkhand (GOJ) invites proposal for the work mentioned in table through e-procurement System by National Bidding Process.

1	Name Of Work	Consultancy Services for the Preparation of Detailed Project Report (D.P.R) for construction of Gola Bypass with approach road towards Rajrappa under road division Ramgarh including new proposal of culverts, bridges, ROBs, RUBs, complete Land acquisition plan including ownership details all complete as per latest guidelines, Resettlement and Rehabilitation proposals , Forest Diversion proposal and Utility Shifting proposal in details etc under Ramgarh District in the State of Jharkhand.(total tentative length-12.00 Km)
2	Tentative Length	12.00 km
3	Period of Completion of Work	60 Days
4	Cost of Tender documents& Earnest Money Deposit	Cost of Tender Document- Rs 5,000/- (Five Thousand only) Earnest Money Deposit- Rs- 20,000/- (Rupees Twenty Thousand only) **As per the Departmental Letter no. -4652(S) dated 06.10.2023, cost of tender document and Earnest Money Depo sit will be received in online mode only through e - procurement portal (https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in) by internet banking/NEFT/RTGS facility as per Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) issued by Information T echnology & e -Governance Department, Government of Jharkhand vide letter no- 120 dated 03.10.2023.**
5	Mode of Bid Submission	e - tendering (**https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in**)
6	Date/Time of Publication of Tender on Website	25.07.2026 At 10:30 AM
7	Availability of online tender/ Bid submission period	25.07.2026, 10:30 AM to 10.08.2026, 12:00 Noon
8	Place of Opening of Tender Paper	Chief Engineer (Communication), Road Construction Department, 1stFloor, Engineer Hostel No. -2, Dhurwa, Ranchi - 834004
09	Last date of submission of Bids	10.08.2026 at 12:00 Noon
10	Date of opening of Bids	11.08.2026 at 12:30 PM
11	Bid validity	120 days
12	Designation and Contact no.of e-Procurement Officer	Executive Engineer, Soil Investigation Division, RCD, Ranchi Mob– 9905660677 Email id :- eercdapsid@jhr@nic.in
13	PR No.-	374588 Road (26 -27) D, 376853 (26 -27)D, 380993 Road (26-27)D

Note:-Only e-Tender shall be accepted.

PR 385661 Road(26-27)D

sd/-
Executive Engineer
Soil Investigation Division,
Road Construction Department, Ranchi

Office of the Resident Commissioner Govt. of Jharkhand New Jharkhand Bhawan Bangla Sahib Road, New Delhi-110001.

Notice Inviting Short-Term (re) e-tender

The tender invited through PR.NO. 384104 Cabinet (26-27) : D is hereby cancelled due to administrative reason and re-tender is invited for the same. e-tenders are invited from reputed interested bidders for providing premises for the accommodation to Security Personnel of Jharkhand Bhawan, New Delhi.

1. Date of issue of Tender notice in website - 25.07.2026 10:00 AM
2. Bid Submission start date & time - 25.07.2026 11:00 AM
3. Bid Submission end date & time - 31.07.2026 06:00 PM
4. Date & Time of opening of technical bid - 03.08.2026 11:00 AM
5. Date & Time of opening of financial bid - To be notified when evaluation of technical bid is completed.

Details & tender document can be downloaded from website-jharkhandtenders.gov.in. Non-commercial entities can register themselves by entering GST No./PAN No. etc. in the place of registration number at registration portal at jharkhandtenders.gov.in, in case registration number is not available.

PR 385629 Cabinet(26-27)D

Sd/-
Chief Administrative Officer

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mohd. Shahid Alam S/o Mohd. Murshid Alam R/o G-433, Gali No.10, Khadda Colony, Jaitpur Extension Part-2, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 332/2025 U/S 318(4)/316(2)/61(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Kalindi Kunj, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Mohd. Shahid Alam** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Mohd. Shahid Alam** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mohd. Shahid Alam** of **FIR No. 332/2025 U/S 318(4)/316(2)/61(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Kalindi Kunj, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **24.08.2026.**

By Order,
Sh. Kawal Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-10
Room No.307, 3rd Floor, South-East District
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi
DP/10148/SE/2026(Court Matter)

PUBLIC AUCTION NOTICE OF OFFENDING VEHICLE

It is respectfully submitted that the Hon'ble Court has directed the initiation of proceedings for the public auction of the offending vehicle bearing **Registration No. HR-47-G-4383 Wagonor Car (Taxi) Registraction 31/08/2024** involved in **FIR No. 424/25 Dated: 07/10/25 U/s 281/125B BNS & 146/196 MV** Act at **PS: Vasant Kunj South, Distt. South-West, New Delhi.** The particulars of the vehicle are as under: •Vehicle **Registration No.: HR-47-G-4383 •Vehicle Type: Wagon R Car (Taxi) •Chassis No.: MA3JMTBB1SREB11035, Engine No.: KI0CNC586129** The general public is hereby informed that the Auction of the above-mentioned vehicle is scheduled to be held on **30/07/2026** at **11:00 AM at Police Station Vasant Kunj South, New Delhi.** Interested persons may participate in the auction as per the prescribed procedure. For further information, please contact Police Station Vasant Kunj South, New Delhi.

SHO
Vasant Kunj South, New Delhi
Ph.: 7065036265, 8802428689
DP/10074/SW/2026
(Court Matter)

Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam Technical University, Uttar Pradesh

Sect-11, Jankipuram Vistar, Sitapur Road, Lucknow, U.P.-226031

Ph.D. Admissions : 2026-27 (Phase- I)

Applications are invited for the Phase-I admission in Ph.D. programmes offered by the University, as per two categories, Category-A and Category-B. Applicants are required to apply online from **20/07/2026 to 05/08/2026** through University website **https://aktu.ac.in.**

- **Application Fee:-** SC/ST/DivyangJan/Girls Rs. 1000; GEN/OBC Rs. 2000.
- For the eligibility criteria of both Categories A and B, visit university website.
- Category A applicants are exempted from Written Examination. However, if Category A candidate wishes to apply for AKTU fellowship scheme (Homi Bhabha Teaching Assistant cum Research Fellowship) they need to apply under Category B.
- The written exam (for Category B only) shall be of two-hour duration and shall contain 100 multiple choice type questions, out of which 50 questions will be of Research Methodology and 50 questions will be from subject specific disciplines/subject areas. Examination will be held at Lucknow.
- Details of written Examination/Interview will be provided subsequently on the university website. Tentative date of written exam – **25th August 2026.**
- Homi Bhabha Teaching Assistant cum Research Fellowship (offered only for Eligible Streams under Faculty of Engg & Technology, Faculty of Applied Sciences, Humanities and Social Sciences, Faculty of Architecture & Planning), will be given to eligible candidates of Category B only, subject to availability of supervisor and seats.

Registrar

website: www.aktu.ac.in

PUNJAB STATE TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED

Corporate Identity No: U4010PB2010SGC033814, www.pstcl.org
O/o SE/TS (D), Telefax: 0175-2207774, e-mail: se-trd@pstcl.org

NOTICE INVIING E-TENDER

Type of tender/TE no.	Open tender/STQ-2099
Name & complete address of office giving tender	The Er-in-Chief/TS, 3rd Floor, Shakti Sadan, PSTCL, Patiala
Scope of work	SPECIFICATION FOR DESIGN, MANUFACTURE, TESTING, SUPPLY & DELIVERY OF ACSR MOOSE NOMINAL ALUMINIUM AREA APPROX. 530mm² (202km), ACSR ZEBRA NOMINAL ALUMINIUM AREA APPROX. 420mm² (1452km), ACSR PANTHER NOMINAL ALUMINIUM AREA OF APPROX 200mm² (36km).
Starting date of downloading	Date of publication
Last date of downloading	21.08.2026 upto11:00hrs.
Last date/time for bid submission	21.08.2026 upto11:00hrs.
Date/time for opening of bids	24.08.2026 at 11:00 hrs.

Detailed NIT/Specification may be downloaded from PSTCL E-Tendering website https://eproc.punjab.gov.in.nicgep/app Corrigendum if any, will not be published in newspapers. As such the website may be visited regularly for updates.

NO. 13576/PSTCL **Sd/- ASE/TS-2, PSTCL, Patiala.**

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD. | GOLD AUCTION NOTICE

Regd. Office: Muthoot Centre, TC No 27/3022, Punnen Road, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, India - 695001. CIN : U65929KL1997PLC011518, Ph: +91 471 4911400, 2331427.

Notice is hereby given for the information of all concerned that gold ornaments pledged with under mentioned branches of the company , which were overdue for redemption and which have not been redeemed so for in spite of repeated notices will be auctioned on 25.08.2026 from 10 am onwards.

BILASPUR DISTRICT - BILASPUR: 4324000468, 4324000494, 4324000507, 4324000535, 4324000577, 4324000591, 4324000600, 4324000633, 4324000634, 4324000646, 4324000651, 4324000667, 4324000679, 4324000680, 4324000685, 4324000699, 4324000714, 4324000719, 4324000732, 4324000743, 4324000773, 4324000780, 4324000791, 4324000823, 4324000832, 4324000865, 4324000871, 4324000872, 4324000875, 4324000891, 4324000907, 4324000911, 4324000912, 4324000932, 4324000947, 4324000979, 4324000984, 4324001071, 4324001099, 8000084324.

Auction will be conducted at respective branches. please note if the auction does not get completed on the same day due to any reasons, the same will be conducted on 03.09.2026 at 10.00 am onwards at BILASPUR DISTRICT - BILASPUR: GROUND FLOOR, NAZOOL SHEET NO .07, PLOT 34/6, NEHRU CHOWK,TILAK NAGAR,OPPOSITE CHHATTISGARH BHAWAN, BILASPUR, CHHATTISGARH-495001 .The bidders are requested to produce photo id card ,Pan card .The successful bidder should transfer the money through RTGS.

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD. | GOLD AUCTION NOTICE

Regd. Office: Muthoot Centre, TC No 27/3022, Punnen Road, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, India - 695001. CIN : U65929KL1997PLC011518, Ph: +91 471 4911400, 2331427.

Notice is hereby given for the information of all concerned that gold ornaments pledged with under mentioned branches of the company , which were overdue for redemption and which have not been redeemed so for in spite of repeated notices will be auctioned on 25.08.2026 from 10 am onwards.

Auction Date: 25.08.2026 - DEWAS DISTRICT - DEWAS-AB ROAD: 2610001145, 2610001173, 2610001207, 2610001209, 2610001351, 2610001383, 2610001394, 2610001410, 2610001411, 2610001412, 2610001521, 2610001539, 2610001541, 2610001560, 2610001561, 2610001576, 2610001595, 2610001612, 2610001627, 2610001701, 2610001710, 2610001723, 2610001749, 2610001769, 2610001789, 2610001794, 2610001828, 2610001858, 2610001861, 2610001863, 2610001865, 2610001875, 2610001879, 2610001920, 2610001932, 2610001933, 2610001949, 2610001953, 2610001954, 2610001960, 2610001961, 2610002013, 2610002022, 2610002037, 2610002043, 2610002045, 2610002106, 2610002137, 2610002142, 2610002163, 2610002188, 2610002190, 2610002257, 2610002279, 2610002284, 2610002328. **Auction Date: 25.08.2026 - INDORE DISTRICT - ANNAPURNA ROAD-INDORE:** 2146000215, 2146000225, 2146005092, 2146005096, 2146005097, 2146005147, 2146005150, 2146005194, 2146005212, 2146005253, 2146005261, 2146005293, 2146005301, 2146005319, 2146005410, 2146005420, 2146005442, 2146005476, 2146005477, 2146005500, 2146005508, 2146005537, 2146005538, 2146005565, 2146005568, 2146005570, 2146005580, 2146005581, 2146005595, 2146005596, 2146005607, 2146005630, 2146005633, 2146005634, 2146005638, 2146005655, 2146005663, 2146005664, 2146005665, 2146005681, 2146005686, 2146005688, 2146005710, 2146005714, 2146005723, 2146005724, 2146005728, 2146005734, 2146005739, 2146005740, 2146005741, 2146005744, 2146005751, 2146005757, 2146005758, 2146005777, 2146005778, 2146005781, 2146005783, 2146005804, 2146005810, 2146005813, 2146005815, 2146005821, 2146005831, 2146005835, 2146005840, 2146005841, 2146005858, 2146005860, 2146005861, 2146005879, 2146005900, 2146005910, 2146005922, 2146005926, 2146005942, 2146005974, 2146005983, 2146005995, 2146006011, 2146006012, 2146006037, 2146006050, 2146006052, 2146006068, 2146006076, 2146006098, 2146006100, 2146006103, 2146006108, 2146006113, 2146006128, 2146006137, 2146006165, 2146006177, 2146006202, 2146006228, 2146006242, 2146006243, 2146006267, 2146006339, 2146006378, 2146006397, 2146006427, 2146006440, 2146006485, 2146006515, 2146006538, 2146006539, 2146006545, 2146006547, 2146006551, 2146006554, 2146006583, 2146006584, 2146006585, 2146006591, 2146006607, 2146006612, 2146006614, 2146006648, 2146006656, 2146006659, 2146006667, 2146006678, 2146006679, 2146006682, 2146006691, 2146006724, 2146006725, 2146006729, 2146006742, 2146006776, 2146006816, 2146006838, 2146006874, 2146006883, 2146007059, 2146007060, 2146007062, 2146007101, 2146007117, 2146007118, 2146007150, 2146007163, 2146007185, 2146007251, 2146007254, 2146007266, 2146007287, 2146007302, 2146007316, 2146007326, 2146007368, 8000012146, 8000132146, 8000462146, 8000542146, 8000592146, 8000602146, 8000612146, 8000672146, 8000892146, 8000952146, 8000982146, 8001032146, 8001122146. **JAWAHAR MARG-INDORE:** 2167001962, 2167001988, 2167003011, 2167003031, 2167003063, 2167003095, 2167003119, 2167003149, 2167003157, 2167003163, 2167003164, 2167003206, 2167003219, 2167003220, 2167003222, 2167003233, 2167003241, 2167003267, 2167003280, 2167003281, 2167003288, 2167003321, 2167003328, 2167003336, 2167003337, 2167003338, 2167003340, 2167003349, 2167003353, 2167003354, 2167003355, 2167003358, 2167003361, 2167003362, 2167003382, 2167003398, 2167003399, 2167003440, 2167003455, 2167003461, 2167003465, 2167003467, 2167003471, 2167003472, 2167003483, 2167003487, 2167003490, 2167003510, 2167003532, 2167003534, 2167003550, 2167003561, 2167003563, 2167003564, 2167003573, 2167003586, 2167003626, 2167003661, 2167003664, 2167003681, 2167003717, 2167003767, 2167003784, 2167003787, 2167003789, 2167003858, 2167003875, 2167003880, 2167003886, 2167003895, 2167003909, 2167003911, 2167003932, 2167003939, 2167003981, 2167003996, 2167003997, 2167004107, 2167004176, 2167004246, 2167004282, 2167004349, 8000042167. **MANGAL NAGAR-SUKHLIA:** 4326001544, 4326001890, 4326001920, 4326002019, 4326002056, 4326002117, 4326002133, 4326002168, 4326002240, 4326002245, 4326002246, 4326002290, 4326002332, 4326002340, 4326002467, 4326002485, 4326002491, 4326002494, 4326002498, 4326002538, 4326002573, 4326002613, 4326002628, 4326002654, 4326002661, 4326002664, 4326002670, 4326002671, 4326002672, 4326002683, 4326002685, 4326002699, 4326002714, 4326002742, 4326002766, 4326002797, 4326002799, 4326002803, 4326002822, 4326002825, 4326002829, 4326002832, 4326002836, 4326002839, 4326002846, 4326002870, 4326002879, 4326002880, 4326002885, 4326002935, 4326002955, 4326002970, 4326002986, 4326003071, 4326003079, 4326003086, 4326003090, 4326003104, 4326003157, 4326003188, 4326003282, 4326003283, 4326003346, 4326003371. **NANDA NAGAR-INDORE:** 2150000638, 2150001096, 2150002032, 2150002768, 2150005820, 2150006193, 2150006217, 2150006242, 2150006245, 2150006251, 2150006252, 2150006265, 2150006368, 2150006380, 2150006383, 2150006435, 2150006457, 2150006503, 2150006531, 2150006543, 2150006566, 2150006568, 2150006573, 2150006588, 2150006615, 2150006640, 2150006648, 2150006658, 2150006659, 2150006685, 2150006689, 2150006690, 2150006710, 2150006711, 2150006727, 2150006747, 2150006772, 2150006784, 2150006800, 2150006818, 2150006820, 2150006821, 2150006823, 2150006829, 2150006830, 2150006846, 2150006849, 2150006867, 2150006874, 2150006875, 2150006886, 2150006897, 2150006910, 2150006918, 2150006921, 2150006929, 2150006930, 2150006941, 2150006949, 2150006953, 2150006959, 2150006960, 2150006977, 2150007012, 2150007025, 2150007057, 2150007074, 2150007079, 2150007082, 2150007096, 2150007097, 2150007108, 2150007112, 2150007115, 2150007122, 2150007139, 2150007173, 2150007176, 2150007194, 2150007197, 2150007199, 2150007209, 2150007215, 2150007218, 2150007236, 2150007254, 2150007255, 2150007261, 2150007265, 2150007282, 2150007287, 2150007291, 2150007292, 2150007295, 2150007296, 2150007298, 2150007311, 2150007315, 2150007325, 2150007336, 2150007339, 2150007344, 2150007353, 2150007362, 2150007366, 2150007378, 2150007386, 2150007410, 2150007421, 2150007432, 2150007458, 2150007462, 2150007463, 2150007466, 2150007469, 2150007478, 2150007488, 2150007505, 2150007506, 2150007511, 2150007513, 2150007530, 2150007535, 2150007540, 2150007553, 2150007633, 2150007637, 2150007651, 2150007692, 2150007695, 2150007705, 2150007707, 2150007711, 2150007714, 2150007715, 2150007718, 2150007754, 2150007760, 2150007766, 2150007775, 2150007782, 2150007796, 2150007840, 2150007867, 2150007873, 2150007886, 2150007887, 2150007892, 2150007896, 2150007897, 2150007899, 2150007906, 2150007916, 2150007924, 2150007935, 2150007947, 2150007952, 2150007978, 2150007991, 2150007994, 2150008004, 2150008005, 2150008022, 2150008023, 2150008053, 2150008059, 2150008063, 2150008073, 2150008074, 2150008143, 2150008185, 2150008190, 2150008205, 2150008211, 2150008212, 2150008214, 2150008222, 2150008236, 2150008246, 2150008247, 2150008265, 2150008267, 2150008290, 2150008354, 2150008407, 2150008416, 2150008500, 2150008507, 2150008509, 2150008528, 2150008541, 2150008573, 2150008580, 2150008590, 2150008682, 2150008721, 2150008731, 2150008737, 8000022150, 8000492150, 8000592150, 8000672150. **Auction Date: 25.08.2026 - UJJAIN DISTRICT - UJJAIN-VED NAGAR:** 4016000396, 4016001594, 4016001633, 4016001700, 4016001751, 4016001810, 4016001815, 4016001825, 4016001838, 4016001839, 4016001864, 4016001871, 4016001872, 4016001873, 4016001874, 4016001880, 4016001882, 4016001884, 4016001906, 4016001909, 4016001918, 4016001924, 4016001929, 4016001930, 4016001931, 4016001934, 4016001940, 4016001948, 4016001966, 4016001974, 4016001975, 4016001976, 4016001978, 4016001982, 4016001994, 4016002008, 4016002009, 4016002024, 4016002032, 4016002034, 4016002035, 4016002052, 4016002065, 4016002070, 4016002071, 4016002087, 4016002107, 4016002136, 4016002159, 4016002182, 4016002196, 4016002202, 4016002206, 4016002214, 4016002223, 4016002233, 4016002243, 4016002249, 4016002286, 4016002298, 4016002317, 4016002329, 4016002338, 4016002350, 4016002382, 4016002495, 4016002496, 4016002498, 4016002509, 4016002535, 4016002537, 4016002539, 4016002543, 4016002544, 4016002546, 4016002547, 4016002555, 4016002557, 4016002587, 4016002621, 4016002636, 4016002712, 4016002764, 4016002767, 4016002809, 4016002818, 4016002820, 4016002849, 4016002870, 4016002889, 4016002902, 4016002903, 4016002910, 4016002914, 4016002980, 4016003023, 8000084016.

Auction will be conducted at respective branches. please note if the auction does not get completed on the same day due to any reasons, the same will be conducted on 03.09.2026 at 10.00 am onwards at INDORE DISTRICT - MANGAL NAGAR-SUKHLIA: GROUND FLOOR, SURVEY NO:585/3, MANGAL NAGAR - SUKHLIAMANGAL NAGAR MAIN ROAD, OPPOSITE ICICI BANK,SUKHLIYA, INDORE, MADHYA PRADESH – 452010 .The bidders are requested to produce photo id card ,Pan card .The successful bidder should transfer the money through RTGS.

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD. | GOLD AUCTION NOTICE

Regd. Office: Muthoot Centre, TC No 27/3022, Punnen Road, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, India - 695001. CIN : U65929KL1997PLC011518, Ph: +91 471 4911400, 2331427.

Notice is hereby given for the information of all concerned that gold ornaments pledged with under mentioned branches of the company , which were overdue for redemption and which have not been redeemed so for in spite of repeated notices will be auctioned on 25.08.2026 from 10 am onwards.

Auction Date: 25.08.2026 - HISAR DISTRICT - ADAMPUR-MANDI: 4360000927, 4360000946, 4360000950, 4360000963, 4360000972, 4360000974, 4360000980, 4360000996, 4360001019, 4360001044, 4360001049, 4360001051, 4360001058, 4360001068, 4360001079, 4360001081, 4360001083, 4360001085, 4360001087, 4360001094, 4360001101, 4360001106, 4360001112, 4360001114, 4360001117, 4360001125, 4360001126, 4360001134, 4360001144, 4360001145, 4360001146, 4360001153, 4360001155, 4360001165, 4360001166, 4360001169, 4360001171, 4360001182, 4360001189, 4360001190, 4360001192, 4360001198, 4360001237, 4360001238, 4360001241, 4360001260, 4360001262, 4360001290, 4360001292, 4360001302, 4360001304, 4360001314, 4360001319, 4360001324, 4360001335, 4360001355, 4360001356, 4360001357, 4360001371, 4360001384, 4360001386, 4360001390, 4360001397, 4360001419, 4360001422, 4360001425, 4360001427, 4360001432, 4360001437, 4360001443, 4360001449, 4360001457, 4360001480, 4360001490, 4360001536, 4360001544, 4360001545, 4360001574, 4360001579, 4360001586, 4360001598, 4360001602, 4360001610, 4360001612, 4360001629, 4360001630, 4360001633. **BARWALA-HARYANA:** 4283001092, 4283001120, 4283001144, 4283001152, 4283001157, 4283001167, 4283001202, 4283001206, 4283001209, 4283001221, 4283001231, 4283001237, 4283001257, 4283001261, 4283001268, 4283001269, 4283001274, 4283001283, 4283001284, 4283001305, 4283001310, 4283001318, 4283001328, 4283001333, 4283001334, 4283001336, 4283001348, 4283001354, 4283001361, 4283001366, 4283001377, 4283001387, 4283001388, 4283001394, 4283001405, 4283001407, 4283001414, 4283001422, 4283001432, 4283001440, 4283001445, 4283001447, 4283001452, 4283001455, 4283001456, 4283001458, 4283001460, 4283001464, 4283001466, 4283001467, 4283001468, 4283001473, 4283001476, 4283001486, 4283001490, 4283001495, 4283001501, 4283001504, 4283001507, 4283001509, 4283001510, 4283001511, 4283001512, 4283001516, 4283001540, 4283001548, 4283001549, 4283001551, 4283001556, 4283001558, 4283001559, 4283001565, 4283001570, 4283001571, 4283001578, 4283001580, 4283001581, 4283001585, 4283001588, 4283001611, 4283001619, 4283001623, 4283001624, 4283001627, 4283001630, 4283001636, 4283001660, 4283001681, 4283001685, 4283001709, 4283001764, 4283001766, 4283001769, 4283001789, 4283001791, 4283001810, 4283001811, 4283001813, 4283001816, 4283001851, 4283001856, 4283001886, 4283001887, 4283001894, 4283001903, 4283001916, 4283001928, 4283001931, 4283001945, 4283001977, 4283001981, 4283001989, 4283002026, 4283002027, 4283002043, 4283002058, 4283002065, 4283002070, 4283002071, 4283002072, 4283002079, 4283002080, 4283002081, 4283002084, 4283002102, 4283002123, 4283002134, 4283002135, 4283002150, 4283002151, 4283002166, 4283002183, 4283002198, 4283002208, 4283002222, 4283002224, 4283002233, 4283002247, 4283002256, 4283002269, 4283002282, 4283002284, 4283002286. **HANSI-HARYANA:** 1821001140, 1821001481, 1821001482, 1821001483, 1821001486, 1821001516, 1821001542, 1821001556, 1821001567, 1821001572, 1821001605, 1821001616, 1821001624, 1821001633, 1821001639, 1821001642, 1821001650, 1821001651, 1821001663, 1821001676, 1821001686, 1821001702, 1821001712, 1821001723, 1821001736, 1821001741, 1821001760, 1821001763, 1821001779, 1821001781, 1821001788, 1821001790, 1821001791, 1821001794, 1821001797, 1821001805, 1821001807, 1821001810, 1821001815, 1821001821, 1821001834, 1821001836, 1821001843, 1821001845, 1821001847, 1821001871, 1821001875, 1821001885, 1821001887, 1821001894, 1821001902, 1821001924, 1821001927, 1821001928, 1821001929, 1821001934, 1821001935, 1821001937, 1821001938, 1821001951, 1821001953, 1821001972, 1821001973, 1821001974, 1821001991, 1821001998, 1821002005, 1821002007, 1821002017, 1821002024, 1821002025, 1821002029, 1821002040, 1821002050, 1821002055, 1821002057, 1821002062, 1821002067, 1821002076, 1821002098, 1821002107, 1821002132, 1821002165, 1821002173, 1821002184, 1821002185, 1821002189, 1821002204, 1821002249, 1821002267, 1821002268, 1821002269, 1821002272, 1821002274, 1821002278, 1821002284, 1821002288, 1821002289, 1821002290, 1821002308, 1821002328, 1821002331, 1821002344, 1821002376, 1821002384, 1821002391, 1821002404, 1821002411, 1821002420, 1821002447, 1821002461, 1821002502, 1821002548, 1821002597, 1821002602, 8000071821, 8000401821, 8000441821, 8000471821. **HISAR:** 0847001794, 0847002122, 0847002138, 0847002156, 0847002197, 0847002198, 0847002199, 0847002209, 0847002225, 0847002233, 0847002241, 0847002277, 0847002359, 0847002405, 0847002463, 0847002480, 0847002482, 0847002540, 0847002571, 0847002630, 0847002656, 0847002667, 0847002681, 0847002703, 0847002809, 0847002813, 0847002815, 0847002839, 0847002865, 0847002897, 0847002908, 0847002919, 0847002939, 0847003024, 0847003054, 0847003055, 0847003065, 0847003071, 0847003167, 0847003231, 0847003255, 0847003299, 0847003367, 8000370847, GL/HSAR/188. **HISAR-URBAN ESTATE:** 1896001161, 1896001229, 1896001248, 1896001270, 1896001282, 1896001292, 1896001327, 1896001454, 1896001510, 1896001513, 1896001524, 1896001558, 1896001561, 1896001572, 1896001573, 1896001582, 1896001596, 1896001601, 1896001610, 1896001617, 1896001622, 1896001623, 1896001632, 1896001641, 1896001656, 1896001671, 1896001696, 1896001708, 1896001734, 1896001806, 1896001900, 1896001956, 1896001970, 1896001981, 1896002010, 1896002020, 1896002056, 1896002062, 1896002111, 1896002213, 1896002223, 1896002228, 1896002243, 1896002253, 1896002259, 1896002264. **Auction Date: 25.08.2026 - JIND DISTRICT - JIND-HARYANA:** 1658001493, 1658001495, 1658001525, 1658001526, 1658001584, 1658001603, 1658001651, 1658001657, 1658001676, 1658001680, 1658001711, 1658001754, 1658001777, 1658001778, 1658001790, 1658001795, 1658001796, 1658001801, 1658001806, 1658001822, 1658001842, 1658001843, 1658001845, 1658001846, 1658001861, 1658001887, 1658001894, 1658001906, 1658001928, 1658001955, 1658001956, 1658001963, 1658001968, 1658001970, 1658001975, 1658001990, 1658001996, 1658001998, 1658001999, 1658002002, 1658002021, 1658002054, 1658002057, 1658002073, 1658002088, 1658002091, 1658002101, 1658002102, 1658002103, 1658002112, 1658002133, 1658002147, 1658002154, 1658002163, 1658002189, 1658002196, 1658002211, 1658002237, 1658002281, 1658002299, 1658002339, 1658002345, 1658002367, 1658002393, 1658002420, 1658002500, 1658002503, 1658002532, 1658002571, 1658002586, 1658002592, 1658002593, 1658002619, 1658002620, 1658002626, 1658002631, 1658002637, 1658002668, 1658002674, 1658002680, 1658002693, 1658002703, 1658002719, 1658002721, 1658002726, 1658002731, 1658002732, 1658002795, 1658002797, 1658002807, 1658002850, 1658002852, 1658002864, 1658002912, 1658002914, 1658002917, 1658002924, 1658002991, 1658002998, 1658003022, 1658003027, 1658003084, 1658003101, 1658003102, 8000161658, 8000511658. **NARWANA-HARYANA:** 1820001191, 1820001204, 1820001223, 1820001239, 1820001251, 1820001266, 1820001271, 1820001318, 1820001333, 1820001334, 1820001393, 1820001395, 1820001433, 1820001468, 1820001493, 1820001501, 1820001520, 1820001530, 1820001538, 1820001541, 1820001551, 1820001558, 1820001566, 1820001570, 1820001573, 1820001577, 1820001587, 1820001591, 1820001599, 1820001600, 1820001602, 1820001609, 1820001638, 1820001649, 1820001652, 1820001655, 1820001662, 1820001665, 1820001669, 1820001670, 1820001675, 1820001685, 1820001693, 1820001694, 1820001709, 1820001710, 1820001718, 1820001721, 1820001729, 1820001730, 1820001736, 1820001738, 1820001744, 1820001752, 1820001774, 1820001775, 1820001784, 1820001785, 1820001788, 1820001789, 1820001791, 1820001793, 1820001794, 1820001799, 1820001802, 1820001813, 1820001817, 1820001818, 1820001823, 1820001824, 1820001830, 1820001845, 1820001878, 1820001882, 1820001887, 1820001910, 1820001919, 1820001958, 1820001962, 1820001995, 1820002017, 1820002086, 1820002110, 1820002112, 1820002126, 1820002199, 1820002204, 1820002230, 1820002242, 1820002250, 1820002255, 1820002256, 1820002272, 1820002289, 1820002292, 1820002301, 1820002320, 1820002324, 1820002336, 1820002344, 1820002348, 1820002354, 1820002357, 1820002379, 1820002393, 1820002414, 1820002415, 1820002428, 1820002429, 1820002431, 1820002432, 1820002433, 1820002464, 1820002474, 1820002476, 1820002490, 1820002492, 1820002493, 1820002495, 1820002496, 1820002501, 1820002510, 1820002528, 1820002556, 1820002604, 1820002663, 1820002678, 1820002762. **PATIALA CHOWK-JIND:** 4052001512, 4052001527, 4052001551, 4052001562, 4052001568, 4052001614, 4052001622, 4052001639, 4052001681, 4052001682, 4052001685, 4052001698, 4052001699, 4052001700, 4052001703, 4052001708, 4052001715, 4052001717, 4052001750, 4052001776, 4052001799, 4052001814, 4052001820, 4052001839, 4052001862, 4052001871, 4052001890, 4052001912, 4052001913, 4052001914, 4052001918, 4052001924, 4052001938, 4052001943, 4052001946, 4052001949, 4052001992, 4052002007, 4052002031, 4052002033, 4052002042, 4052002045, 4052002046, 4052002061, 4052002062, 4052002067, 4052002087, 4052002102, 4052002107, 4052002115, 4052002124, 4052002132, 4052002135, 4052002142, 4052002145, 4052002152, 4052002154, 4052002176, 4052002186, 4052002201, 4052002210, 4052002244, 4052002247, 4052002258, 4052002264, 4052002272, 4052002282, 4052002290, 4052002304, 4052002305, 4052002310, 4052002311, 4052002320, 4052002323, 4052002337, 4052002374, 4052002502, 4052002509, 4052002531, 4052002562, 4052002582, 4052002608, 4052002628, 4052002630, 4052002634, 4052002635, 4052002638, 4052002663, 4052002679, 4052002690, 4052002706, 4052002738, 4052002744, 4052002750, 4052002751, 4052002800, 4052002813, 4052002824, 4052002866, 4052002883, 4052002902, 4052002927, 4052002978, 4052002981, 4052003156, 4052003160.

Auction will be conducted at respective branches. please note if the auction does not get completed on the same day due to any reasons, the same will be conducted on 03.09.2026 at 10.00 am onwards at HISAR DISTRICT - HISAR-URBAN ESTATE: FIRST FLOOR, MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD , SCF-89, , URBAN ESTATE DELHI ROAD, NEARSAINI SWEETS , HISAR, HARYANA , 125001 .The bidders are requested to produce photo id card ,Pan card .The successful bidder should transfer the money through RTGS.

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD

District Child Protection Unit

Room No. 407, Fourth Floor Mini secretariat, Panipat
Phone No. 0180-2641574 | E Mail: Icpspnp.wcd@gmail.com

1. बालक का नाम : अज्ञात उम्र लगभग 6 माह

वर्तमान तस्वीर

विवरण – दिनांक 27-06-2026 को जिला पानीपत में उपरोक्त बच्चा लावारिस हालत में नेताजी एक्सप्रेस गाड़ी संख्या 13051 में सीट नंबर 63 पर नाम पता ना मालूम मिला जिसके शरीर पर गेहुए रंग की टीशर्ट हरे रंग की निकर दोनों हाथों में नजरिया, दोनों हाथों व पैरों में कडूली व गले में चैन थी। बच्चे के साथ एक बैग में तीन जोड़ी कपड़े एक छोटी गिलासी, दूध की बोतल, मिल्क पाउडर तथा डायपर मिले। बालक का हुलिया रंग सांवला, गोल चेहरा, स्वस्थ शरीर है। बालक की FIR थाना – जीआरपी, पानीपत में दर्ज है। जिसका FIR NO-0048 दिनांक 28-06-26 में दर्ज है। बालक बाल कल्याण समिति, पानीपत द्वारा जारी आदेशानुसार सिविल अस्पताल, पानीपत एसएनसीयू यूनिट में रह रहा था तत्पश्चात बाल कल्याण समिति, पानीपत कार्यालय के पत्र क्रमांक 1295-1299 दिनांक 03/07/2026 अनुसार बालक को दिनांक 03/07/2026 में बाल कल्याण समिति, कैथल में स्थानांतरित करवाया गया है।

2. बालक का नाम: अंकुश उम्र लगभग 14 साल

वर्तमान तस्वीर

विवरण: एक बालक जो अपना नाम अंकुश पिता का नाम धर्मेंद्र, निवासी पावीपुर, स्टेशन बासलीगंज, गया (बिहार) बताता है। वह अपनी मां का नाम रीना बताता है । बालक की उम्र लगभग 14 वर्ष है। दिनांक 08-07-2026 में बालक जिला पानीपत में लावारिस हालत में पेप्सी पुल रिफाइनरी के पास घुमता हुआ मिला । बालक का रोजनामचा अनुरोध संख्या 36 दिनांक 8.7.2026 थाना सदर (पानीपत) में दर्ज है। बालक दिनाक 08-07-2026 से बाल कल्याण समिति, पानीपत के आदेशानुसार बाल श्रमिक पुनर्वास केन्द्र, वाल देख-रेख केन्द्र, शिव नगर, गली न0-3, पानीपत में रह रहा है।

3. बालिका का नाम लकीप्रीत@ लकी उम्र 13-14 वर्ष

वर्तमान तस्वीर

विवरण – बालिका जो अपना नाम लकीप्रीत @ लकी बताती है। वह नए बस स्टैंड, शिवा (पानीपत) के पास घूमती हुई मिली जिसका रोजनामचा अनुरोध संख्या 39 दिनांक 30/6/2026, थाना सेक्टर 29, पानीपत में दर्ज है। वालिका अपने माता-पिता का नाम अपना स्थाई पता बताने में असमर्थ है। दिनाक 01-07-2026 से बाल कल्याण समिति, पानीपत के आदेशानुसार एकता बिहार कॉलोनी, उझा रोड स्थित ओपन शेल्टर होम (सृष्टि कल्याण समिति), पानीपत में रह रही है।

विशेष नोट :- यदि उपरोक्त बालको / बालिका का कोई संरक्षक / माता पिता / परिजन / रिश्तेदार हो जो यह सूचना पड़ रहा है तो वह 15 दिन के अंतर्गत निम्न पते पर सम्पर्क करे। यदि 15 दिन तक कोई सम्पर्क नहीं करता है तो बालको / बालिका की दतक ग्रहण प्रक्रिया हेतु बाल कल्याण समिति, पानीपत द्वारा आवश्यक कार्यवाही अम्ल में लायी जायेगी ।

सूचना देने हेतु पता :-
जिला बाल संरक्षण यूनिट,
बाल कल्याण समिति, पानीपत कमरा न० 407,
चौथी मंजिल, लघु सचिवालय पानीपत (हरियाणा)
फोन न०-0180-2641574, 2642574
9255644002

हस्ता./-
जिला बाल संरक्षण अधिकारी
जिला बाल संरक्षण समिति, पानीपत।

No.47469/HRY

Bangalore Electricity Supply Company Limited

(A wholly owned Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
(CIN: U04010KA2002SGC030438)

E-TENDER NOTIFICATION (Through KPP Portal only)

BESCOM invites Request For Proposal (RFP) vide **Tender No.:BESCOM/2026-27/SE0470** for **"Selection of Solar Power Generators (SPGs) on the basis of Build, Own & Operate (BOO) for Design, Survey, Supply, Installation, Testing, Commissioning, Operation & Maintenance of grid connected distributed solar power plants for solarization of Sub-Station (SS) of capacity 500MW in BESCOM jurisdiction, its associated 11kV line to connect the plant with concerned SS and Remote Monitoring System (RMS) of solar power plants through RESCO mode, under Non-CFA category for 25 years under CM-SKY (Mukhya Mantri Soura Krishi Yojane) Scheme".** The bid documents will be available **on or after 29.07.2026 in https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.** The prospective bidders have to register on the bidding portal. For any queries regarding portal, please contact KPPP helpdesk no.:080-46010000, 080-68948777 or email: support@eprochelpdesk.com.

Sd/- General Manager(Ele.), DSM,
BESCOM, Bengaluru

For Electricity related complaints call: 1912
Download BESCOM Mithra Mobile APP

DIRECTORATE OF TOWN AND COUNTRY PLANNING, HARYANA

Nagar Yojana Bhavan, Plot No. 3, Block-A, Sector-18-A, Madhya Marg, Chandigarh. Tele-Fax: -0172-2548475: 0172-2549851,
E-mail:tcpharyana7@gmail.com | Web Site www.tcpharyana.gov.in

Memo No. RCP-29-Vol-XVI-A/SD(RD)/2026/25359

Dated: 16-07-26

Public Notice

The sectoral plans of Sector-99A, Gurugram-Manesar Urban Complex bearing Drawing no. DTP (G) 2319/2016 dated 18.10.2016 stands approved.

A representation dated 06.03.2026 was received from Sh Abhiram Sharma (on behalf of all co-owners) for re-alignment of proposed 24.0 mtr. wide Road of Sector-99A, Gurugram. Accordingly, Government has decided to grant in-principle approval to amend the sectoral plan of Sector-99A, Gurugram-Manesar Urban Complex. A copy of earlier approved sectoral plan as well as proposed revised sectoral plan has been hosted on the Departmental website namely **www.tcpharyana.gov.in**.

Any person having any objection to the proposed revision of sectoral plan may file his/her objection alongwith reasons in writing in the office of Senior Town Planner, Gurugram situated at HSVP Complex Sector-14, Gurugram within a period of 30 days from this notice. The objections received after given period will not be entertained.

Dated:-
Place:- Chandigarh
No.47437/HRY

(Amit Khatri, IAS)
Director, Town and Country Planning,
Haryana, Chandigarh.

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

The Chief Workshop Manager/SEC Railway, MIB/WS, Nagpur, acting for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender for execution of work mentioned below:

Tender Notice No. MIBW/2026/19/06/03/04R dated 17/07/2026, **Name of Work:** Testing of Chain Pulley blocks, sling chains, EOT Cranes, Electrical hoists, Gantry mobile jacks and internal and external testing of pressure vessels etc. of Motibagh Workshop, Nagpur through Government authorized competent outside agency for two years. **Approx Tender Value (in ₹):** ₹ 1,11,869.28 (Rupees One Lakh Eleven Thousand Eight Hundred Sixty-Nine and Paisa Twenty-Eight Only inclusive all taxes), **Earnest Money (in ₹):** ₹ 2,200/- (Rupees Two Thousand Two Hundred Only), **Tenure of contract:** 24 Months from the date of issue of LOA, **Cost of Tender Form in ₹:** ₹ 0/- (Rupees Zero only)

Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids up to 11:00 hrs. on 08/08/2026 only.

Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offers received shall be rejected. Details are available on our website **www.ireps.gov.in**.

Workshop Manager, Motibagh Workshop/
PAM/26/58 **SECR/Nagpur**

South East Central Railway @secrail

"IMPORTANT"

Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No.:JHS/W/T/Tender General/176 **Date : 21.07.2026**

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG-C-2026-176, **Description of work:** Supplying and stacking of SKV Welding Portions for 60 kg 90UTS /60Kg/60EI R-260 Rails with complete accessories under Sr. DEN/C/ Jhansi's jurisdiction.

Approx. Cost : ₹ 2,11,45,059.48	**Earnest Money :** ₹ 4,22,900.00
Date of closing Tender : 12.08.2026 at 15:00 hrs.	
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 24 Months	

(1) Tender online can be submitted up to **15:00** hrs on **12.08.2026 (2)** For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in**

1674/26 (MG)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD. | GOLD AUCTION NOTICE

Regd. Office: Muthoot Centre, TC No 27/3022, Punnen Road, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, India - 695001. CIN : U65929KL1997PLC011518, Ph: +91 471 4911400, 2331427.

Notice is hereby given for the information of all concerned that gold ornaments pledged with under mentioned branches of the company , which were overdue for redemption and which have not been redeemed so for in spite of repeated notices will be auctioned on 25.08.2026 from 10 am onwards.

Auction Date: 25.08.2026 - DURG DISTRICT - BHILAI: 4388001650, 4388001652, 4388001655, 4388001685, 4388001708, 4388001725, 4388001752, 4388001769, 4388001886, 4388001898, 4388001904, 4388001931, 4388001958, 4388002012, 4388002054, 4388002058, 4388002062, 4388002066, 4388002091, 4388002100, 4388002129, 4388002130, 4388002133, 4388002193, 4388002202, 4388002308, 4388002324, 4388002371, 4388002457, 4388002496, 4388002504. **Auction Date: 25.08.2026 - RAIPUR DISTRICT - RAIPUR:** 4332000566, 4332000586, 4332000601, 4332000602, 4332000603, 4332000641, 4332000651, 4332000662, 4332000664, 4332000671, 4332000693, 4332000699, 4332000717, 4332000720, 4332000729, 4332000734, 4332000735, 4332000736, 4332000737, 4332000763, 4332000784, 4332000792, 4332000800, 4332000803, 4332000821, 4332000829, 4332000842, 4332000846, 4332000847, 4332000860, 4332000889, 4332000912, 4332000914, 4332000916, 4332000965, 4332000970, 4332001000, 4332001010, 4332001013, 4332001021, 4332001022, 4332001050, 4332001063, 4332001069, 4332001070, 4332001118, 4332001155, 4332001156.

Auction will be conducted at respective branches. please note if the auction does not get completed on the same day due to any reasons, the same will be conducted on 03.09.2026 at 10.00 am onwards at RAIPUR DISTRICT - RAIPUR: GROUND FLOOR,SHOP NOS 03 & 04,PART 41,LALGANGA MINDAS,KHASRA NO 261/4,PLOT NO 80,OPP TO RAIPUR ICE FACTORY,FAFADIH,RRAJIV GANDHI WARD NO.19,RAIPUR,CHHATTISGARH-492009 .The bidders are requested to produce photo id card ,Pan card .The successful bidder should transfer the money through RTGS.

MUTHOOT FINCORP LTD

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER IRRIGATION CONSTRUCTION DIVISION

OKHLA NEW DELHI-110025
PHONE NO:- 01126940377
E-mail:- eeicdokhland25@gmail.com

E-Procurement Notice Inviting Tender No.- 02/EE/2026-27

Online Quotation/ rates (inclusive all taxes/G.S.T. w.e.f. dt. 01.17.2017) of supply of O.P.C. (43 grade) Cement IS Code 8112/1989 and P.P.C. Cement IS Code 1489/1991 at 28 destinations/stores of U.P. are invited by the undersigned on behalf of the Governor of Uttar Pradesh, from original Cement manufecturers (having production capacity not less than one lac bag per day) only.

The rates/Quotation must be submitted online in website "**https://etender.up.nic.in**" under Irrigation Department during date 28.07.2026 (02:00 P.M.) to 06-08-2026 till 02:30 P.M. and the tender will open on 06-08-2026 at 03:00 P.M. All quotations may be downloaded and uploaded in requisite BOQ "Excel Format" on e-procurement website "**https://etender.up.nic.in**" during above said period ONLY. Bidders' digital signature issued by the nominated agency must have to be registered for participation in e-tender process by registering in above said e-tender Website.

Remaining detail can be had from above said "**https://etender.up.nic.in**" during stipulated period.

Sl. NO.	supply of O.P.C. (43 grade) Cement IS Code 8112/1989 and P,P.C. Cement Code 1489/1991 as per (50 kg. pack) at following departmental stores including loading, transportation up to stores, unloading, stacking and all taxes (G.S.T. etc.)	Tentative Quantity of OPC (43 Grade) IS Code 8112-1989/269-2015 Cement Supply (in 50 kg. pack)	Tentative Quantity of PPC IS Code 1489-1991/part-1 2015 Cement Supply (in 50 kg. pack)
1	Ghaziabad	500	500
2	Meerut	1000	800
3	Saharanpur	1000	800
4	Moradabad	1000	800
5	Bareilly	1000	800
6	Pilibhit	1000	800
7	Aligarh	1000	800
8	Mathura	500	500
9	Bijnor	1000	800
10	Kasganj	500	500
11	Bulandsahar	1000	800
12	Mainpuri	500	500
13	Rampur	1000	800
14	Shikohabad	500	500
15	Firozabad	500	500
16	Muzaffarnagar	500	500
17	Agra	500	500
18	Etah	1000	800
19	Amroha	1000	800
20	Shamli	500	500
21	Khurja	500	500
22	Bodaun	500	500
23	Hapur	1000	800
24	Bagpat	500	500
25	Hathras	500	500
26	Sambhal	1000	800
27	Gautam Buddha Nagar	500	500
28	Kalagarh (Uttrakhand)	500	500
29	Haridwar(Uttrakhand)	500	500

Note:-Terms and conditions related to above tender/quotation are available on website **https://etender.up.nic.in**

(Satish Kumar)
EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
IRRIGATION CONSTRUCTION DIVISION
OKHLA NEW DELHI-110025

UPID-254017 Dt. 22/07/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, ग्रामीण अभियन्त्रण विभाग, परिमण्डल-अलीगढ़।

पता :- धनीपुर ब्लाक रोड़, निकट केनरा बैंक ट्रेनिंग सेन्टर, धनीपुर अलीगढ़।

पत्रांक-694 / ग्रा०अ०वि०/निविदा/अलीगढ़ / पत्रा०सं० लेखा-03 / अनु०लि0/2026-27 दिनांक 15.07.2026

ई-निविदा (द्वितीय कॉल)

1- महामहिम राज्यपाल, उत्तर प्रदेश, की ओर से अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, ग्रामीण अभियन्त्रण विभाग, अलीगढ़ परिमण्डल-अलीगढ़ द्वारा प्रतिशत दर पर इलैक्ट्रानिक प्रणाली के माध्यम से योग्य एवं अनुमोदित ठेकेदारों जो कि यू०पी०आर०ई०डी० में मार्ग निर्माण कार्य हेतु उपयुक्त श्रेणी ए, बी एवं सी० में पंजीकृत है, से निम्नलिखित कार्य की निविदा आमंत्रित करते है।

2- कार्य का नाम तालिका के अनुसार

क्र. सं.	जनपद का नाम	विधान सभा/लोक सभा का नाम	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलन की धनराशि (रू० लाख में) जी०एस० टी० सहित	निविदा की जमानत धनराशि (रु० लाख में)	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य जी०एस०टी० सहित (रुपए में)	वर्षा ऋतु को सम्मिलित करते हुये कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	अलीगढ़	विधान सभा इगलास	विकास खण्ड गोण्डा के ग्राम पाइंनदापुर के ग्राम मगधा में दिनेश चन्द्र शर्मा के ट्यूबेल से शंकरी लहरीखेड़ा तक सी०सी० निर्माण कार्य।	49.40	1.00	3500.00	6 Month
2	अलीगढ़	विधान सभा खैर	विकास खण्ड खैर के ग्राम चौधाना में मुख्य मार्ग से गौशाला तक सी०सी० निर्माण कार्य।	52.16	1.05	3500.00	6 Month
3	अलीगढ़	विधान सभा बरौली	विकास खण्ड चण्डौस गभाना बरौली से मोहरैना प्रा० स्कूल तक सड़क निर्माण कार्य।	86.25	1.75	3500.00	6 Month
4	एटा	अलीगंज /फरुर्खाबाद	ग्राम नगला बरी से दादूपुर असगरपुर तक सम्पर्क मार्ग का निर्माण कार्य।	64.81	1.30	3500.00	6 Month

3- बिड डाक्यूमेन्ट की बेबसाईट पर उपलब्धता का दिनांक - 27.07.2026

4- ई-प्रोक्यूरमेन्ट के माध्यम से निविदा डालने की अन्तिम तिथि एवं समय 11.08.2026 को दोपहर 12:00 बजे तक।

5- ई- प्रोक्यूरमेन्ट के माध्यम से निविदाये खोलने की तिथि एवं समय 11.08.2026 को अपरान्ह 12:30 बजे ।

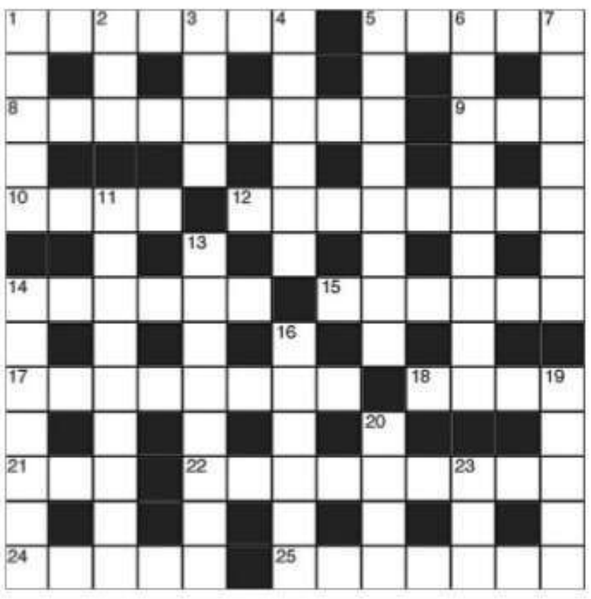
6- शासन के निदेर्शानुसार कार्य-कुशलता / Competitive Price Efficiency के रूप में 5 प्रतिशत धनराशि की कटौती भुगतान के समय की जायेगी।

7- नियोक्ता को आई०टी०बी० के प्रस्तर-10 के अनुसार अतिरिक्त जानकारी / शुद्धिपत्र ऑनलाइन जारी करने का अधिकार है जो किसी भी समाचार पत्र में प्रकाशित नही किया जायेगा। अतः निविदा प्रक्रिया में भाग लेने वाले समस्त निविदादाताओं को सुझाव दिया जाता है कि वे ई-निविदा पोर्टल को नियमित रूप से देखते रहें।

(दुष्यंत प्रताप)
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता,
ग्रामीण अभियन्त्रण विभाग,
परिमण्डल-अलीगढ़।

UPID-254003 Date 22/07/2026
www.upidadv.nic.in

CROSSWORD 6049



ACROSS
1 Not hard to find ten line errors (7)
5 Non-U field event records (5)
8 He is held by a form of respect and revulsion (3,6)
9 A gold-plated propeller blade (3)
10 How fire can become widespread (4)
12 Took a quiet walk in the street and tumbled (8)
14 Wrongs a source of Shakespearean comedy (6)
15 Say positively that it's a source of tension (6)
17 A new look for cars here (8)
18 Like one always starting in the East (4)
21 Are out for a time (3)
22 What a cash register does is to stop fiddling (4,5)
24 Tour arranged round Denmark's first royal house (5)
25 Jacket twice as big as one sort of shirt (7)

DOWN
1 Afterwards? Dead right! (5)
2 Born of woman (3)
3 Aristocrat in a real mess (4)
4 Break for food in an attempt to reach agreement (6)
5 Gets into bad shape (8)
6 Takes responsibility for roughshod rules (9)
7 Big steps tried out on board (7)
11 Strong line taken at a trade exhibition? (4,5)
13 A rest for anyone who's still alive (8)
14 Dedicated a Sterne novel (7)
16 Climbed — then peeled off (6)
19 A number with much to distribute (5)
20 Rising employment included a son of Isaac (4)
23 Billing omits Mr Crosby — sick (3)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6048 **ACROSS:** 1 Solicits, 5 Cues, 9 Angel, 10 Mahatma, 11 Takes the lead, 13 To date, 14 Flagon, 17 Perambulator, 20 Against, 21 Ennui, 22 Sump, 23 Presides **DOWN:** 1 Stag, 2 Laggard, 3 Called to mind, 4 Tomato, 6 Untie, 7 Standing, 8 Cheerleaders, 12 Stopgaps, 15 Groaned, 16 Cutter, 18 Realm, 19 Miss

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

I just need enough to ___ _ ___ until I need more - Bill Hoest (4,2,4)

GSEEE

DIOYDT

HNIOR

EIOSMV

SOLUTIONS: Geese, Rhino, Oddity, Movies
ANSWER: I just need enough to **tide me over** until I need more - Bill Hoest

OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON

MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG

SUDOKU 6389

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 3s
INSTRUCTIONS
To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

			5	8				
					4	6	7	
	6	1			9			
8						9	2	3
	1						8	
3	9	5						7
			3			1	9	
	7	8	6					
				2	5			

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6388

9	4	5	7	3	8	2	1	6
2	3	8	6	9	1	7	5	4
1	7	6	4	5	2	8	3	9
6	2	4	1	8	3	9	7	5
3	5	1	9	2	7	6	4	8
8	9	7	5	6	4	3	2	1
7	1	2	8	4	6	5	9	3
4	8	9	3	7	5	1	6	2
5	6	3	2	1	9	4	8	7

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): It's the perfect day to tell someone how much you care for them. This might be a family member or someone who lives with you. It might be a co-worker and, of course, it could be a romantic interest. Tonight: Study and learn.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): All your conversations with others are charming today. People want to hear what you have to say. You might choose today to tell siblings, relatives and neighbours something positive — something they will want to hear. Tonight: Check your finances.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Financial discussions will go well today. Whatever transpires, you will be the one who is laughing all the way to the bank. You also might shop for beautiful things today. Tonight: Be affectionate.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Today you'll enjoy reading for pleasure, socialising, enjoying concerts and doing anything where you can appreciate the beauty and talents of others. Visit art galleries, museums, architectural buildings and parks. Tonight: Get organised.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Sports events, the arts, museums, galleries and activities with kids will appeal. This is a romantic day. New romance can begin and existing relationships can blossom. Tonight: Socialise and have fun.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Romance is in the air today, making this a lovely, sociable day! However, it's also an excellent day for you to buy wardrobe goodies. Enjoy the company of friends and groups. Someone's feedback or advice might be helpful. Bonus! Tonight: Relax.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): You can make great strides in whatever you want to do today. You can sweet talk your way into or out of anything. Enjoy socialising, reading for amusement, concerts, art exhibits and sports. Tonight: Interesting conversations.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): This is the perfect day to explore avenues in higher education. Doors will open for you because you're admired, well-spoken and convincing. You will hold people in the palm of your hand. Tonight: Maintain your possessions.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): This is a five-star day for you! The Moon is in your sign dancing with lucky, moneybags Jupiter. You will find that financial discussions about shared property and anything that is jointly held with someone else will favour you. Tonight: You win!

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): This is the perfect day to tell someone close to you how much they mean to you. Tell them that you care. And yet, so many of us leave it up to the imagination of someone very close. Travel plans look appealing! Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Some of you might have a crush on a co-worker or a person involved with your health regimen. Today is the day to let someone know that you care. You also might get caught up in competitive sports. Tonight: Be friendly.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Enjoy the company of loved ones. Do something special. You will also enjoy appreciating the arts and creative work of others. Your appreciation of beauty is heightened today. Tonight: You're admired.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Notice No. 2026-July-05 Dated: 21.07.2026
E-TENDER NOTICE
Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), N. C. Rly Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under:
SN: 1 | Tender No.: 2026-July-05-01 | Approx Cost ₹ : 96594781.22
Description of work: Provision of pathways at various stations under jurisdiction of ADEN/HQ/Agra & ADEN/Line/IDH
SN: 2 | Tender No.: 2026-July-05-03 | Approx Cost ₹ : 21003521.52
Description of work: (A) Provision of Toolboxes with Rest rooms for each Gang/Units under SSE/P. Way/AA under ADEN/HQ/Agra (B) Provision of Toolboxes with Rest rooms for each Gang/Units under SSE/PW/N/AGC under ADEN/Line/IDH
For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website "www.ireps.gov.in". Tenders can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" up to 15:00 hrs on 12.08.26 1675/26(AK)
North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Tarun Kumar S/o.Umesh Kumar, R/o.: H.No.10685, Gali No.09, Near Pratap Nagar Metro Station, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case vide **E-FIR No.80027614/2025 U/S 304(2)/317(2)/3(5) BNS** registered at **P.S. I.P. Estate, Central District, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Tarun Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Tarun Kumar** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said Tarun Kumar, accused of **E-FIR No.80027614/2025 U/S 304(2)/317(2)/3(5) BNS, P.S. I.P. Estate, Central District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.08.2026.**
By Order, Ms. Preeti
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03 (Central)
Central District, Room No.150
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi
DP/8033/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL COMMITTEE FARRUKHNAGAR (GURUGRAM)	ELECTION OF AGENCY FOR MECHANIZED AND MANUAL SWEEPING OF ROADS IN MC FARRUKHNAGAR	16.07.2026 06.08.2026	26000 + 18,62,700/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8222002777 secymcfarrukhnagar@gmail.com
2	MUNICIPAL COMMITTEE FARRUKHNAGAR (GURUGRAM)	SHIFTING 11 KV FEEDERS, TFS AND LT LINES (11 KV GANESH MARKET URBAN, 11 KV GUGANA AP, 11 KV MAJRI RDS, 11 KV PALRI RDS AND 11 KV CIVIL HOSPITAL (CHC) INDEPENDENT FEEDERS) FOR CONSTRUCTION AND WIDENING WORK OF PATAUDI-HALI MANDI ROAD FROM BUS STAND TO .	17.07.2026 27.07.2026	6000+ 1,42,400/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8222002777 secymcfarrukhnagar@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 47459/HRY

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

1.	N.I.T. No.	Project_DLI_SNT_26_11 dated 23.07.2026
2.	Name of work with its location	S&T work for interlocking of LC gates with TVU>10000 in section Delhi-Bathinda, Sonipat-Gohana & Shamli-Tapri section of Delhi Division of Northern Railway
3.	Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 2,86,53,570.90/-
4.	Bid Security deposit	Rs. 573100.00/-
5.	Completion period of work	12 Months
6.	Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Upto 11.30 hrs. on 14.08.2026. Opening of tender at 11.30 hrs on 14.08.2026.
7.	Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

No:- Project_DLI_SNT_26_11 Dated:- 23.07.2026 2538/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

RAJASTHAN HOUSING BOARD
No.:- 305 Dated :- 22/07/2026
NIT : 01/2026-27
Bids for **1.** Plantation and Maintenance work under Div.-I as IG Nagar Sector 1,11, 12 Phase-II **2.** Plantation and Maintenance work under Div.-I as MGD Nayala Phase-II **3.** Plantation and Maintenance work under Div.-I as R.K. Puram Kotputli Jaipur Phase-II **4.** Anti termite Treatment of wooden work & under Existing floors and Ceiling at Head Office building Jyoti Nagar, Jaipur **5.** Annual Maintenance Work (Sanitation) at R.K. Puram Colony Kotputli (for one year) **6.** Renovation of Office Building R.K. puram Kotputli **7.** Providing and fixing of Steel wardrobe, Fire Extinguisher cylinder & partition wall in RE Div.-I Sector 4,Indira Gandhi Nagar, Jagatpura, Jaipur. **8.** Annual Repair and Maintenance of Automatic sensor glass sliding door at H.O.Building, Jaipur are invited from interested bidders from 03.08.2026 to 12.08.2026 up to 6.00 pm. Other particular of bid may be visited on the procurement portal (**http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in**, **http://sppp.raj.nic.in**) of the state & **http://rhb.rajasthan.gov.in** Department website.
UBN No. :- RHB2627WSOB00101 to RHB2627WSOB00108
Raj.Samwad/C/26/7502 RESIDENT ENGINEER, Div.-I, JAIPUR

Mumbai Railway Vikas Corporation Ltd.
INVITATION FOR TENDER: MRVC/W/403
(Two - Envelope E-Procurement Tender)
Mumbai Railway Vikas Corporation Ltd. (MRVCL) having its corporate office at Second Floor, Churchgate Station Building, Mumbai-400020, invites e-Tenders for the **"Shifting of Signalling and Telecom Infringed Cables in connection with Badlapur-Karjat 3rd & 4th line under Mumbai Urban Transport project-3B (MUTP-3B)"**. Details of Tender and Tender document are available on **E-Procurement** website **https://eprocure.gov.in.** The last date for completed e-Tender submission at website **https://eprocure.gov.in** is on **25.08.2026 up to 15:00 hours**. **Corrigendum, if any, will be posted on the website only.**

UJVN LIMITED
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
P. O. "UJJAWAL" MAHARANI BAGH, GMS ROAD, DEHRADUN - 248006, CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866
Tele.: 0135-2763508, 2763808, Fax: 0135-2763507, website: www.ujvnl.com
Tender No.612 Date : 23.07.2026
TENDER NOTICE
Office of the Executive Engineer (Generation) Chibro Power House, Chibro, invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below ::
Tender No. 05/EE(G)/CPH/2026-27
Name of work/supply/services:"SITC of 03 nos. 800 A, 11kV VCBs Panel including dismantling of damaged VCBs panels and protection work of 33/11KV Transformers at 33/11 Sub Station Chibro".
Estimated cost: ₹ 24,00,185/- GST Extra,
Date of availability of tender on website: 23-07-2026 from 10:00 Hrs.
Last date for submission of bids on website: 13-08-2026 up to 15:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website **"www.ujvnl.com"**
EE(G),Chibro
"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
(Through e-tendering)

Name of work with its location	Comprehensive Annual maintenance Contract of HASSDAC of G.G.TRONICS make for three years over Delhi Division.
App. Cost of the work (₹)	Rs. 3,92,76,743.76/-
Bid Security (₹)	Rs. 7,85,500.00/-
Address of the office	Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer-C, Northern Railway, 3rd Floor, Annexe-1, DRM Office, New Delhi-110055.
Date & Time for uploading the tender/closing of tender	Tender uploading **22.07.2026**/ closing date & time - **13.08.2026** up to 15.00 hrs.
Website particular & notice board location where complete details of the tender can be seen etc.	See the Northern Railway website **www.ireps.gov.in** & Notice board at S&T branch, 3rd Floor, DRM Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055.

Tender No. 558-Sig-16-M-T-AMC-099 Dated: 22.07.2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2516/26

उदयपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, राजस्थान
No. :- F-2(01)Acct/Contract/2026-27/118 - 120 Date :- 20/07/2026
ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या : 31/2026-27
उदयपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, उदयपुर द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्यो मय डिफेक्ट लाईबिलिटी अवधि के लिये जो कि निविदा प्रपत्र में अंकित है के लिये उपयुक्त श्रेणी में पंजीकृत संवेदको से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई–टेण्डरिंग के माध्यम से ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है :–

निविदा कार्यो की कुल लागत	: रूपये 1019.07 लाख (02 कार्य)
ऑनलाईन निविदा प्रपत्र डाउनलोड / अपलोड करने की अवधि	: 21.07.2026 को प्रातः 10.00 बजे से 18.08.2026 को सांयः 6.00 बजे तक
Online EMD, Tender Fee & Processing Fee जमा कराने की तिथी	: 21.07.2026 को प्रातः 10.00 बजे से 18.08.2026 को सांयः 6.00 बजे तक
ऑनलाईन निविदा खोलने की तिथी	: 19.08.2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे

विस्तृत विवरण वेबसाईट **urban.rajasthan.gov.in/uitudaipur**, **www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** व **www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in** पर देखा जा सकता है।
UBN No. : ITU2627WLOB00190, ITU2627WLOB00191
अधिशाषी अभियन्ता - प्रथम
उदयपुर विकास प्राधिकरण
राज.संवाद/सी/26/7448

IKF FINANCE LIMITED
HEAD OFFICE : # 40-1-144, Corporate Centre, M.G.Road, Vijayawada-520 010. Phone No.: 0866-2474644.
DEMAND NOTICE [SECTION 13(2) SARFAESI Act]
A notice is hereby given that the following **Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s) (1) M S M S DEEPAK FOTO STUDIO Rep. by its Proprietor Pradeep Kumar Dhurvey,** R/o. House Number 1613, Behind Doctor Colony, Madfaiya Mohalla, Pauruwa Jabalpur- 482003, Madhya Pradesh. **(2) Mr. Pradeep Kumar Dhuruvey S/o Teekaram Dhuruvey,** R/o. House Number 1613, Behind Doctor Colony, Madfaiya Mohalla, Pauruwa Jabalpur - 482003, Madhya Pradesh. **(3) Mrs. Rachna Gound C/o Pradeep Dhurvey,** R/o. House Number 1613, Behind Doctor Colony, Madfaiya Mohalla, Pauruwa Jabalpur - 482003, Madhya Pradesh. **(4) Khusboo Dhurvey C/o Teekaram Dhurvey,** R/o. House Number 1613, Behind Doctor Colony, Madfaiya Mohalla, Pauruwa Jabalpur - 482003, Madhya Pradesh. **(5) Mrs. Gyanwati Dhurvey W/o Teekaram Dhrvey**, R/o. House Number 1613, Behind Doctor Colony, Madfaiya Mohalla, Pauruwa Jabalpur - 482003, Madhya Pradesh have defaulted in the repayment of principal and interest of the loans facility obtained by them from the **IKF Finance Limited** and the loans have been classified as **Non-Performing Asset (NPA).** The notices were issued to them under Section 13(2) of Securitization and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 on their last known addresses, but they have been returned unserved and as such they are hereby informed by way of this public notice.
Name of Borrower(s)/ Co- Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s): **(1) M S M S DEEPAK FOTO STUDIO Rep. by its Proprietor Pradeep Kumar Dhurvey**, R/o, House Number 1613, Behind Doctor Colony, Madfaiya Mohalla, Pauruwa Jabalpur 482003 - Madhya Pradesh, **(2) Mr. Pradeep Kumar Dhuruvey S/o Teekaram Dhuruvey**, R/o House Number 1613, Behind Doctor Colony, Madfaiya Mohalla, Pauruwa Jabalpur - 482003, Madhya Pradesh. **(3) Mrs. Rachna Gound C/o Pradeep Dhurvey**, R/o. House Number 1613, Behind Doctor Colony, Madfaiya Mohalla, Pauruwa Jabalpur - 482003, Madhya Pradesh. **(4) Khusboo Dhurvey C/o Teekaram Dhurvey,** R/o. House Number 1613, Behind Doctor Colony, Madfaiya Mohalla, Pauruwa Jabalpur - 482003 Madhya Pradesh. **(5) Mrs. Gyanwati Dhurvey W/o Teekaram Dhrvey,** R/o. House Number 1613, Behind Doctor Colony, Madfaiya Mohalla, Pauruwa Jabalpur - 482003, Madhya Pradesh.
Date of Notice: 22.07.2026 | Date of NPA: 04-07-2026
Amount outstanding (As on 22-07-2026) Rs.25,67,845/- (Rupees Twenty Five Lakh Sixty Seven Thousand Eight Hundred Forty Five Only)
DESCRIPTION OF THE PROPERTY
All that Mouza Purwa, Patwari halka Purwa, Tehsil-Gorkhpur, Disst-Jabalpur Khasra Number 211/2/4 Plot Area 3444 Seq. Ft (319.99 Sq. Mtr.) Jabalpur Madhya Pradesh and bounded as follows: **NORTH:** Jagdeesh Prasad, **SOUTH:** Patel Ji, **EAST:** Road, **WEST:** Kostha Ji
The steps are being taken for substituted service of notice. The above Borrower(s) and /or their Guarantor(s) are hereby called upon to make payment of outstanding amount within 60 days from the date of publication of this notice, failing which further steps will be taken after expiry of 60 days from the date of this notice under sub-section (4) of Section 13 of Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security interest Act, 2002. The borrowers attention is invited to provisions of Sub-section(8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available to redeem the secured assets
Date: 23.07.2026, Place: Jabalpur Sd/- Authorised Officer, IKF Finance Ltd.

Lakshmibai National Institute of Physical Education, Gwalior
Deemed to be University
Government of India,
Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports
No.: E/B&R/W.P. Treatment/49/2025-26/15 Date : 17.07.2026
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Sealed tenders in two bid system are invited for "PROVIDING AND LAYING WATER PROOFING TREATMENT IN PRATAP & AZAD HOUSE AT L.N.I.P.E, GWALIOR" from the eligible companies / firms/ contractors/ agencies, having experience of the similar works(s). The estimated cost is Rs. 48,47,135/- and EMD is Rs. 2,42,500/- only.
The interested companies /firms /contractors /agencies, who are qualified as per eligibility conditions of the tender, given in the tender form, may submit their tenders in the prescribed format along with EMD and required documents, by speed post or registered post or by hand, so as to reach /drop in the tender box at the office of Assistant Registrar (Estate), LNIPE, Gwalior by 03:00 PM on 10.08.2026, which shall be opened of 4:00 PM on dated 10.08.2026. The quoted rates of only those bidders shall be considered, who are found eligible as per eligibility criteria prescribed in the tender document, and who submit information and documents in all respect.
The tender-application form fee is NIL and the same containing detailed specifications, terms and conditions etc., are available on the website of Institute www.lnipe.edu.in, and CPP Portal, which may be downloaded for submission.
Registrar I/c

UTTARAKHAND POWER CORPORATION LTD.
(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Undertaking)
Victoria Cross Vijeyta Gabar Singh Urja Bhawan, Kanwali Road, Dehradun-248001
Corporate Identity No. U40109UP2001SGC025867/2358 Tel No. (0135) 2763672-76, Fax-(0135)2760289 Web.: www.uktenders.gov.in
E-TENDER NOTICE (NIT)
TENDER SPECIFICATION NO. CCP-II/9/2026-2027
Uttarakhand Power Corporation Ltd. Dehradun invites e-tender for following item :

Name of Item	Quantity (Nos.)	Estimate cost (in ₹ Lakh)	Average yearly Turn Over of Preceding Three Financial Year (in ₹ Crore)	Earnest Money Deposit in (₹Lakh)	Cost of tender document including GST (in ₹)	Date & Time of Prebid conference in online & Offline mode	Last Date & time of online request for Tender and Submission of Tender in online & Offline Mode	Date of opening of Part-I of Tender in online & Offline mode
33/0.4kV, 1000KVA, BIS mark EEL:2 (New) Copper Wound Distribution Transformer	3	98.45	1.97	1.97	5 900	03.08.2026 at 11:30 hrs. Victoria Cross Vijeta Gabar Singh Urja Bhawan, Kanwali Road, Dehradun	17.08.2026 upto 17:00 hrs.	18.08..2026 at 15:30 Hrs.

For further details please visit our website www.uktenders.gov.in
No.: 542/EE(CM)/UPCL/A-2 Dated : 23.07.2026
SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
Corporate (Contract & Procurement-II)
"SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF THE NATION. Use LED Bulb to Save Electricity
(Toll Free No. 1912) Pay Electricity Bill Online 24x7 from www.upcl.org. (For information on Electricity theft, informer may report to Toll Free No. 1800 180 4185/Fax No. 0135-2760911)

INDIA watch

GYMNASTICS
Men's team final and individual qualification (Tapan Mohanty, Swathish KP, Tapeshwarnath Das, Yogeshwar Singh) **5:00pm**

PARA SWIMMING
Men's S13 100m Freestyle Heats: (Ravi Veera Venkata Bhavani Karthik Budigina and Imam Ali) **3:40pm**

SWIMMING
Men's 50m Backstroke Heats: (Srihari Natraj) **3:56pm**

PARA POWERLIFTING
Men's Lightweight Final: (Ashok and Parmjeet Kumar) **5:40pm**
Women's Lightweight Final: (Jaspreet Kaur and Suman Devi) **7:24pm**
Women's Heavyweight Final: (Kasthuri Rajamani) **10:40pm**
Men's Heavyweight Final: (Sudhir and Jhandu Kumar) **(12:29am, Saturday)**

LAWN BOWLS
Women's Pairs Section match: India vs South Africa **7:30pm**
Men's Singles Section match: India vs Falkland Islands (Putul Sonowal vs Cecil Alexander) **10:20pm**

BOXING
Men's 55kg Round of 32: (Jadumani Singh vs Aaron Cullen, Scotland) **11:00pm**

Ready, steady... Glas-gow

A cyclist rides past The Hydro, the venue for the netball competition at the 2026 Commonwealth Games in Glasgow. PTI

THE PARED-down Commonwealth Games will feature just 10 sports, down from 19 at Birmingham in 2022. Seventeen sports were in the programme at the 2014 Glasgow Games.

SCOTSTOUN STADIUM, with a capacity of 10,000, is the venue for track and field, the biggest draw along with swimming. In 2014, track and field was held at the 46,000-seater Hampden Park.

ALL FOUR competition venues, Scotstoun Stadium, the Chris Hoy Velodrome, Tollcross International Swimming Centre, and the Scottish Event Campus, sit within an eight-mile radius of the city centre.

BADMINTON, HOCKEY wrestling, table tennis, squash and cricket, the sports that delivered nearly half of India's 61-medal haul in Birmingham, 2022, aren't on the Glasgow programme.

Lovlina assured of medal without even throwing a punch

Indian boxer Lovlina Borgohain arrives for a training session at the SEC Centre in Glasgow on Thursday. PTI

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 23

STAR INDIAN pugilist Lovlina Borgohain is already assured of a medal for India at the Commonwealth Games 2026 without even stepping into the ring or landing a single punch.

On Thursday, the day the CWG 2026 got underway in Glasgow, the boxer from Assam received a direct entry into the semifinals of the women's 75kg event, which guarantees her at least a bronze.

The Tokyo Olympic bronze medallist was handed a first-round bye in the five-boxer draw, automatically securing a place in the last four and assuring herself a podium finish. She will now take on Tuvalu's Tarona Khanum Badi Pasoni Taafaki in the semifinal on July 31, with the winner advancing to the gold medal bout.

This will be Lovlina's first Commonwealth Games medal and the only major multi-sport honour that had eluded her decorated career until now.

The 28-year-old has already won medals at the Olympic Games, World Championships, Asian Games, and Asian Championships.

Since only five boxers are featuring in the women's 75kg event, three of them — Lovlina, Taafaki, and Australia's Emma-Sue Greentree — received byes in the first round, which served as the quarterfinal. All three advanced to the semifinals without fighting.

England's Mary Kate Smith and Nigeria's Patricia Mbata will face each other in the only quarterfinal, with the winner taking on Greentree in the other semifinal.

In the previous edition in Birmingham in 2022, Lovlina had reached the quarterfinals of the light middleweight category, where she lost to Wales' Rosie Eccles.

Boxing has been a key sport for India at the Commonwealth Games, yielding 44 medals for the country so far.

At the Glasgow event, as many as eight Indian boxers have received first-round byes.

The likes of Jaismine Lamboria (57kg), Priya Ghanghas (60kg), and Preeti Pawar (54kg) are just one win away from securing medals.

DOWNSIZING TO SURVIVE

Commonwealth Games: LITE VERSION

No new venues, no athletes' village, a budget a fifth of the size of Birmingham's, and for India, the sports that delivered half its '22 medal haul not in the programme

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, July 23

AN INDIAN team member, who was in Glasgow 12 years ago as well, couldn't help but compare the mood then and now upon reaching Scotland's largest city. "In 2014," he says, "the central square was a lively place where everyone congregated, creating a party atmosphere. When I passed it today, all I heard was drilling sounds, the road was dug up, and it was out of bounds."

It isn't a lament so much as a statement of fact.

Exactly 12 years ago, during the opening ceremony of the previous Glasgow Commonwealth Games on July 23, 2014, Rod Stewart stood on a stage inside Celtic Park and belted out 'Can't Stop Me Now' to a crowd that brought the proverbial roof off. As the flame reached Glasgow for Thursday night's opening, the loudest noise this time is of the heavy construction machinery.

Host cities tend to expedite infrastructure projects to welcome an event of this magnitude. But Glasgow has been unwilling to disturb the city's rhythm to accommodate the CWG. It has, by design, kept the thousands who have descended upon Glasgow away from its centre, concentrating the Games within a leaner, tighter corridor, one that fits, quite literally, inside an eight-mile loop of the city.

That number, eight miles, has become the defining phrase of Glasgow 2026, repeated in every briefing and brochure. All four competition venues, Scotstoun Stadium, the Chris Hoy Velodrome, Tollcross International Swimming Centre, and the Scottish Event Campus, sit within that radius of the city centre. A visitor could, in theory, watch a swimming heat at Tollcross in the morning, be pitchside for netball at the SEC by early afternoon, and hop over to Scotstoun for athletics in the evening.

This compactness was born of necessity.

When the Australian state of Victoria withdrew as host in 2023, citing costs, the Commonwealth Games looked, for a moment, like it might not survive at all. Singapore, Malaysia and Gold Coast all weighed bids and walked away.

Glasgow stepped in with an unusual pitch: no new venues, no athletes' village, no ballooning budget, just the infrastructure already sitting from 2014, dusted off and reused. The Commonwealth Games Federation backed it with initial funding, and in September 2024 the deal was done.

The contrast with twelve years ago is stark. Glasgow 2014 was a sprawling, 17-sport spectacle that drew nearly 5,000 athletes from 71 nations, sold 1.1 million tickets, and was watched by an estimated billion people worldwide.

Bagpipers play in Glasgow ahead of the opening ceremony. PTI

Glasgow 2026 wears a rather thin look. The sport count has dropped from 17 to 10. There is no new athletes' village, competitors are billeted in existing city accommodation at hotels and college hostels.

There are no road events at all. Bowls, usually played outdoors on manicured greens, move indoors for the first time in the sport's Commonwealth history.

It is, by design, a Games with the fat trimmed to the bone. The numbers speak for themselves: the 2022 Birmingham CWG were held at a cost of £778 million; this time, the organisers have spent just £150 million.

And if the organisers sold more than a million tickets for Glasgow 2014, they hadn't even been able to sell the 13,000 tickets until a few hours before Thursday night's opening.

• Cost effective

£778 mn
THE COST: Birmingham 2022

£150 mn
THE COST: Glasgow 2024

No country will feel the cuts quite like India. Before the contingent departed, a sports ministry official requested the media not to 'panic' by looking at the medals table.

When the count begins, India might not feature in the top five, as it usually does. Badminton, hockey, wrestling, table tennis, squash and cricket, the sports that delivered nearly half of India's 61-medal haul in Birmingham, now aren't on the Glasgow programme.

Of the 210 athletes India sent to Birmingham in 2022, close to half competed in disciplines that no longer exist at these Games.

Wrestling alone handed India twelve medals last time; table tennis gave them five golds. There is no equivalent cushion here.

Narrower base

India's hopes now rest on a narrower base: athletics, weightlifting, boxing, judo and lawn bowls. It's a blunt reminder that a leaner Games doesn't cut costs evenly; it reshuffles winners and losers, and this time the shuffle has landed hardest on one of the Commonwealth's biggest sporting nations.

Even for those who are there, the Glasgow CWG is a mere warm-up for September's Asian Games. Vijay Sharma, the national weightlifting coach, has said Mirabai Chanu is unlikely to lift anywhere close to her personal best so that she remains fully fit for the Asiad, the only medal missing from her cabinet.

Adille Sumariwalla, the Athletics Federation of India spokesperson, recently said that they would have liked to send 'token' representation to Glasgow and rather focus on the continental event.

But India, as the hosts of the next CWG, couldn't have had a lean contingent. So, Neeraj Chopra headlines a strong track and field contingent.

Nearly all the sports that have been dropped are likely to return when Ahmedabad hosts the Games in four years. For now, Glasgow opens its second Commonwealth Games not with the unguarded joy of 2014, but with something quieter and more pragmatic.

A compact loop of familiar venues, a city betting that intimacy can be a substitute for scale, and a 'Lite' Games whose true shape will only be visible once the running, swimming and lifting actually begin.

Sonowal stuns former World Champion Bester

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 23

INDIA'S CAMPAIGN at the 2026 Commonwealth Games started with an upset win as debutant Putul Sonowal stunned 2023 world champion Ryan Bester of Canada in tie-break in Lawn Bowls Men's Singles on Thursday.

Rupa Rani Tirkey and Pinki Singh also won their Women's Pairs opening match against Malta in tie-break.

Lawn Bowls, a sport held majorly at the Commonwealth Games, is having singles and pairs competition this time.

Sonowal, the reigning Asian champion, kept his cool to clinch the tie-break for a remarkable win in his opening match in Section D. He faces Cecil Alexander of Falkland Islands in his second match on Friday.

In the Women's Pairs, Rupa Rani Tirkey (lead) and Pinki Singh (skip) dished out a dominant show in the first set, winning it 7-1 and going up 1-0 in the opening round match in section B.

India's Rupa Rani Tirkey during the Women Pair's event. PTI

But the Maltese duo of Rebecca Louise Rixon (lead) and Connie-Leigh Rixon (skip) fought back to take the second set 3-4. In the nervy tie-break, the Indians were lagging behind before Pinky sent down a fine effort in the last bowl and won the match.

The Indian pair face South Africa in their second match of Section B on Friday.

• FOOT-TAPPING MUSIC FOR GRAVITY-DEFYING MOVES

From *Bhool Bhulaiyaa* to *Dil To Pagal Hai*, Bollywood comes to gymnastics floor

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, July 23

SRI LANKAN-AMERICAN UCLA artistic gymnast Tiana Sumanasekara went viral earlier this summer at the NCAA Regionals, linking the ballad '*Tujhe Dekha Toh*' with the upbeat '*Sheila Ki Jawani*' before moving into the dramatic 'Dola Re Dola', earning a career-high score of 9.95. Bollywood hits have always carried the rhythm that elevates a competitive floor exercise routine, pepping it up as flying gymnasts go in search of perfection.

At the Glasgow Commonwealth Games over the coming weekend, India's own Protistha Samanta and Eshita Rewale will again lean on Bollywood hits as they compete in the All Around and Team qualifications, hoping to advance to the individual apparatus finals.

While Protistha has chosen the lilting *'Dil To Pagal Hai' Dance of Envy,* composed by Uttam Singh, Eshita was keen on Indian classical instrumentation and picked *'Mere Dholna'* (Ami Je Tomar, Version 1) by music composer Pritam, the song to which Monjulika dances in *Bhool Bhulaiyaa,* for her 90-second routine.

India's finest gymnast on the floor, Nishka Agarwal of Hyderabad, will instead opt for Gabriel Saban's 'Golden Cage', a title symphony by artist Noe Zagroun. It's a western classical piece that suits her elements and lines, which are less balletic and more in the realm of trance and suspense.

Medal hope Pranati Nayak will not feature on the All Around list in Glasgow, and hence will not perform the floor exercise. It was Nayak, though, the three-time Asian Championship medallist and World Cup winner, who had borrowed the *'Ek Tha Tiger'* banger *'Mashallah'* by Shreya Ghosal for her routine at the Tokyo Olympics. India last won a Commonwealth Games medal in gymnastics at Glasgow, when Dipa Karmakar rolled out her Produnova on the vault.

But at this edition, even as the Indians chase a vault medal, effort has also gone into improving floor scores.

Marking by judges for the floor routine changed after the 2024 Olympics, with a share of the points now devoted exclusively to choreography and dance: a fraction less about acrobatics, more about presentation. Or, as India's first World Cup medallist, Aruna Reddy, puts it: "It's not what lines and elements of the routine you perform in those 90 seconds, it's how."

India's Protistha Samanta has chosen the Dance of Envy from the Bollywood hit *Dil To Pagal Hai,* composed by Uttam Singh. INSTA

Bollywood music, and even Indian classical, as with Rewale's choice of a sitar, tabla and ghungroo-heavy piece, lends itself beautifully to storytelling. "In those 90 seconds, you're now expected to show a story, reveal a character in each line. You are marked for expression," says Reddy, who guided Hyderabad gymnast Nishka in her early years. "Her routine isn't flowing, it's more suspense," she says, explaining the staccato music.

Mumbai gymnast Eshita had insisted on showcasing an Indian classical piece when she trained at the Prabodhankar Thackeray complex and at Infinity in Pune.

'It's our culture'

A natural tumbler with a strong double tuck back pike, Eshita's coach, Vishal Katakdound, trained her by watching French gymnastics videos, but would also visit the Andheri Sports Complex, requesting rhythmic gymnast Vandita Raval to help with choreography. "Indian music helps bring artistry to acrobatic routines. It's our culture," Katakdound explained.

Indian gymnasts have traditionally struggled on the floor because, though they were good acrobats, the choreography tended to be sub-par; no Indian female floor gymnast has done well internationally. So this time, a 20-day camp in London brought in South Essex Gym Club Level 4 coach and choreographer Nicole Beckford to prepare the Indian lines.

Manoj Rana, who coaches Nishka, explains: "India has good judges who know where to deduct points. But we have no coaches who can help our girls with choreography. Artistry is missing. The music will help."

Ruby Evans is the big name on floor at Glasgow. So Rana took floor specialist Nishka to Kazakhstan last month, where she worked with renowned coach Andrei Levit, who smoothed out the edges and gave her the confidence to attempt a 5.3-difficulty routine, against a world-best of around 5.6, built on his hyper-speciality: the twists.

Nishka is considered prodigious on the four-twist, the only Indian performing it. Indian coaches say she is one of the best twisters in the world, alongside her jumps and turns.

"She has very good orientation and control of her body," Reddy explains. "Double saltos and twisting are crucial because you can connect immediately into the next line, giving you extra scores," she adds.

Indian gymnastics has come a long way from the 90s, when the Parvati Khan retro track '*Jimmy Jimmy Aaja Aaja*' was chosen for a floor routine. The 90s and 2000s Bollywood playlist, including the title track of Taal, that got a rollicking reception at NCAA is only the start. This weekend, India will own its DTPH and Bhool Bhulaiyaa bangers, and back them up with a twisting specialist.

Keep best interests of students at heart: Gill speaks up along with Tendulkar, Bindra

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 23

> **I have immense respect for every young person who believes in making their voice heard peacefully"**
> SHUBMAN GILL,
> INDIA ODI & TEST CAPTAIN

INDIA TEST and ODI captain Shubman Gill and cricket legend Sachin Tendulkar spoke up on the student protests on the issue of the NEET paper leaks on Thursday, without directly referring to the events in the national capital over the last few days. While Gill expressed "immense respect" for those trying to make their voices heard, Tendulkar stressed on the need to "find solutions that strengthen our children's future and safeguard their aspirations."

Gill and Tendulkar are two among several sports personalities like Yuvraj Singh, Abhinav Bindra and Nikhat Zareen, who have reacted to the recent developments. "As a young Indian, I believe our generation deserves every opportunity to learn, dream and shape the future we all aspire to. I have immense respect for every young person who believes in making their voice heard peacefully," said Gill in a statement he put out in his Instagram stories. "Education has the power to shape our nation's future. I hope we move forward with compassion, mutual respect and keeping the best interests of every student at heart."

Tendulkar recalled his father, who was a professor and said he understood the importance of a level playing field.

"My father was a professor. He was a mentor and guide to many young students. One lesson that he instilled early on was, 'Failure is okay, cheating is not. Never take shortcuts.' As adults in society, we have the responsibility of shaping culture. A society which prioritises outcomes over effort will seek shortcuts over meritocracy. Today, when students feel disappointed that their hard work hasn't been rewarded, it is understandable. Collectively, we should all work together towards ensuring they don't feel this way again. Young India is full of dreams and energy. They are the fuel to our success," he said on X.

Tendulkar said the society at large has a responsibility to ensure youngsters don't feel disillusioned. "As a society, all of us, including parents, teachers, friends, relatives, schools, and administrators, have a massive responsibility and different roles to play in ensuring our youth remain encouraged and energised. We must create a culture where hard work is rewarded, honesty is encouraged, and merit wins. I am certain we will all find solutions that strengthen our children's future and safeguard their aspirations," he added.

Bindra, India's first individual Olympic gold medallist, did not directly mention the protests."I have never considered myself a political person. But I do believe that some issues belong to all of us, regardless of where we stand. Education is one of them. The measure of a nation is found not only in its economy or its achievements, but in the opportunities it creates for its young people. An education system that inspires confidence, rewards merit and nurtures curiosity is one of a nation's greatest strengths," Bindra wrote on social media.

Oval awarded 2027 WTC Final days after Lord's pitch deemed 'unsatisfactory'

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 23

THE 2027 World Test Championship final will be hosted at the Oval from June 9 to 13, the International Cricket Council (ICC) said on Thursday. It will be the second time that the marquee Test match will be played at the venue, with the Oval having played host to the final in 2023. Australia had won the title that year, beating India by 209 runs. South Africa are the defending champions, beating Australia in the last WTC Final in 2027 and thus ending their long wait for an ICC trophy.

The decision comes just over a month after the Lord's pitch for the first Test between England and New Zealand was rated 'unsatisfactory' by the ICC. The iconic cricket ground was earlier expected to host the 2027 Final, as it did in 2025. Match referee Andy Pycroft had said that there was "excessive seam movement throughout the Test and the ball also kept extremely low on several occasions". "The bounce was variable throughout as 16 wickets fell on the first day and 17 on the second. There was simply an over-balance in favour of ball against bat caused by the pitch," Pycroft further said.

The 2025-27 cycle is approaching the halfway mark. Australia are currently placed top of the WTC rankings with a points percentage of 87.50 after playing eight Tests. Reigning champions South Africa are second with 75 PCT while New Zealand are third at 72.22 PCT. Bangladesh are fourth with 58.33 PCT while India are fifth with 48.15 PCT.

The 2027 World Test Championship final will be hosted at the Oval from June 9 to 13, the International Cricket Council said on Thursday. It will be the second time that the marquee Test match will be played here.

Iyer's India are eighth-time lucky

Pacers Prince, Mayank set tone before Vaibhav's fifty outclasses Zimbabwe

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, July 23

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi scored 50 runs off 19 balls. CREIMAS/BCCI

WHEN INDIA dropped Vaibhav Sooryavanshi after just three innings in England, it raised a few uncomfortable questions. The decision to leave out the left-hander looked like more than a tactical call for another right-hander in the batting order. Still, this was the first time the 15-year-old had faced the cruel side of cricket at the top level: that he can be benched.

So when Sooryavanshi took guard at Harare Sports Club on Thursday, all eyes were on how the teenager would respond to the first setback he has faced at this level. Even at the start of the chase, Zimbabwe quicks, in particular Blessing Muzarabani tested him. And unlike England, didn't throw it away, instead set up Shreyas Iyer's first win as T20I captain with 50 off 19 deliveries that included 4 boundaries and as many sixes. After the bowling unit restricted the hosts to 125/7, India crossed the line in 13.2 overs.

In his three innings in England, the short ball had caused him problems. The pull shot and uppercut he had leaned on through the IPL suddenly became his undoing. The issue was never really about shot-making. It was more about adjusting to the extra bounce on offer, combined with a little movement.

In the IPL, he had already shown a maturity beyond his years, quick to learn from his mistakes and quicker still to analyse them himself. Like in England, the surface at Harare Sports Club offered bounce, a lot more lively and quick, enough for Muzarabani to pose a few hard questions. Off the first delivery he faced, Sooryavanshi tried to get away from the line of a sharp short ball and was beaten. Left-arm seamer Richard Ngarava then squared him up, the ball almost taking his edge. A wide delivery later, Sooryavanshi began to announce his arrival on the international stage. It had taken him three innings, but off the fifth ball he faced, he swung a length ball over deep square leg, one of his favourite areas.

What followed was a typical whirlwind knock from Sooryavanshi. After a textbook cover drive, he brought out a shot lifted straight from Virat Kohli's own textbook, the one Kohli hit off Haris Rauf in Melbourne. India's seamers had bowled a probing back-of-a-length line to skittle Zimbabwe for 125 earlier in the day, and when Ngarava tried the same length back at him, Sooryavanshi stood tall, went back, and punched it over long-off. In the next over, Brad Evans was punished for a boundary and a six, both through brute power.

Then came the face-off against Muzarabani. At 6'8", his raw pace and ability to extract extra bounce had troubled the best at this year's T20 World Cup, Australia included. Off his first two overs on Thursday, he had given away only three runs, his sharp short balls and bouncers repeatedly pushing Sooryavanshi, Abhishek Sharma and Ishan Kishan onto the back foot. When he angled one across him, Sooryavanshi pounced, slashing it inside-out over cover. In England, Indian batsmen, Sooryavanshi included, had played against similar deliveries and top-edged them.

Earlier, pacer Mayank Yadav struck of the first ball of the game as the young crop of bowlers strangled Zimbabwe early and kept them in their control. Mayank's pace alongside that of Prince Yadav, Ashok Sharma pushed Zimbabwe into the back foot early, as their innings never found any sort of momentum. Mayank, playing his first international fixture in two years, was sharp through the afternoon with his raw pace and bounce coupled with his control giving him to two wickets and the Man of the Match award.

BRIEF SCORES: Zim 125/7 in 20 overs (Madhevere 39; Mayank 2/18, Prince 2/19) lost to **Ind** 126/3 in 13.2 overs (Vaibhav 50, Ishan 35, Muzarabani 2/26) by 7 wkts

Sindhu wastes match points, exits China Open

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, July 23

PV Sindhu lost 15-21, 21-13, 22-20 against Chen Yufei. BWF

IT WAS a terrible day to be tall and talented in Indian badminton. While PV Sindhu frittered away four match points, Ayush Shetty wasted three to suffer painful losses at the Super 1000 China Open.

Ayush, playing Irishman Nhat Nguyen, was on course to enter his first China Open quarters but made inexplicable errors and poor shot selections as his wily opponent won 15-21, 21-13, 22-20. The 6-ft-4 Indian could take only two of the last nine points, as coach Irwansyah was left puzzled.

PV Sindhu too ran into familiar finishing blues playing World No.2 Chen Yufei, as she wasted four match points to eventually lose 21-16, 20-22, 18-21.Later, Lakshya Sen was wrapped up in two games by Viktor Lai. On a maddening drifty court, the Indian saw his 15-9 first game lead evaporate as he lost 21-19, 21-11. The Indian couldn't capitalise on a 19-18 lead either.

Winner of the Japan Open last week, Sindhu was expected to be exhausted playing the top Chinese. But she defied fatigue to get to match point against the former Olympic champion, who was backed by the home crowd. She even led 15-13 in the decider. But the finishing got fluffed as Yufei, emboldened by her audacious second game heist, took hold of the decider and then ruled it.

Though Sindhu's attack was good enough till the 15-point mark in the decider, the Chinese had too much momentum riding her way, and she knew the Sindhu smash was fading out in her seventh match in 10 days. The win came from Yufei pushing the Indian back, inviting a smash, which shorn off strength, went too flat, and into the meshing.

It was a lesson for Irwansyah if he needs to take Sindhu to 2019 levels - she simply needs point-by-point instructions when closing out, even at 31. Impatience can resurface any time and undo all her hard work.

The first game fightback from Sindhu started at the interval with an Irwansyah pep talk. The Indian trailed 6-12, a formidable lead given Yufei's ability to forge on. But it was this very assurance that was disrupted by Sindhu's persistence that quietly tuned out the noisy Chinese home crowd.

But it all unravelled in the second game, and Sindhu let go four match points, showing familiar finishing blues. The Indian World No.8 had the lead from Point 1 to 20, before crumbling from impatience.

Sindhu had been imposing with a double body smash attack to take a 5-2 lead. The attacking hits increased in intensity, with a massive shoulder-smash to get to 10-7 lead and then a conventional hammering shot to take the 11-7 lead. She even had a surging forward cross net swoosh kill to keep the lead at 14-11, and despite Yufei threatening to overturn things at 16-18, Sindhu was up 20-16. Then panic struck.

The Chinese would get six points in a row, as Sindhu let go a shuttle on the backline - the first signs of fatigue clouding judgment.

"I had my chances in the second game," Sindhu told BWF. "I should have finished it"

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